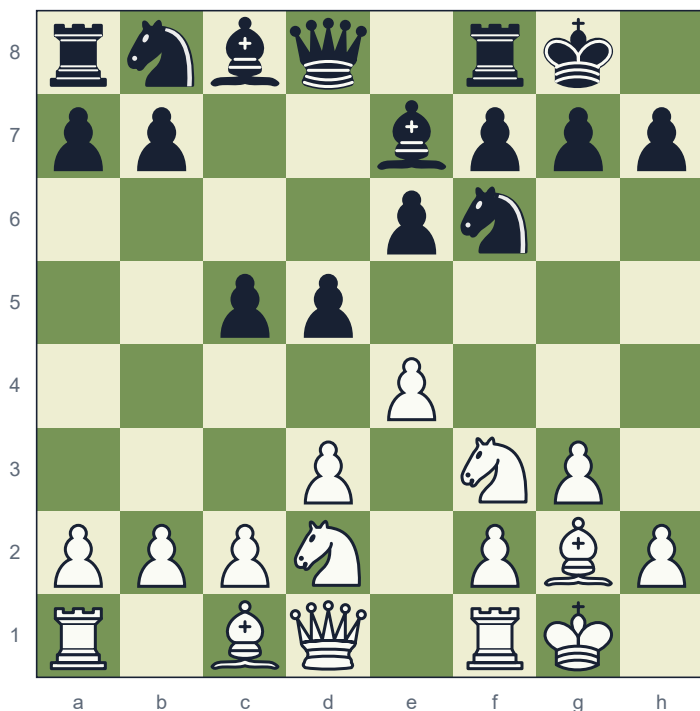


King's Indian Attack

A complete practical curriculum from the ground up

White normally combines Nf3, g3, Bg2, O-O, d3, Nbd2 and e4. This is a family of positions, not seven moves to play regardless of Black. The core route starts with 1.Nf3; separate chapters explain the useful 1.e4 routes.



The reference position - Black to move

YOUR PERSPECTIVE

White is at the bottom of every diagram. Coordinates remain explicit and all pieces stay upright.

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

24 opening branches, six middlegame laboratories, 48 exercises with explained answers, and a 12-week practice plan. Each subject also appears in one combined volume.

START HERE

Read this booklet first. Then learn one line from each family in Booklet 01. Use 02 for plans, 03 for practice positions, 04 for retrieval and 05 for study schedules and reference.

How to use this course

YOUR FIRST PASS

Use a real or digital board. Read the foundations, then learn only the first line of each opening family. Play slow practice games before trying to remember every variation. A useful opening lesson ends with a decision you can explain, not a string of moves you can recite.

YOUR SECOND PASS

Return to the branch your opponent actually played. Replay it from move one and stop before each move by your side. Name the threat, two plausible replies and the reason for your choice. Check the printed continuation only after committing to an answer.

YOUR THIRD PASS

Use the middlegame laboratories and exercise book. These are original illustrative positions and engine-assisted continuations, not attributed master games. Switch colors in training so you experience the opponent's space, defensive resources and attacking chances.

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This is a broad practical curriculum from basic rules to common opening decisions, middlegames and typical transitions. Chess has too many legal branches for a finite course to exhaust. The course teaches a decision process for unfamiliar replies and marks alternatives, warnings and entry-route boundaries explicitly.

The board and the object of the game

COORDINATES

Files are a through h from White's left to right. Ranks are 1 through 8 from White's side toward Black. A square such as e4 has one file letter and one rank number. White has a light square at the near right corner, h1. Black-oriented diagrams reverse the coordinate display, not the movement rules.

URNS AND CHECK

White moves first; the players alternate one move each. A move may not leave your own king attacked. Check means that the king is attacked; answer by moving the king, capturing the attacker or blocking a line attack when possible. A knight check cannot be blocked.

CHECKMATE AND STALEMATE

Checkmate means the player to move is in check and has no legal reply. Stalemate means the player has no legal move but is not in check; it is a draw. Before announcing mate, examine every king move, capture and possible block. Kings are never actually captured.

MATERIAL IS A GUIDE

For beginner decisions, a pawn is roughly 1, a knight or bishop 3, a rook 5 and a queen 9. These are rough comparisons, not a scoring rule. A king has no exchange value. Activity, safety, passed pawns and immediate tactics can outweigh a small material difference.

How the pieces move

ROOK AND BISHOP

A rook moves along a rank or file. A bishop moves diagonally and stays on its starting square color. Neither can jump over any piece. A sliding piece controls only as far as the first occupied square on each ray; do not count an attack through your own pawn.

QUEEN AND KNIGHT

A queen combines rook and bishop movement. A knight moves two squares in one direction and one at right angles, changing square color. The knight may jump over pieces. A knight on f3 can move to d2, d4, e1, e5, g1, g5, h2 or h4 if the destination and king-safety rules allow.

KING

A king moves one square in any direction and cannot enter an attacked square. The kings cannot stand next to each other. A pinned enemy piece can still restrict the king's legal squares; the rules about attacked squares are more subtle than whether that enemy piece could legally move away from its own king.

PAWN

White pawns move toward higher rank numbers; Black pawns toward lower. A pawn moves one square straight ahead into an empty square, or two from its starting rank if both squares are empty. It captures one square diagonally forward. It cannot move backward or capture straight ahead.

Castling, promotion and en passant

CASTLING

Castling moves the king two squares toward a rook and places that rook on the square the king crossed. The king and that rook must never have moved, the intervening squares must be empty, and the king must not be in check or cross or land on an attacked square. A rook being attacked does not by itself prevent castling.

RIGHTS DO NOT RETURN

If a king or rook moves out and back, the relevant castling right is still lost. A king moved to f1 in the King's Gambit must coordinate its rooks another way. In queenless positions the loss of castling may be less serious, but the legal right remains lost.

PROMOTION

A pawn reaching the last rank must promote to a queen, rook, bishop or knight of its color. It need not choose a previously captured piece. A second queen is legal. Underpromotion can avoid stalemate or create a knight fork, so inspect the exact position before always choosing a queen.

EN PASSANT

Immediately after an opposing pawn advances two squares from its starting rank and lands beside your pawn on your fifth rank, you may capture it as though it had advanced one square. The opportunity lasts only for your next move. The capture is illegal if removing those pawns exposes your own king to check.

Reading moves and navigating branches

ALGEBRAIC NOTATION

K means king, Q queen, R rook, B bishop and N knight. Pawns have no piece letter: e4 is a pawn move. Bc4 means a bishop moves to c4. Nxe5 captures on e5. exd5 is an e-file pawn capturing on d5. A plus sign is check; # is checkmate; O-O is kingside castling and O-O-O queenside castling.

WHICH PIECE MOVED

If two identical pieces can legally reach the same square, notation distinguishes them: Nbd2 means the knight from the b-file; R1e2 means the rook from rank 1. The board, not the notation alone, determines which capture or check is legal. Promotion is written e8=Q, with + or # when appropriate.

MOVE NUMBERS

1.e4 e5 is White's first move and Black's first reply. A line beginning 7...Nf6 starts with Black's seventh move. All main opening lines in this course begin at the initial position; laboratory continuations display their starting diagram and exact move number.

ONE LINE IS NOT FORCED

An example to move ten is one route through the position. It is not a claim that every reply is compulsory. The authored anchor and its illustrative continuation are distinguished. Each line has an ID that also appears in the PGN files and exercises.

Your thinking routine on every move

1. INSPECT THE LAST MOVE

Ask what the opponent's move changed. Did it attack a piece, unmask a bishop, release a rook file, threaten mate or leave something undefended? A remembered opening move is only a candidate until it survives this inspection.

2. EXAMINE FORCING MOVES

Check all checks, serious captures and direct threats for both sides. Calculate the opponent's best reply, not the reply you hope for. Stop the line at a position you can assess: material, king safety and the resulting pawn structure.

3. GENERATE CANDIDATES

Usually compare two or three useful moves: one forcing move, one developing or improving move, and one central response if relevant. In a cramped position ask which exchange or pawn break creates room. In an attacking position ask whether the center can open against your king.

4. BLUNDER CHECK

Before moving, visualize the new position. Is your queen or another piece loose? Have you removed a defender or opened a diagonal to your king? Can the opponent answer with a check, fork or intermediate capture? A ten-second check often saves more points than memorizing another opening branch.

Center, development and time

OCCUPY AND INFLUENCE

Pawns on d4 and e4 occupy central space; bishops and knights can influence those squares from a distance. A restrained setup needs a plan to challenge the opponent's center. Space becomes useful when it gives your pieces safe squares and restricts the opponent.

DEVELOPMENT

Bring knights and bishops into useful play, protect the king and connect the rooks. Avoid moving the same piece repeatedly without a concrete gain. An exception must be explained: a queen retreat in the Scandinavian or a knight escape in the King's Gambit can be compulsory.

A TEMPO

A tempo is one move of useful time. Attacking a queen while developing often gains time, but a check that helps the opponent develop can fail to do so. Count actual useful moves and threats instead of assuming every attack is a gain.

OPENING THE CENTER

If your king is safer and your pieces are ready, opening files can exploit a development lead. If your king is exposed, central exchanges may be dangerous. A closed center often allows maneuvering or a wing attack, but first verify that the opponent cannot open it with a pawn break.

Pawn structures and planning vocabulary

BREAK AND TENSION

A pawn break challenges an enemy pawn structure: c4 against d5 or ...c5 against d4. Tension exists when pawns can capture each other but neither side has committed. Before exchanging, ask which pieces become active, which file opens and which pawn becomes weak.

CHAIN AND BASE

A pawn chain is a diagonal line of mutually supporting pawns. In a white d4-e5 chain, d4 is the base and e5 the head. An attack on either end may work, but the calculation differs: ...c5 usually challenges d4, while ...f6 challenges e5.

WEAK SQUARES AND OUTPOSTS

A square is a useful outpost when a piece can occupy it securely and create meaningful pressure, often because enemy pawns cannot chase it. An outpost with no targets may be less valuable than a flexible central piece. Check whether exchanges eliminate its support.

FILES, DIAGONALS AND LEVERS

A file without pawns is open; one with no pawn of your color is half-open for you. A fianchetto bishop can be excellent on an open diagonal and restricted behind blocked pawns. A lever changes that reality. Name the pawn move that makes your plan possible.

Playing, recording and analyzing a game

CHOOSE A USEFUL TIME CONTROL

For course practice use at least 15 minutes with an increment, or a longer control if available. Blitz is useful for pattern recognition after the basic decisions are learned. It is a poor substitute for calculating an unfamiliar sharp opening carefully.

ANALYZE YOURSELF FIRST

After the game, mark the first unfamiliar position and write your candidates without an engine. Identify the first important mistake, not only the final blunder. Separate opening memory, tactical calculation, strategic judgment and time-management errors.

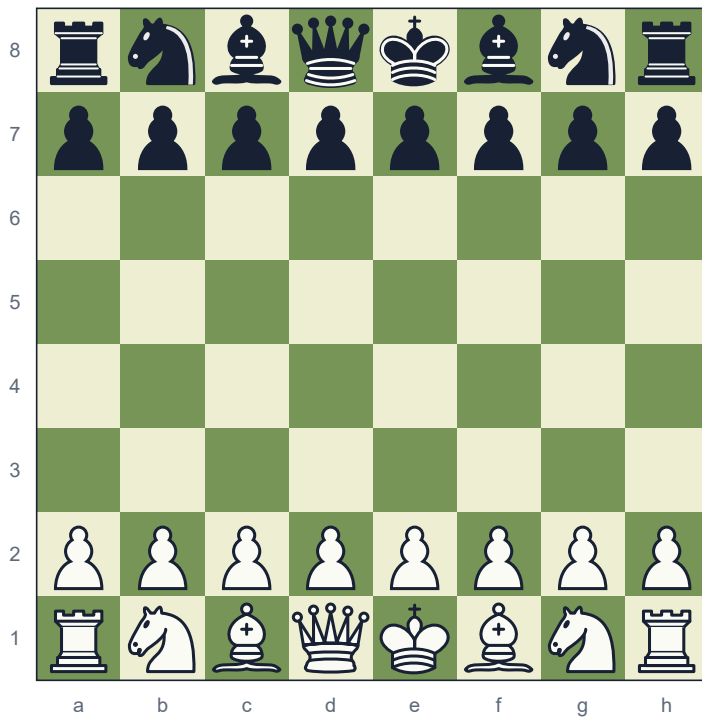
THEN USE THE TOOLS

Compare the game with the matching line ID. Use an engine to test forcing variations and examine a stronger defensive reply. An engine number is evidence from a finite search, not a verbal explanation. Write one sentence that tells you what to do differently next time.

BUILD A SMALL ERROR NOTEBOOK

Keep the position, your move, a better candidate, the opponent's key reply and one lesson. Revisit it after one day, three days, a week and a month. Add the position to your repertoire only when you can explain it without the answer visible.

Read the diagram before the moves



White to move

A RELIABLE FIRST SCAN

Find both kings, name the side to move and locate all pawns in the center. Then inspect checks, captures and direct threats.

ORIENTATION

Your course side is at the bottom. On a Black-oriented board, files read h to a along the bottom; pawns still move according to their color and rank numbers.

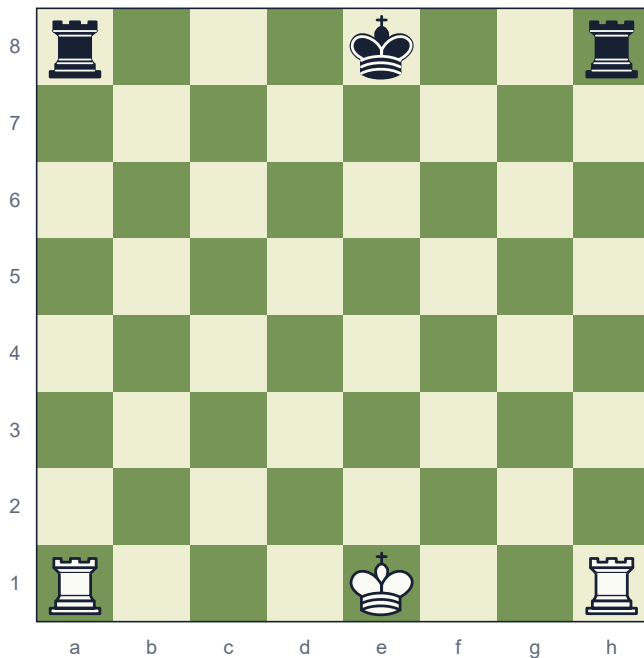
PRACTICE WITHOUT MOVING

Find e4, d5, f7 and b2. Name the piece that begins on each of b1, c1, f8 and g8. From the initial position, count White's legal pawn moves and knight moves: 16 pawn moves and 4 knight moves.

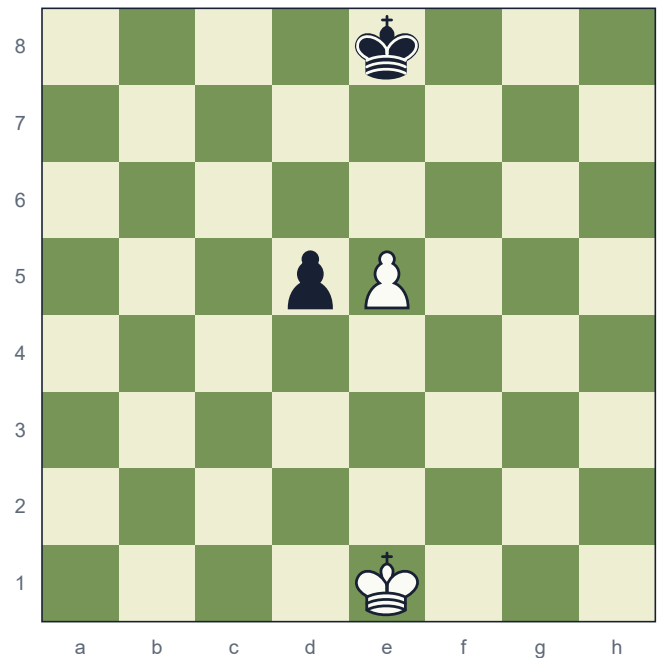
ANSWER THE REAL POSITION

A board caption always states whose move it is and whether the king is in check. You may not ignore check to finish development. In the initial position, bishops and rooks are blocked by friendly pieces.

Castling and en passant on a board



White to move - castling geometry



White to move - en passant available

LEFT: CASTLING GEOMETRY

With the rights recorded in this teaching position, White may castle O-O or O-O-O. The king crosses f1 or d1 and lands on g1 or c1; the rook lands on f1 or d1. Empty squares alone are not enough in a real game: check previous king/rook moves and attacked king squares.

RIGHT: IMMEDIATE EN PASSANT

Black has just played ...d7-d5. White can play exd6 en passant: the white pawn lands on d6 and the black pawn is removed from d5. If White plays another move, the special capture is no longer available.

TRAINING QUESTION

Why can a knight jump over a piece but a bishop cannot? Why can a rook be attacked during legal castling while the king cannot cross an attacked square? Explain the movement rule before using it in an opening.

Your first moves, explained

1. NF3

Develops the king knight toward e5 and d4. In the King's Gambit it also controls h4, making an immediate queen check there unattractive.

2. G3

Prepares a fianchetto and changes the long diagonal. Check the bishop and corner rook before assuming the next developing move is safe.

3. BG2

Completes the kingside fianchetto. Trace the diagonal to its first blocker; the bishop cannot attack through friendly pawns or pieces.

4. O-O

Moves the king toward shelter and brings a rook toward the center. Check the resulting open lines before assuming the king is safe.

5. D3

Supports a restrained central formation and opens one bishop diagonal while possibly blocking another. Plan the later pawn break.

BEFORE YOU MEMORIZE

The reference route is one example. Reconstruct it, then change one opposing move and explain why the next automatic setup move might need to change.

Your first moves, explained / continued

6. NBD2

Develops the queen knight while leaving the c-pawn free. The knight supports e4 and may seek c4 or a route through f1.

7. E4

Changes central space and pawn contacts. Calculate captures, advances and maintaining tension before choosing the next piece plan.

BEFORE YOU MEMORIZE

The reference route is one example. Reconstruct it, then change one opposing move and explain why the next automatic setup move might need to change.

Repertoire map / 1

THE FRENCH-TYPE CENTER

Start with KIA-01. Then add the remaining branches one at a time. The IDs connect this map, the theory booklet and the PGN files.

KIA-01 The core French-type position

Support e4 before converting it into an e5 wedge.

KIA-02 The e5 wedge and ...Nd7

An advanced pawn gives space and creates a target.

KIA-03 Black exchanges on e4

A changed pawn structure requires a changed plan.

KIA-04 Black closes with ...d4

Against a d4 wedge, identify a lever.

KIA-05 Black delays castling

Attack a real king position, not a remembered diagram.

KIA-06 The direct 1.e4 French route

A transposition is a position, not a similar-looking setup.

Repertoire map / 2

SLAV STRUCTURES AND ACTIVE BISHOPS

Start with KIA-07. Then add the remaining branches one at a time. The IDs connect this map, the theory booklet and the PGN files.

KIA-07 Slav setup: bishop outside the chain

Notice which bishop escaped the pawn chain.

KIA-08 A direct central challenge with c4

c4 is a useful adaptation, not a failure of the system.

KIA-09 Questioning Bf5 with Nh4

A damaged pawn structure may open useful lines for its owner.

KIA-10 The ...Bg4 pin

A pinned defender may not be a real defender.

KIA-11 An early ...Bg4 without ...c6

The location of the c-pawn changes the available break.

KIA-12 Caro-Kann route with 1.e4

Name the actual central pawns before naming your attack.

Repertoire map / 3

FIANCHETTOS AND OTHER CENTRAL STRUCTURES

Start with KIA-13. Then add the remaining branches one at a time. The IDs connect this map, the theory booklet and the PGN files.

KIA-13 Symmetrical fianchetto

Symmetry calls for useful improvements, not an automatic pawn storm.

KIA-14 Black chooses ...d5 in the fianchetto

When the opponent occupies the center, plan the challenge.

KIA-15 Reversed King's Indian structure

Reversed colors do not reverse every plan mechanically.

KIA-16 The Pachman setup

Count the real pieces around the intended pawn advance.

KIA-17 Sicilian with ...e6

The Sicilian entry is useful when the center matches.

KIA-18 Sicilian with ...d6

KIA piece placement does not guarantee a KIA attack.

Repertoire map / 4

FIRST-MOVE CHOICES AND USEFUL ADAPTATIONS

Start with KIA-19. Then add the remaining branches one at a time. The IDs connect this map, the theory booklet and the PGN files.

KIA-19 Black plays ...c5 on move one

Pick the knight square to support a plan.

KIA-20 Black occupies e5 immediately

A pawn attack on a piece overrides a setup plan.

KIA-21 Dutch-style ...f5

Meet wing space with a supported central challenge.

KIA-22 The ...b5 flank expansion

Ask what the flank bishop attacks.

KIA-23 Early ...d4 before the setup

Adapt the pawn structure before copying the piece setup.

KIA-24 Early central exchange before castling

Queen exchange can change what king safety means.

The French-type center

HOW TO STUDY THIS FAMILY

First reconstruct the main branch from the initial position. Explain the central structure, each side's king safety and the most urgent threat. Then compare the alternatives one at a time.

MAIN BRANCH

KIA-01 - Re1 supports e4 and makes e5 more credible. Black has a broad d5-c5 center and may expand on the queenside while White builds a kingside initiative.

A PRACTICAL PLAN

Check whether e5 is safe, then consider Nf1 and h4 only if the center is stable. White's queen bishop needs a route, often through f4 or g5 after development.

THE OPPONENT GETS A VOTE

Black can play ...Qc7, ...b5 or ...dxe4. A kingside attack is premature if e4 can simply be captured.

RECOGNITION TEST

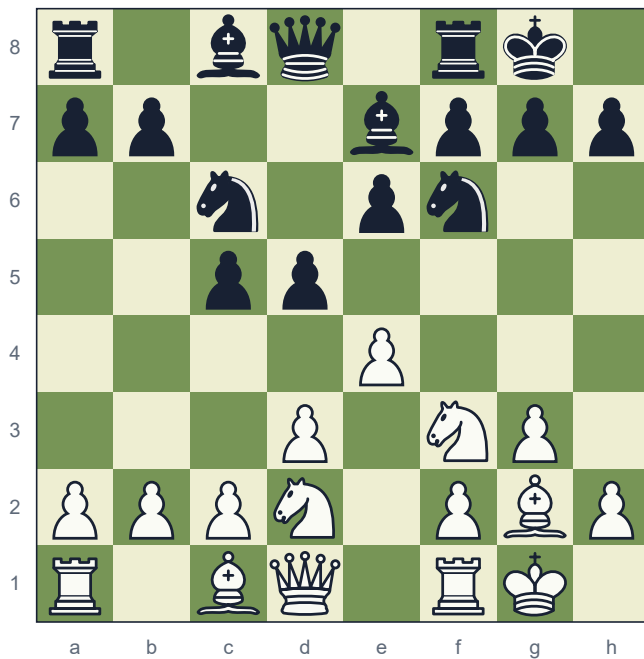
For each alternative, name the move that changes the plan. If you cannot identify that decision, return to the board rather than memorizing the last three moves.

KIA-01 / The core French-type position

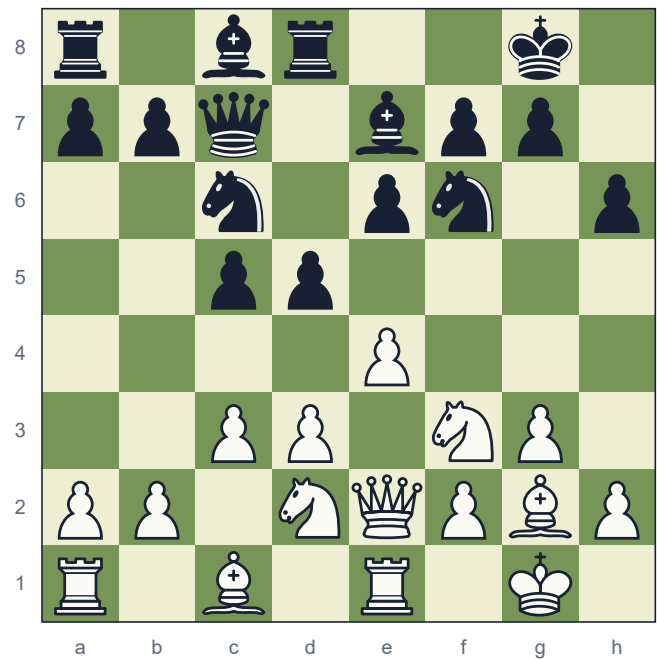
COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 Qc7 9. c3 h6 10. Qe2 Rd8

Authored anchor ends after 8. Re1. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

Re1 supports e4 and makes e5 more credible. Black has a broad d5-c5 center and may expand on the queenside while White builds a kingside initiative.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Check whether e5 is safe, then consider Nf1 and h4 only if the center is stable. White's queen bishop needs a route, often through f4 or g5 after development.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

Black can play ...Qc7, ...b5 or ...dxe4. A kingside attack is premature if e4 can simply be captured.

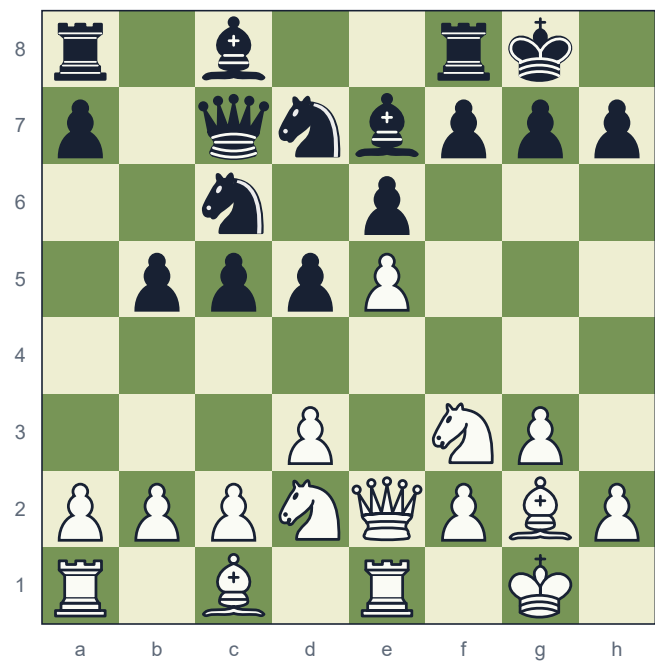
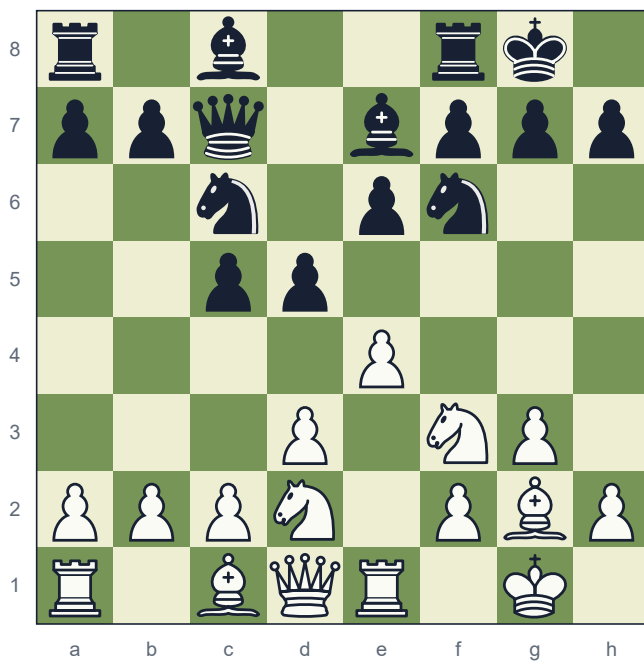
REMEMBER Support e4 before converting it into an e5 wedge.

KIA-02 / The e5 wedge and ...Nd7

COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 Qc7 9. e5 Nd7 10. Qe2 b5

Authored anchor ends after 9... Nd7. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



WHY THIS BRANCH

Advancing e5 gains space and displaces Nf6, but fixes a pawn that Black can undermine with ...f6. The f1 knight route is now a plan, not a forced continuation.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Improve Nf1-e3 or h2-g4 according to available squares, and use h4 only after inspecting ...f6. Keep d3 defended as Black expands.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

Black can strike at the base or head of the chain. A dramatic wing attack fails if the center opens with your pieces misplaced.

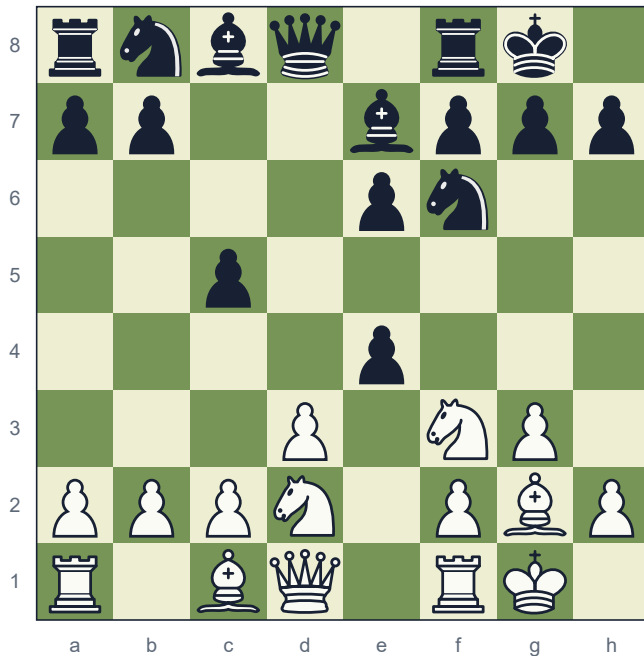
REMEMBER An advanced pawn gives space and creates a target.

KIA-03 / Black exchanges on e4

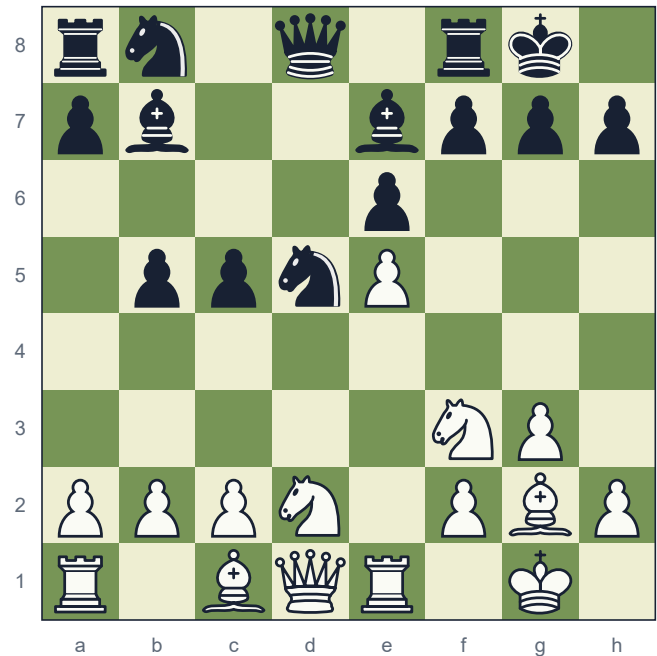
COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 dxe4 8. dxe4 b5 9. e5 Nd5 10. Re1 Bb7

Authored anchor ends after 8. dxe4. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

The central exchange removes the familiar d5-e5 blockade. White's d-pawn becomes an e-pawn, opening the d-file and changing the bishop's prospects.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Develop on open files and compare piece activity. Use the e4 outpost control and consider Nc4 when it creates a real threat.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

An automatic e5 attack plan may no longer fit. Black can use ...Nc6 and ...Qc7 to put pressure on e4.

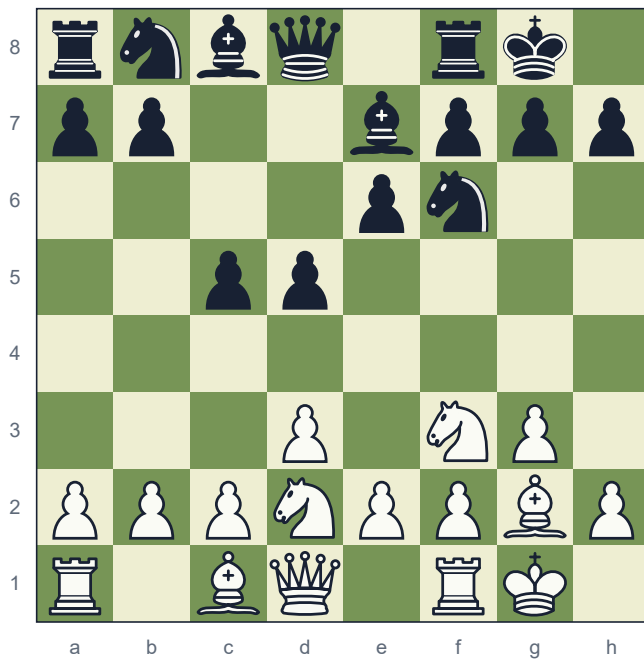
REMEMBER A changed pawn structure requires a changed plan.

KIA-04 / Black closes with ...d4

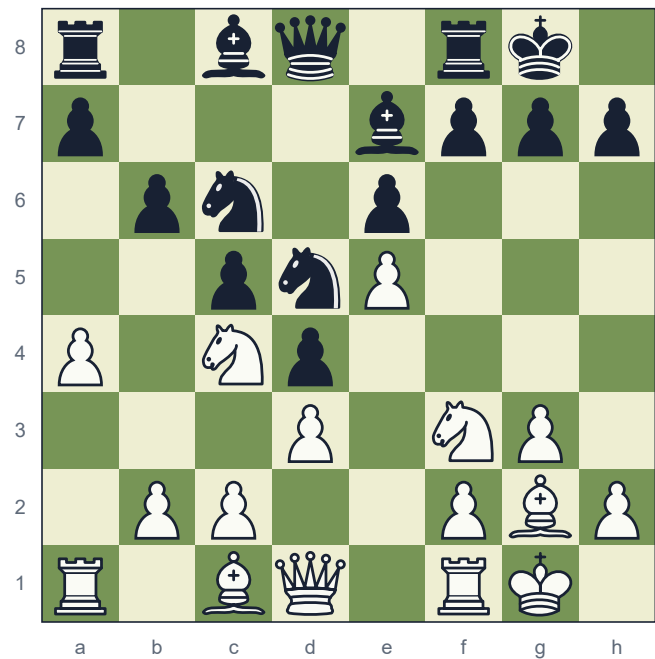
COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 d4 8. a4 b6 9. e5 Nd5 10. Nc4 Nc6

Authored anchor ends after 7... d4. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

Black gains space and closes the d-file. White must choose where to challenge the chain rather than follow a standard e5 attack by habit.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Consider c3 against d4, or Nc4 if the square is available. Keep the f-pawn flexible until you know whether kingside expansion is safe.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

...Nc6 and ...e5 can consolidate a space advantage. Waiting without a pawn break can leave every white piece short of squares.

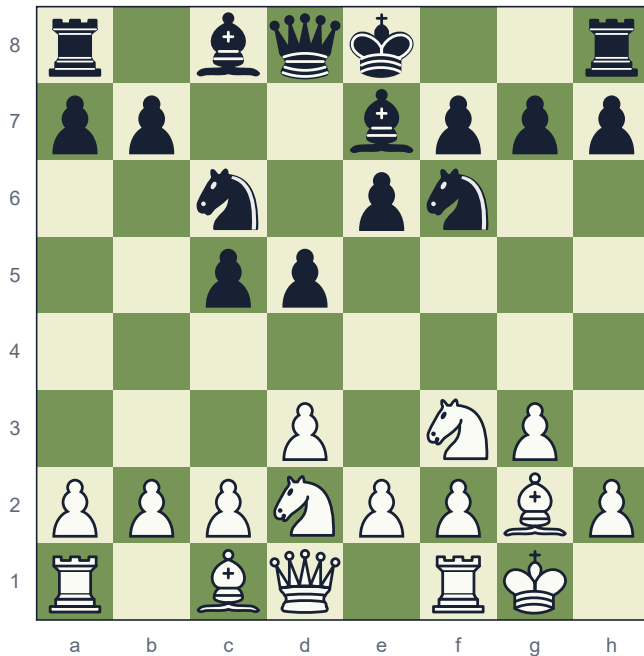
REMEMBER Against a d4 wedge, identify a lever.

KIA-05 / Black delays castling

COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 c5 6. Nbd2 Nc6 7. e4 Qc7 8. exd5 exd5 9. d4 b6 10. dxc5 bxc5

Authored anchor ends after 7... Qc7. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

Black has not declared the king's destination. White has no automatic target on g8 and should prepare useful central moves first.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Re1 supports e4; e5 can gain space if tactically justified. Wait to see whether Black castles or opens the center before committing the h-pawn.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

A pawn storm toward an empty kingside wastes time. Black may answer by exchanging central pawns with the king still flexible.

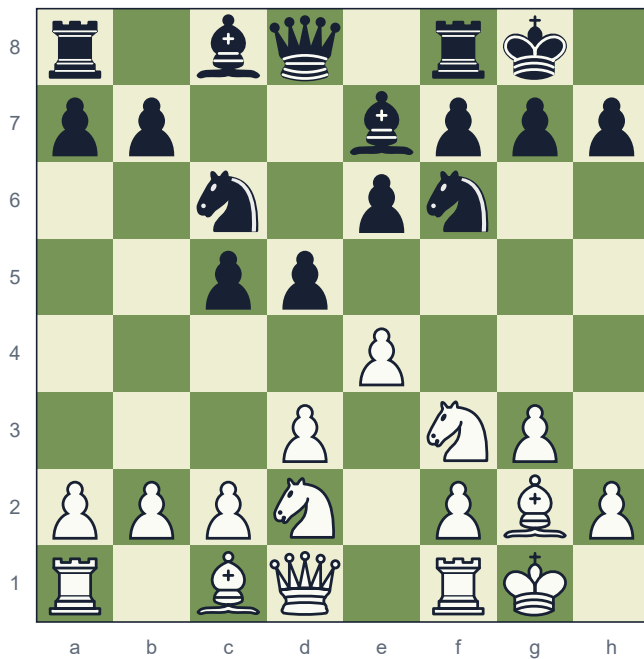
REMEMBER Attack a real king position, not a remembered diagram.

KIA-06 / The direct 1.e4 French route

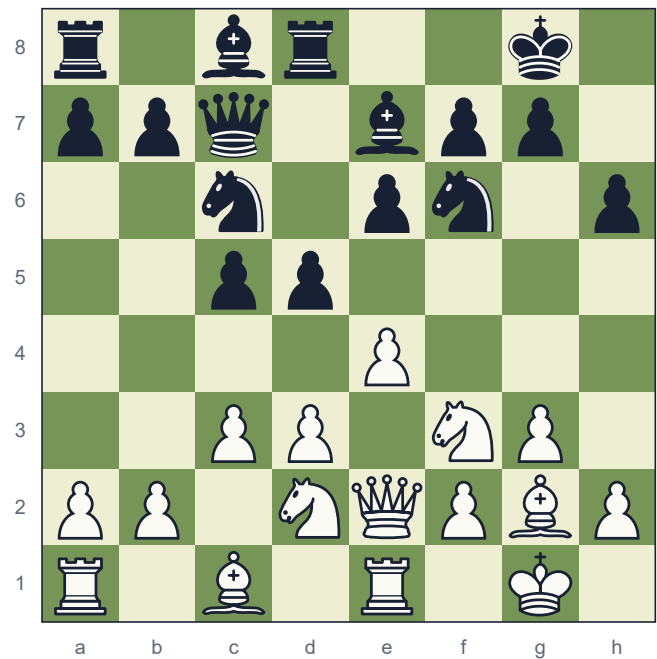
COURSE STUDY LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 c5 5. g3 Nc6 6. Bg2 Be7 7. O-O O-O 8. Re1 Qc7 9. c3 h6 10. Qe2 Rd8

Authored anchor ends after 8. Re1. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

The same structural idea can be reached with 1.e4 and d3. Nd2 must precede Ngf3 here if White wants this exact arrangement without blocking a knight.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Compare the position with the 1.Nf3 route by placing every piece, including the queen bishop. Learn the transposition once and keep both entry routes on the map.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

Black is not forced to play ...Nf6 or ...Be7. Early ...dxe4 or a different bishop development changes the task.

REMEMBER A transposition is a position, not a similar-looking setup.

Work through KIA-01

7. E4

Changes central space and pawn contacts. Calculate captures, advances and maintaining tension before choosing the next piece plan.

8. RE1

Places the rook on the e-file, commonly supporting e4 or preparing pressure against an opposing king or central pawn.

9. C3

Places the pawn on c3. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

10. QE2

Places the queen on e2. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

EXPLAIN THE POSITION

Re1 supports e4 and makes e5 more credible. Black has a broad d5-c5 center and may expand on the queenside while White builds a kingside initiative. Check whether e5 is safe, then consider Nf1 and h4 only if the center is stable. White's queen bishop needs a route, often through f4 or g5 after development.

PRACTICE TASK

Replay this branch without looking. Stop at the first move you cannot explain. Then play the endpoint for ten moves against a partner or engine, switching sides for a second game. Judge your decisions, not just the result.

Slav structures and active bishops

HOW TO STUDY THIS FAMILY

First reconstruct the main branch from the initial position. Explain the central structure, each side's king safety and the most urgent threat. Then compare the alternatives one at a time.

MAIN BRANCH

KIA-07 - Black develops the light-squared bishop before closing it with ...e6. White cannot assume that Black has the restricted bishop of a French-type position.

A PRACTICAL PLAN

Prepare e4 with adequate support, or choose c4 to challenge d5 directly. Consider Nh4 only if it wins a useful bishop exchange without neglecting the center.

THE OPPONENT GETS A VOTE

The bishop on f5 influences e4 and may move to g6 if chased. A knight trip can cost more time than the bishop is worth.

RECOGNITION TEST

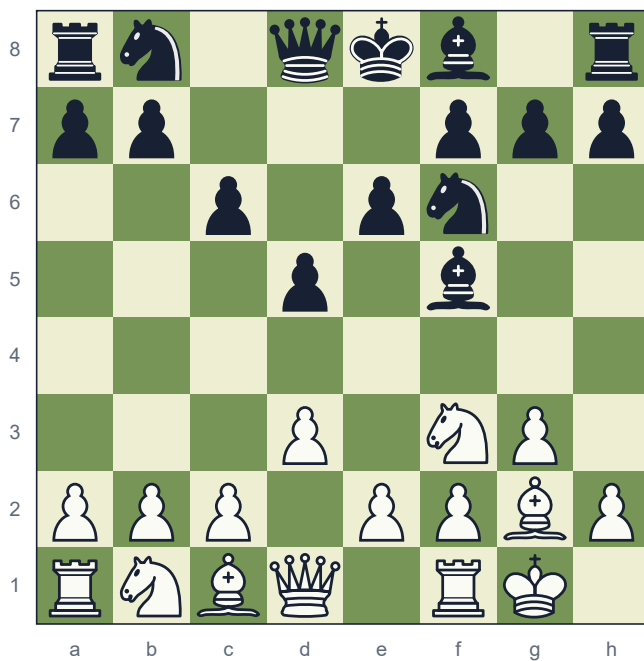
For each alternative, name the move that changes the plan. If you cannot identify that decision, return to the board rather than memorizing the last three moves.

KIA-07 / Slav setup: bishop outside the chain

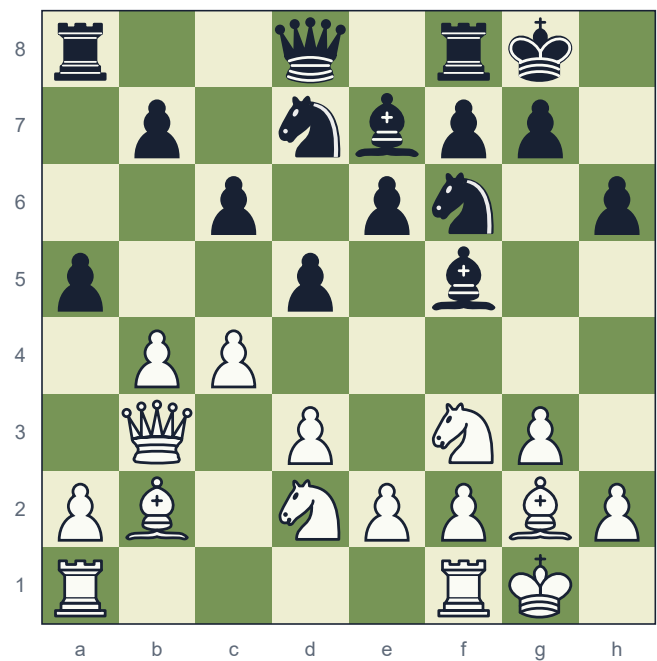
COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 c6 4. O-O Bf5 5. d3 e6 6. Nbd2 h6 7. c4 Be7 8. b4 O-O 9. Qb3 Nbd7 10. Bb2 a5

Authored anchor ends after 6. Nbd2. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

Black develops the light-squared bishop before closing it with ...e6. White cannot assume that Black has the restricted bishop of a French-type position.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Prepare e4 with adequate support, or choose c4 to challenge d5 directly. Consider Nh4 only if it wins a useful bishop exchange without neglecting the center.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

The bishop on f5 influences e4 and may move to g6 if chased. A knight trip can cost more time than the bishop is worth.

REMEMBER Notice which bishop escaped the pawn chain.

KIA-08 / A direct central challenge with c4

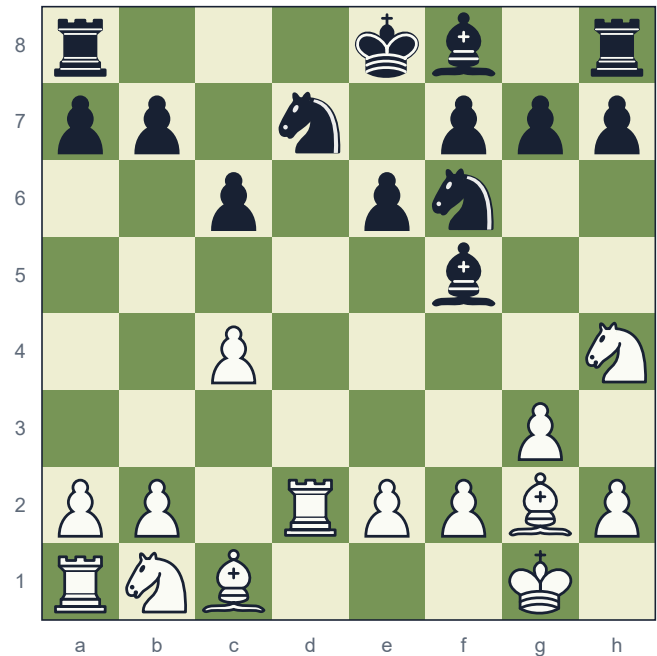
COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 c6 4. O-O Bf5 5. d3 e6 6. c4 dxc4 7. dxc4 Qxd1 8. Rxd1 Bc2 9. Rd2 Bf5 10. Nh4 Nbd7

Authored anchor ends after 7. dxc4. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

White changes the usual KIA pawn structure to challenge Black's center immediately. The d-pawn recapture opens the d-file and retains a central foothold.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Develop the queen knight and contest the open file. Decide whether a later e4 gains space or simply creates a target.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

Black can exchange queens or use ...Nbd7 and ...Be7 to complete development. The position is now closer to a Reti structure than an e5 attack.

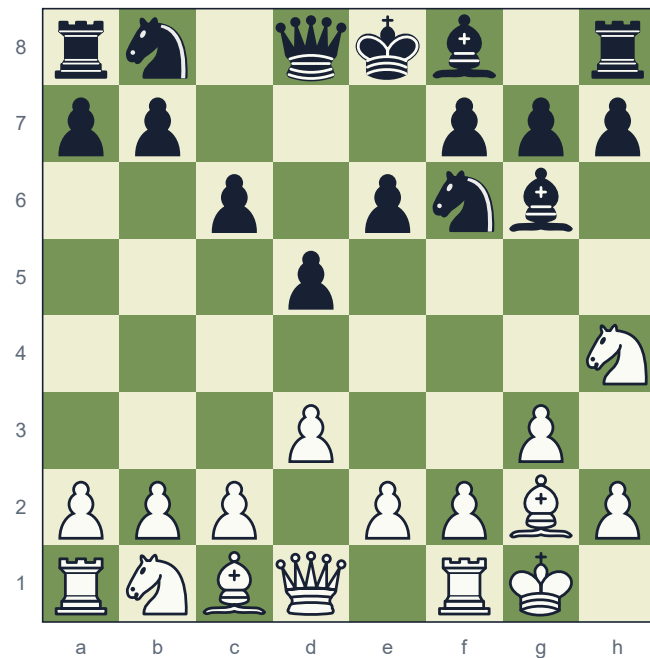
REMEMBER c4 is a useful adaptation, not a failure of the system.

KIA-09 / Questioning Bf5 with Nh4

COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 c6 4. O-O Bf5 5. d3 e6 6. Nh4 Bg6 7. Nxg6 hxg6 8. Nd2 Bd6 9. e4 Nbd7 10. d4 Nxe4

Authored anchor ends after 7... hxg6. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

White gives a knight for the active bishop and changes Black's kingside pawn structure. The open h-file can help Black as well as create targets.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Develop the remaining pieces and use the bishop pair in a position that may open. Do not assume doubled pawns alone justify a direct attack.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

Black's h8 rook now has an open file. Castling short was already a commitment, so watch pressure toward your own king.

REMEMBER A damaged pawn structure may open useful lines for its owner.

KIA-10 / The ...Bg4 pin

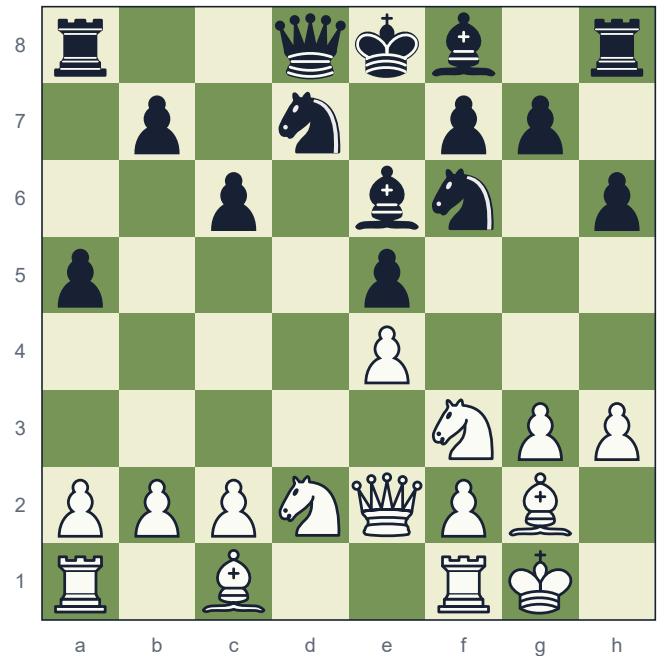
COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 c6 4. O-O Bg4 5. d3 Nbd7 6. Nbd2 e5 7. e4 dxe4 8. dxe4 h6 9. h3 Be6 10. Qe2 a5

Authored anchor ends after 6... e5. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

Black pins or pressures Nf3 and establishes a broad center. White needs a central plan before beginning a maneuvering attack.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Consider e4 if it holds, or c4 to challenge d5. h3 can ask the bishop a question but should serve development rather than become an isolated tempo.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

If Nf3 is exchanged, e4 may lose a defender. Count defenders after ...Bxf3 rather than before it.

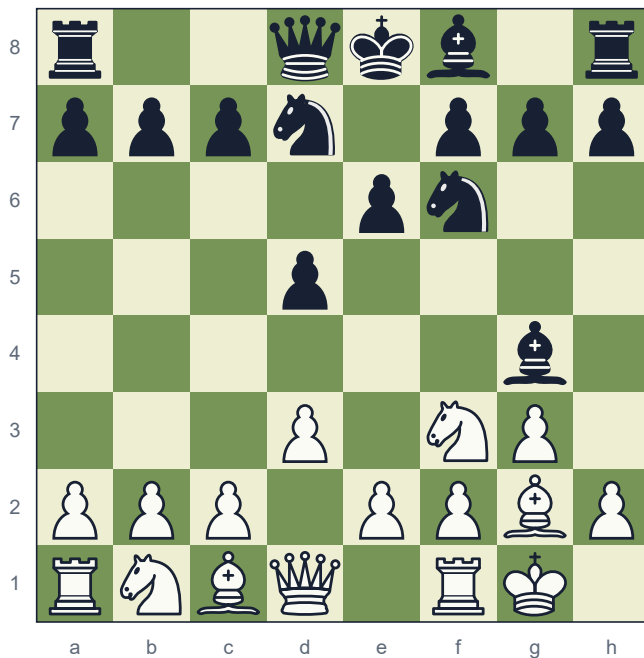
REMEMBER A pinned defender may not be a real defender.

KIA-11 / An early ...Bg4 without ...c6

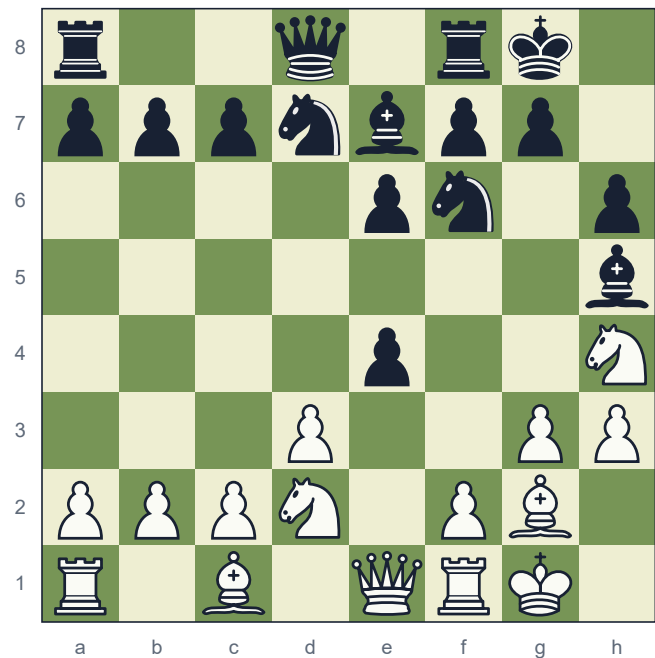
COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Bg4 3. Bg2 Nd7 4. O-O e6 5. d3 Ngf6 6. Nbd2 Bh5 7. h3 h6 8. Qe1 Be7 9. e4 O-O 10. Nh4 dxe4

Authored anchor ends after 6. Nbd2. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

Black develops actively while retaining the c-pawn's choice between c5 and c6. White keeps the usual pieces but must watch central pressure.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Use e4 with sufficient support and prepare Re1 if needed. The queen can sometimes unpin Nf3 by moving from d1, but move it only for a clear reason.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

Copying the Slav plan can be inaccurate because Black can play ...c5 in one move. White's d3 pawn can become a target after central exchanges.

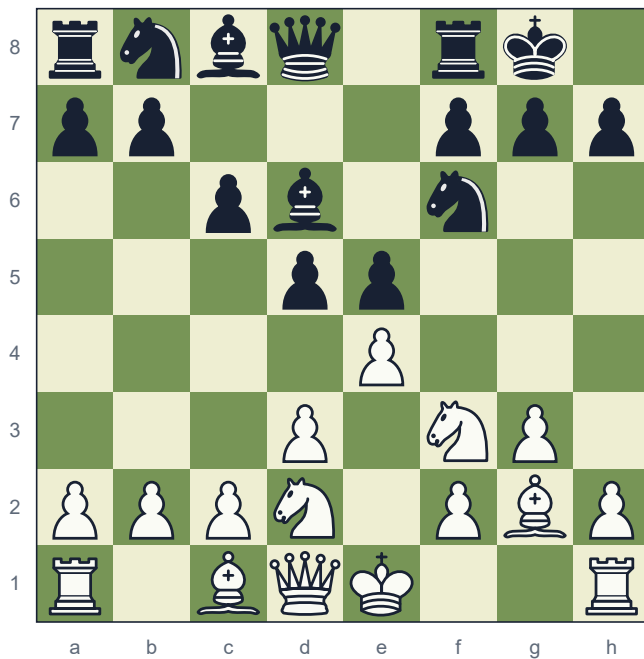
REMEMBER The location of the c-pawn changes the available break.

KIA-12 / Caro-Kann route with 1.e4

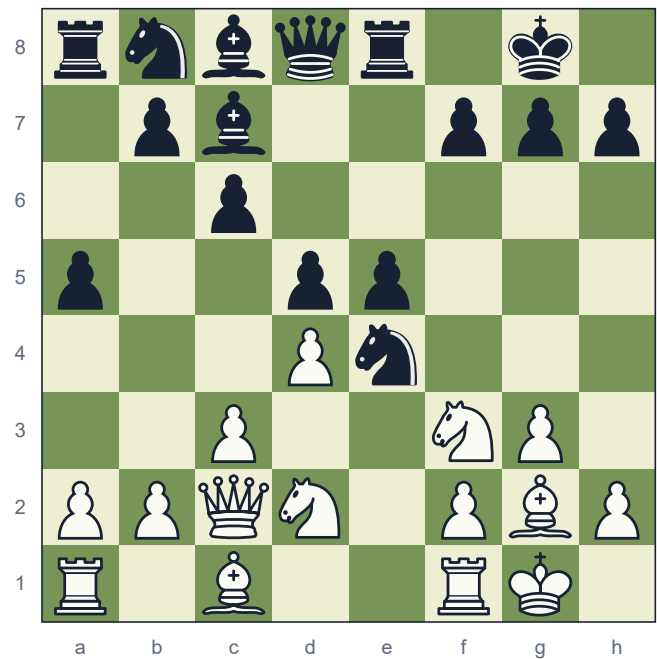
COURSE STUDY LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 e5 4. Ngf3 Bd6 5. g3 Nf6 6. Bg2 O-O 7. O-O Bc7 8. c3 Re8 9. Qc2 a5 10. d4 Nxe4

Authored anchor ends after 7. O-O. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

White can choose a KIA-style arrangement, but Black obtains an e5-d5 center and an active bishop. This is not the usual French target position.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Challenge the center with c3 and possibly d4, or prepare exd5 when the resulting files favor your pieces. Maintain a safe e4 pawn.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

Black may gain space with ...d4. A rehearsed e5 push is impossible while Black occupies e5.

REMEMBER Name the actual central pawns before naming your attack.

Work through KIA-07

7. C4

Changes central space and pawn contacts. Calculate captures, advances and maintaining tension before choosing the next piece plan.

8. B4

Places the pawn on b4. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

9. QB3

Places the queen on b3. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

10. BB2

Places the bishop on b2, attacking knight on f6. A legal capture may still be unsound if the target is defended.

EXPLAIN THE POSITION

Black develops the light-squared bishop before closing it with ...e6. White cannot assume that Black has the restricted bishop of a French-type position. Prepare e4 with adequate support, or choose c4 to challenge d5 directly. Consider Nh4 only if it wins a useful bishop exchange without neglecting the center.

PRACTICE TASK

Replay this branch without looking. Stop at the first move you cannot explain. Then play the endpoint for ten moves against a partner or engine, switching sides for a second game. Judge your decisions, not just the result.

Fianchettoes and other central structures

HOW TO STUDY THIS FAMILY

First reconstruct the main branch from the initial position. Explain the central structure, each side's king safety and the most urgent threat. Then compare the alternatives one at a time.

MAIN BRANCH

KIA-13 - Both sides have fianchettoed and established restrained centers. White's extra move is useful, but the standard French-style kingside attack has no obvious hook.

A PRACTICAL PLAN

Improve pieces and decide between c3-d4, c4 or a restrained queenside expansion. Compare the bishops' diagonals before exchanging central pawns.

THE OPPONENT GETS A VOTE

An unnecessary e5 can be captured or leave d5 weak. Black can challenge the center with ...c5 just as White can with c4.

RECOGNITION TEST

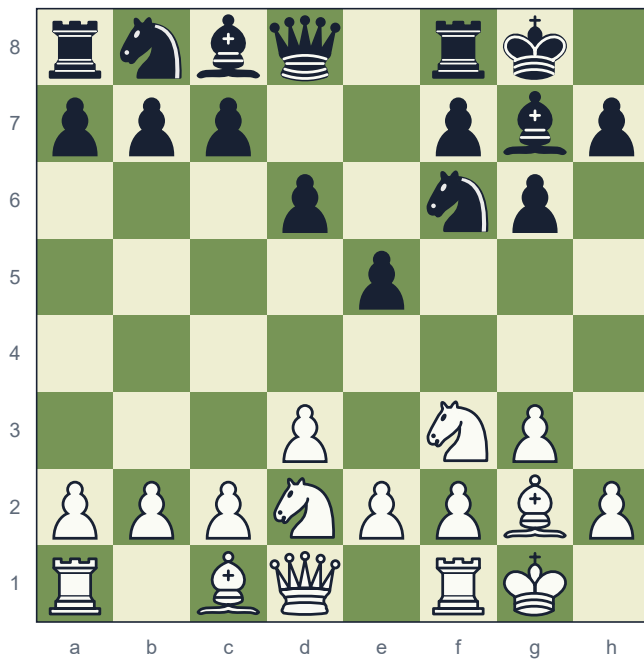
For each alternative, name the move that changes the plan. If you cannot identify that decision, return to the board rather than memorizing the last three moves.

KIA-13 / Symmetrical fianchetto

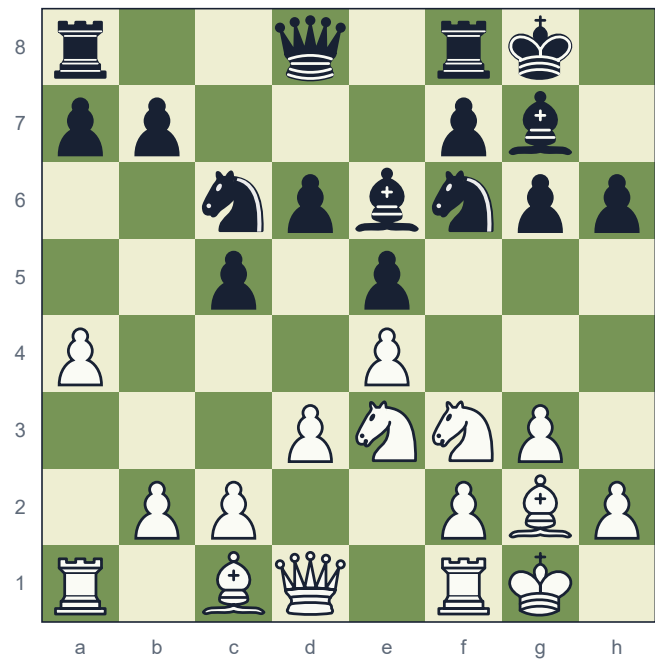
COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 Nf6 2. g3 g6 3. Bg2 Bg7 4. O-O O-O 5. d3 d6 6. Nbd2 e5 7. e4 c5 8. a4 Nc6 9. Nc4 h6 10. Ne3 Be6

Authored anchor ends after 7. e4. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

Both sides have fianchettoed and established restrained centers. White's extra move is useful, but the standard French-style kingside attack has no obvious hook.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Improve pieces and decide between c3-d4, c4 or a restrained queenside expansion. Compare the bishops' diagonals before exchanging central pawns.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

An unnecessary e5 can be captured or leave d5 weak. Black can challenge the center with ...c5 just as White can with c4.

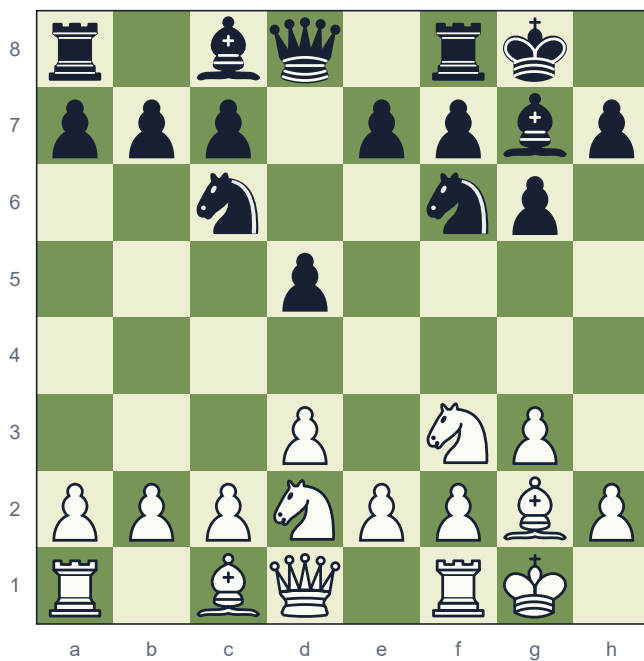
REMEMBER Symmetry calls for useful improvements, not an automatic pawn storm.

KIA-14 / Black chooses ...d5 in the fianchetto

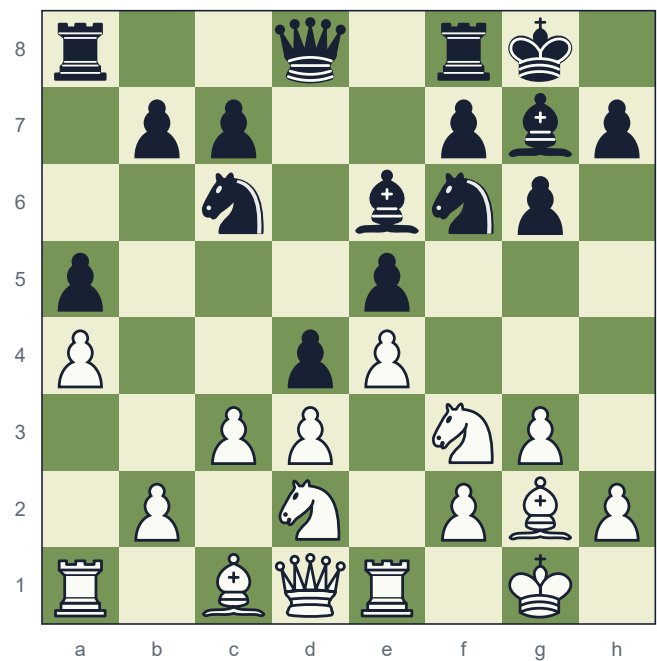
COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 Nf6 2. g3 g6 3. Bg2 Bg7 4. O-O O-O 5. d3 d5 6. Nbd2 Nc6 7. e4 e5 8. a4 a5 9. c3 Be6 10. Re1 d4

Authored anchor ends after 7... e5. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

Black claims a broad center. White may need a central exchange or a lever rather than another slow redeployment.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Consider exd5 and Re1, checking the recapture and pressure against e5. Look for c4 or c3-d4 only after comparing the resulting weak squares.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

Black can advance ...d4 and squeeze the knights. Passivity is a practical risk even without a direct tactical threat.

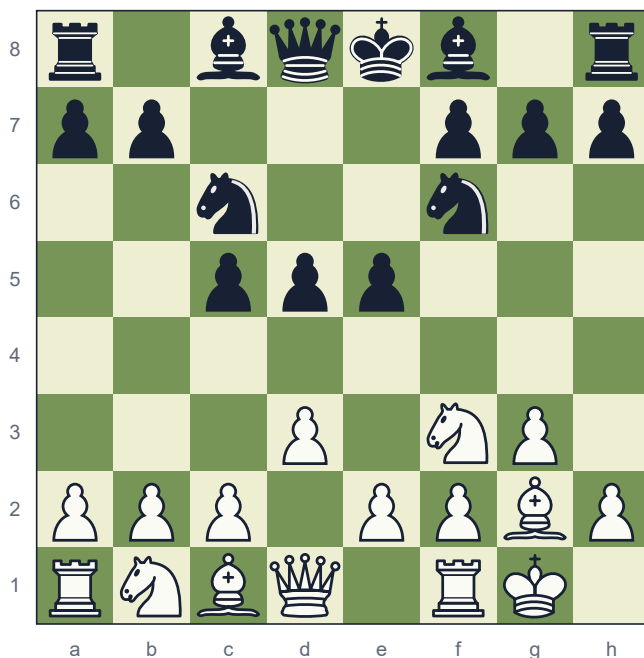
REMEMBER When the opponent occupies the center, plan the challenge.

KIA-15 / Reversed King's Indian structure

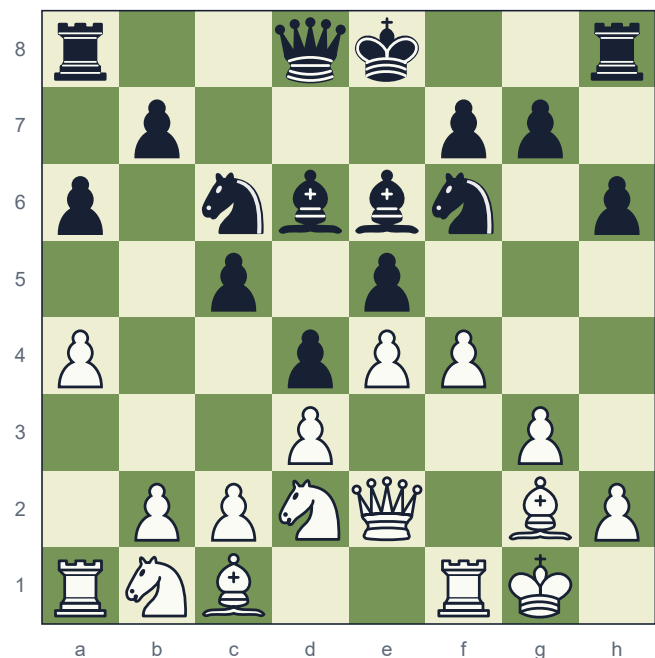
COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 c5 3. Bg2 Nc6 4. O-O e5 5. d3 Nf6 6. e4 d4 7. a4 Bd6 8. Nfd2 a6 9. f4 h6 10. Qe2 Be6

Authored anchor ends after 6... d4. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

Black closes the center with a space advantage. White has a reversed King's Indian type of position, but the move order and extra tempo require independent calculation.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Prepare a kingside lever with appropriate knight moves or use c3 to question d4. Choose a side based on the fixed pawn chain and king locations.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

Black can expand with ...b5 and ...c4. A slow maneuver must be measured against the opponent's actual pawn-break timing.

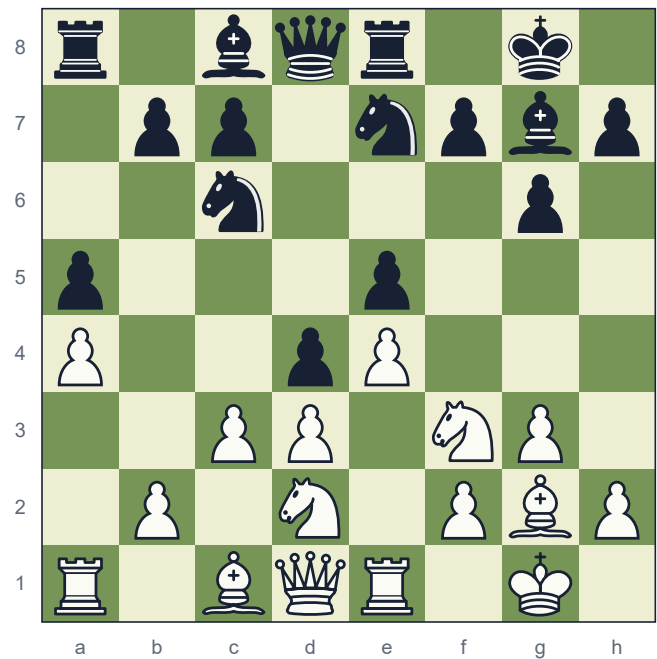
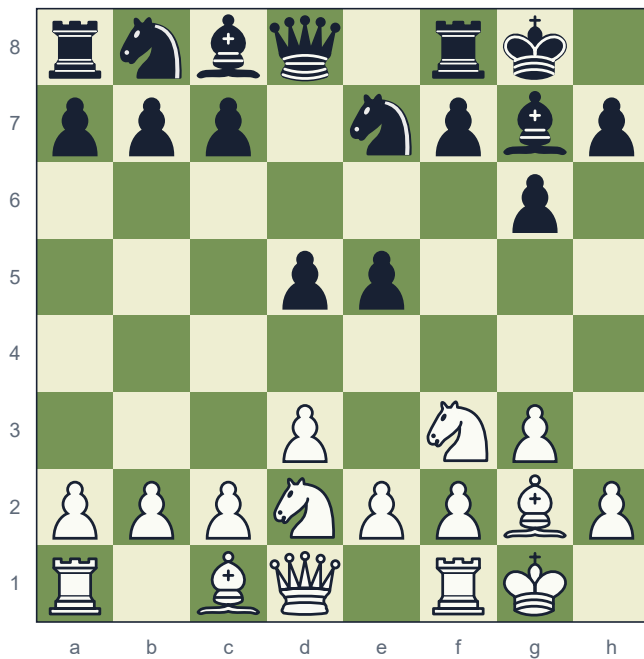
REMEMBER Reversed colors do not reverse every plan mechanically.

KIA-16 / The Pachman setup

COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 g6 3. Bg2 Bg7 4. O-O e5 5. d3 Ne7 6. Nbd2 O-O 7. e4 a5 8. a4 Re8 9. c3 Nbc6 10. Re1 d4

Authored anchor ends after 7. e4. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



WHY THIS BRANCH

Black develops the king knight to e7 and holds d5-e5. The absence of a knight on f6 changes both e5 ideas and possible kingside exchanges.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Use a central lever and complete development. Consider exd5 when the resulting open file can be used by a rook rather than merely exchanging for its own sake.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

Black may play ...Nbc6 or ...c5, gaining more space. Do not waste a tempo preparing to displace a knight that is not on f6.

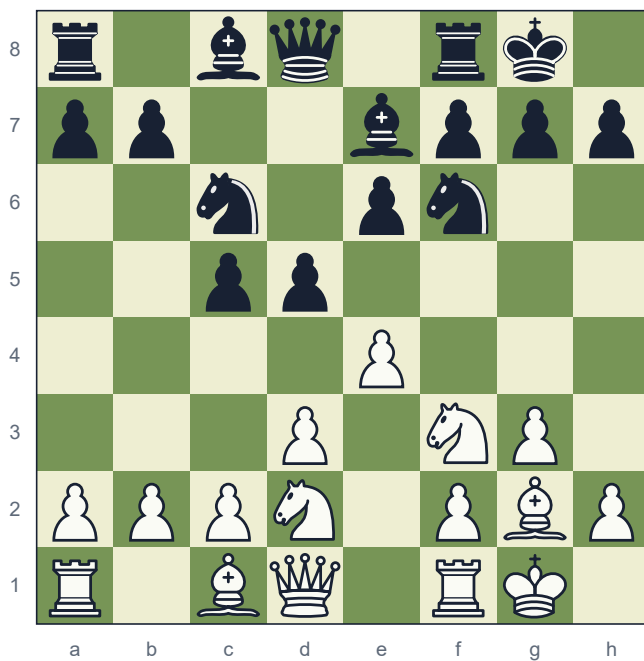
REMEMBER Count the real pieces around the intended pawn advance.

KIA-17 / Sicilian with ...e6

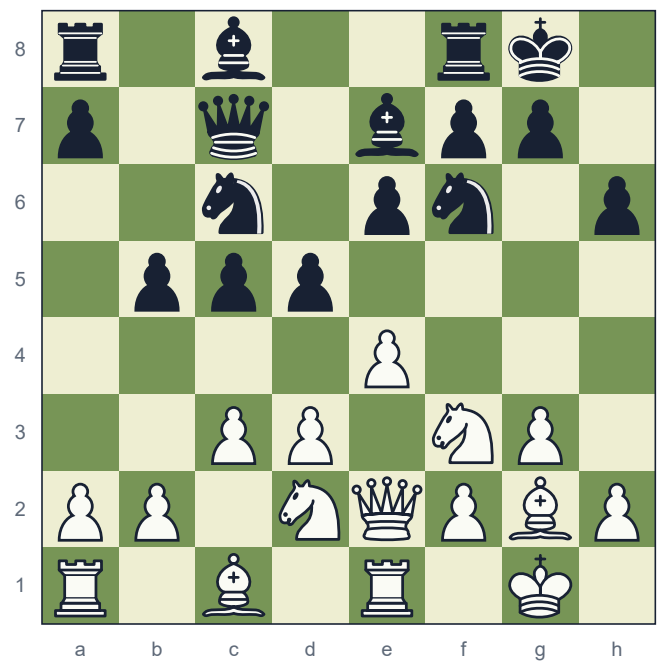
COURSE STUDY LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d3 d5 4. Nbd2 Nc6 5. g3 Nf6 6. Bg2 Be7 7. O-O O-O 8. Re1 Qc7 9. c3 h6 10. Qe2 b5

Authored anchor ends after 8. Re1. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

This 1.e4 route can reach the French-type center when Black chooses ...d5 and ...e6. White keeps familiar plans without opening the Sicilian with an immediate d4.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Support e4 and assess e5. If Black exchanges on e4, switch to open-file play instead of retaining the closed-center attacking script.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

Black may delay ...d5, fianchetto or expand on the queenside. The same first three moves do not guarantee the same middlegame.

REMEMBER The Sicilian entry is useful when the center matches.

KIA-18 / Sicilian with ...d6

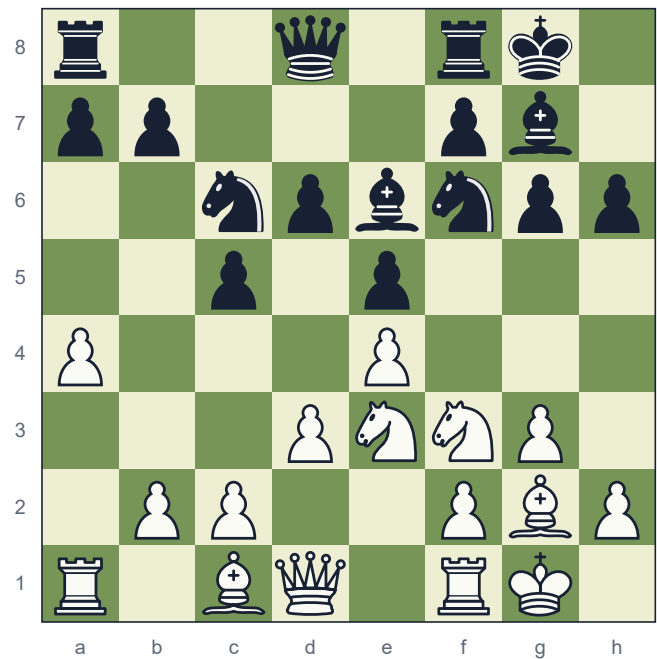
COURSE STUDY LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d3 Nf6 4. g3 Nc6 5. Bg2 g6 6. O-O Bg7 7. Nbd2 O-O 8. a4 e5 9. Nc4 h6 10. Ne3 Be6

Authored anchor ends after 7... O-O. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

Black fianchettoes and does not offer the French-type e6-d5 target. White's setup is playable but the main task is a central or queenside decision.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Prepare c3 and d4 if favorable, or c4 for a different space structure. Develop the queen bishop before starting a slow knight tour.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

Black can play ...Rb8 and ...b5, or ...d5 when ready. Waiting only for an e5 attack can concede the initiative.

REMEMBER KIA piece placement does not guarantee a KIA attack.

Work through KIA-13

7. E4

Changes central space and pawn contacts. Calculate captures, advances and maintaining tension before choosing the next piece plan.

8. A4

Places the pawn on a4. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

9. NC4

Places the knight on c4. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

10. NE3

Places the knight on e3. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

EXPLAIN THE POSITION

Both sides have fianchettoed and established restrained centers. White's extra move is useful, but the standard French-style kingside attack has no obvious hook. Improve pieces and decide between c3-d4, c4 or a restrained queenside expansion. Compare the bishops' diagonals before exchanging central pawns.

PRACTICE TASK

Replay this branch without looking. Stop at the first move you cannot explain. Then play the endpoint for ten moves against a partner or engine, switching sides for a second game. Judge your decisions, not just the result.

First-move choices and useful adaptations

HOW TO STUDY THIS FAMILY

First reconstruct the main branch from the initial position. Explain the central structure, each side's king safety and the most urgent threat. Then compare the alternatives one at a time.

MAIN BRANCH

KIA-19 - Starting with Nf3 allows Black a Sicilian-like or English-like structure. White can establish e4 after seeing Black's fianchetto.

A PRACTICAL PLAN

Finish development with Nbd2 or Nc3 according to the desired pawn break. Decide whether c3-d4 or c4 gives the pieces the best squares.

THE OPPONENT GETS A VOTE

Nc3 blocks the c-pawn temporarily, while Nbd2 can crowd the queen bishop. Each knight square carries a structural commitment.

RECOGNITION TEST

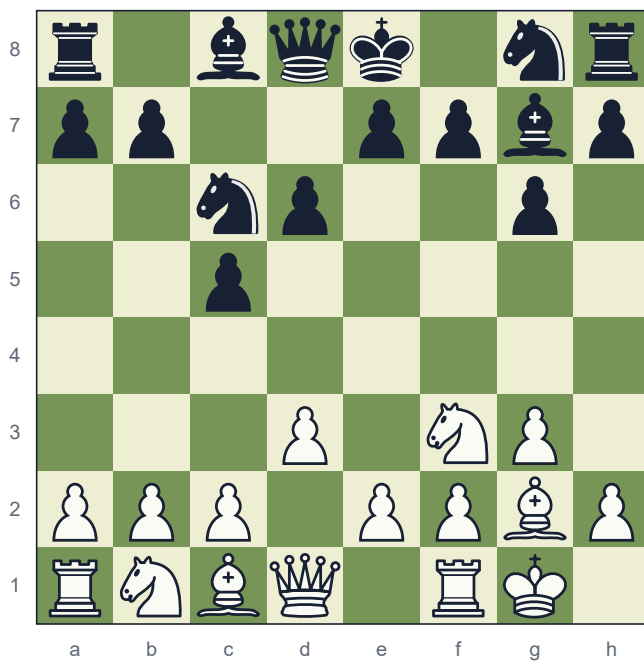
For each alternative, name the move that changes the plan. If you cannot identify that decision, return to the board rather than memorizing the last three moves.

KIA-19 / Black plays ...c5 on move one

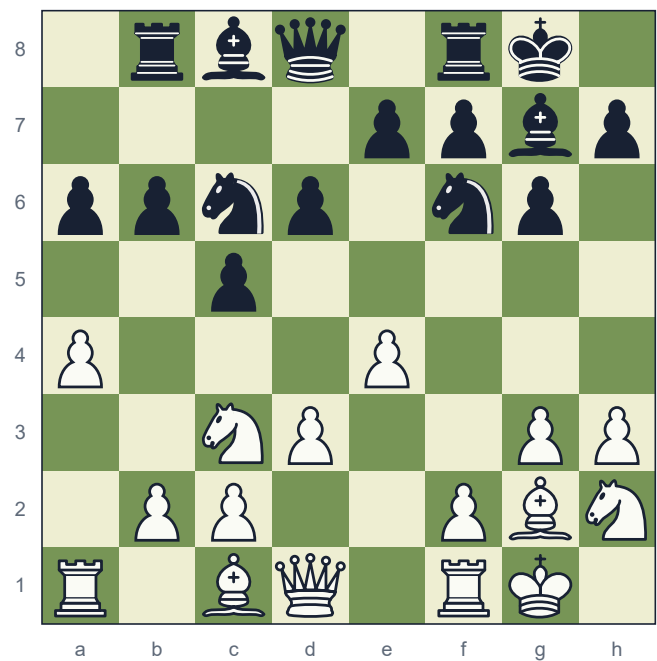
COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 c5 2. g3 Nc6 3. Bg2 g6 4. O-O Bg7 5. d3 d6 6. e4 Nf6 7. a4 O-O 8. Nc3 Rb8 9. h3 b6 10. Nh2 a6

Authored anchor ends after 6. e4. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

Starting with Nf3 allows Black a Sicilian-like or English-like structure. White can establish e4 after seeing Black's fianchetto.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Finish development with Nbd2 or Nc3 according to the desired pawn break. Decide whether c3-d4 or c4 gives the pieces the best squares.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

Nc3 blocks the c-pawn temporarily, while Nbd2 can crowd the queen bishop. Each knight square carries a structural commitment.

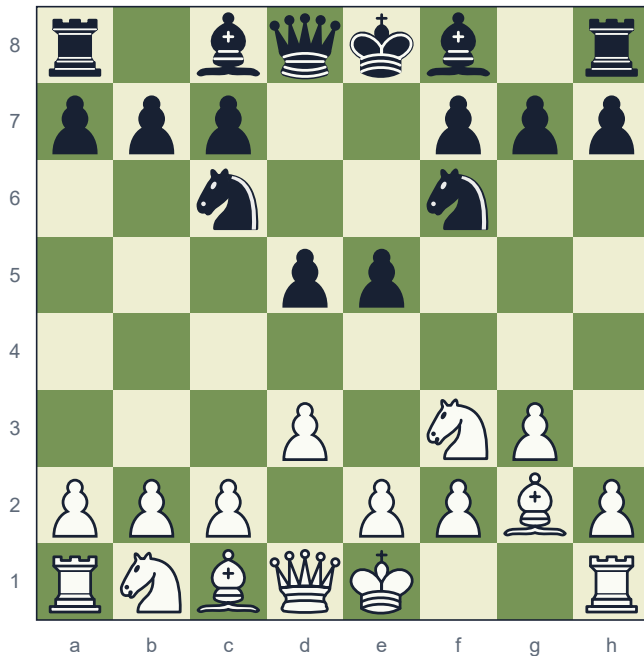
REMEMBER Pick the knight square to support a plan.

KIA-20 / Black occupies e5 immediately

COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 Nc6 2. g3 e5 3. d3 d5 4. Bg2 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. c4 O-O 7. cxd5 Nxd5 8. Nc3 Be6 9. d4 exd4 10. Nxd4 Nxd4

Authored anchor ends after 5... Be7. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



WHY THIS BRANCH

Black has gained a large center. White completes development while preparing a challenge; there is no obligation to finish every standard KIA move first.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Use c4 or e4 only after calculating exchanges. Develop the queen knight to a square that supports the chosen lever.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

Black can push ...e4 to attack Nf3 if the pawn is supported. Watch that immediate threat before choosing a quiet move.

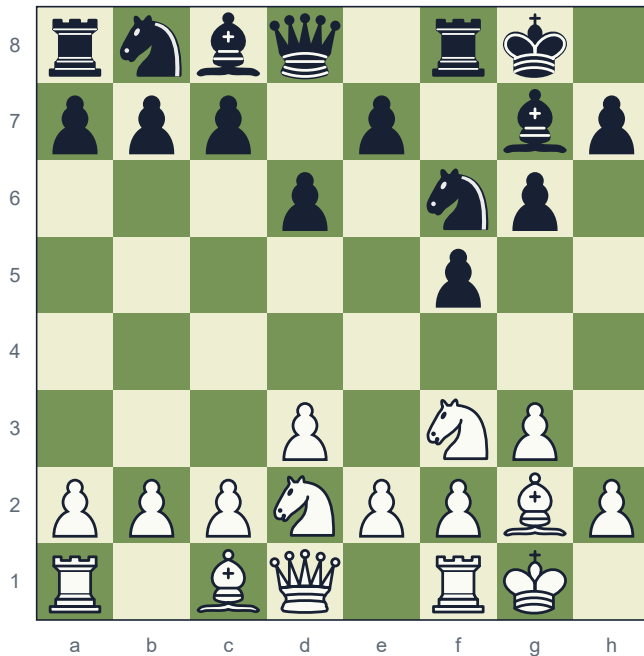
REMEMBER A pawn attack on a piece overrides a setup plan.

KIA-21 / Dutch-style ...f5

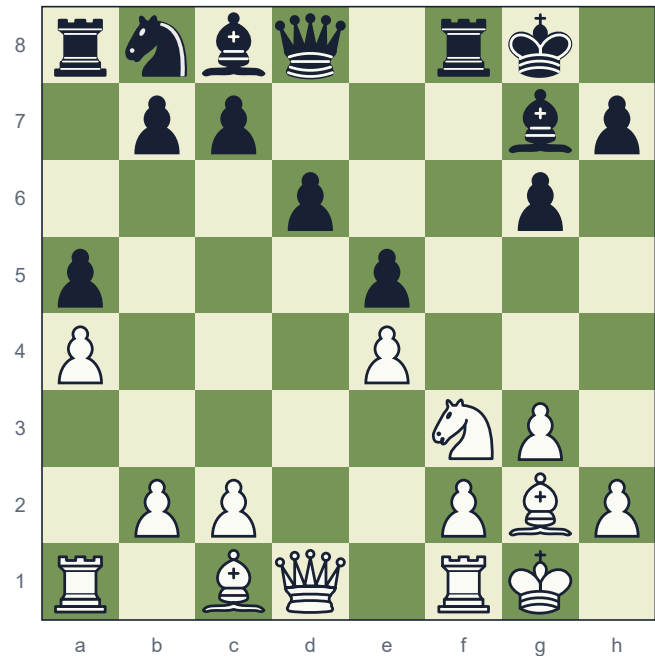
COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 f5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 g6 4. O-O Bg7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 d6 7. e4 fxe4 8. Nxe4 Nxe4 9. dxe4 e5 10. a4 a5

Authored anchor ends after 7. e4. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

White challenges Black's kingside space through e4. Black's f-pawn move creates a different set of dark-square weaknesses and attacking chances.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Calculate ...fxe4 and dxe4, develop the queen bishop and watch the e-file. A later c3 can prepare a central expansion.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

Black may use ...e5 and ...Nc6 to support a broad center. The g7 bishop and f-file can become active after exchanges.

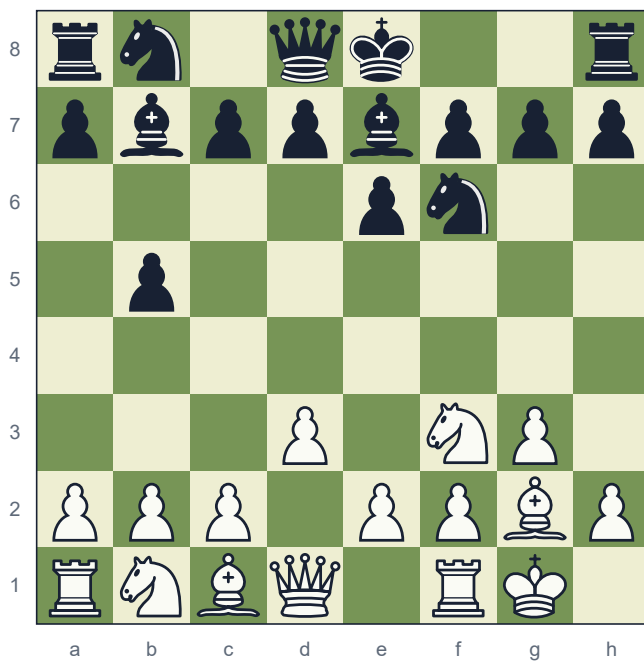
REMEMBER Meet wing space with a supported central challenge.

KIA-22 / The ...b5 flank expansion

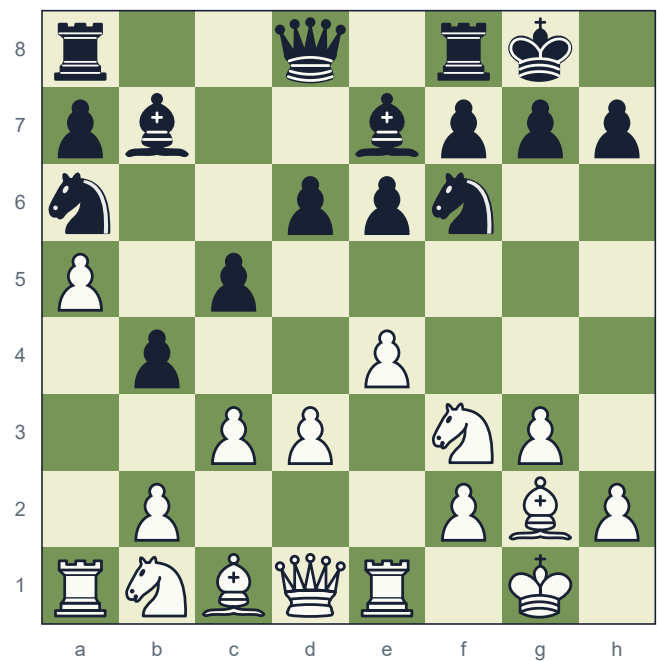
COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 Nf6 2. g3 b5 3. Bg2 Bb7 4. O-O e6 5. d3 Be7 6. e4 d6 7. a4 b4 8. a5 c5 9. c3 O-O 10. Re1 Na6

Authored anchor ends after 6. e4. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

Black gains queenside space and develops the bishop to b7. White uses the time to establish e4 but must notice the long diagonal toward the king side.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Develop Nbd2 and support the center. a4 may question b5 if it creates a useful weakness without costing a central tempo.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

Black can pressure e4 after ...d5 or ...c5. A flank pawn advance may be part of central control, not merely a waste of time.

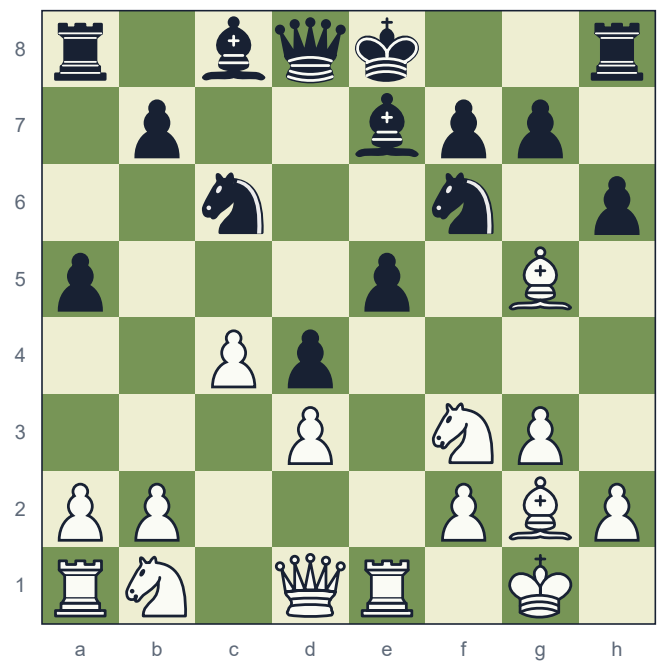
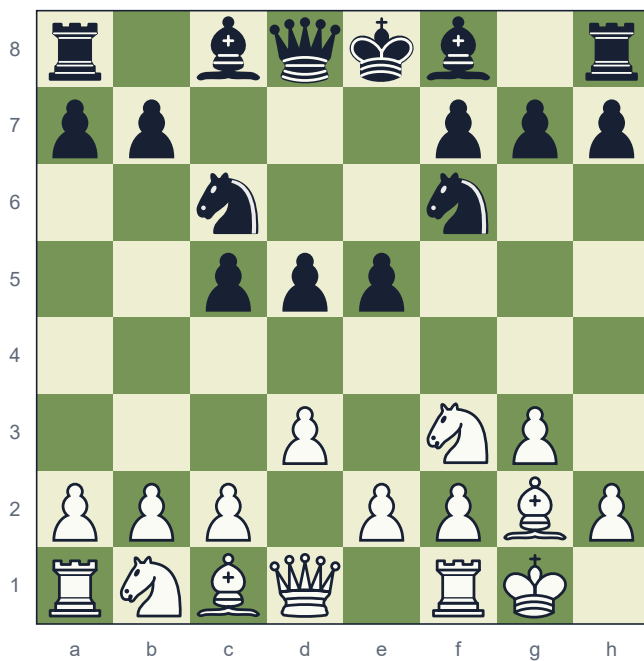
REMEMBER Ask what the flank bishop attacks.

KIA-23 / Early ...d4 before the setup

COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 c5 3. Bg2 Nc6 4. O-O e5 5. d3 Nf6 6. c4 d4 7. e3 Be7 8. exd4 cxd4 9. Bg5 a5 10. Re1 h6

Authored anchor ends after 6... d4. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



WHY THIS BRANCH

White chooses c4 before e4 to challenge the broad center. Once Black closes with ...d4, the result belongs to a different structure from the main KIA attack.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Decide between e3 to undermine d4 and queenside development. Keep the g2 bishop's diagonal in mind when opening the center.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

Black's d4 pawn restricts Nc3. Putting a piece on a square controlled by that pawn is a concrete error, regardless of a familiar development pattern.

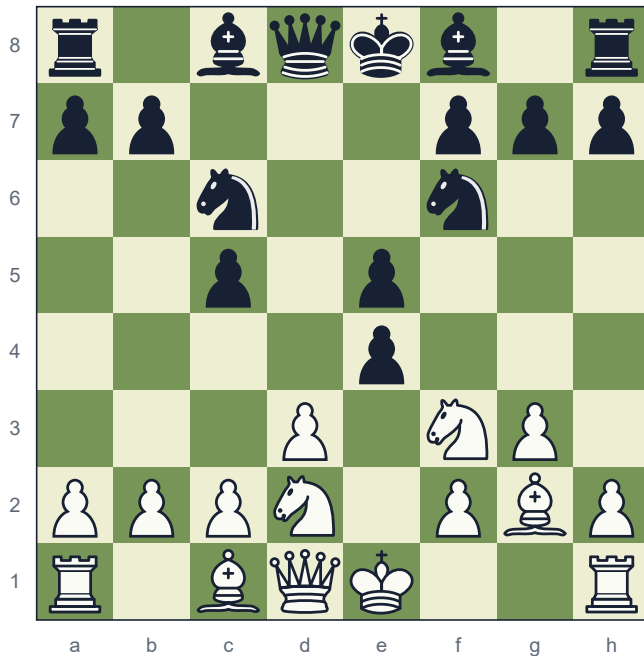
REMEMBER Adapt the pawn structure before copying the piece setup.

KIA-24 / Early central exchange before castling

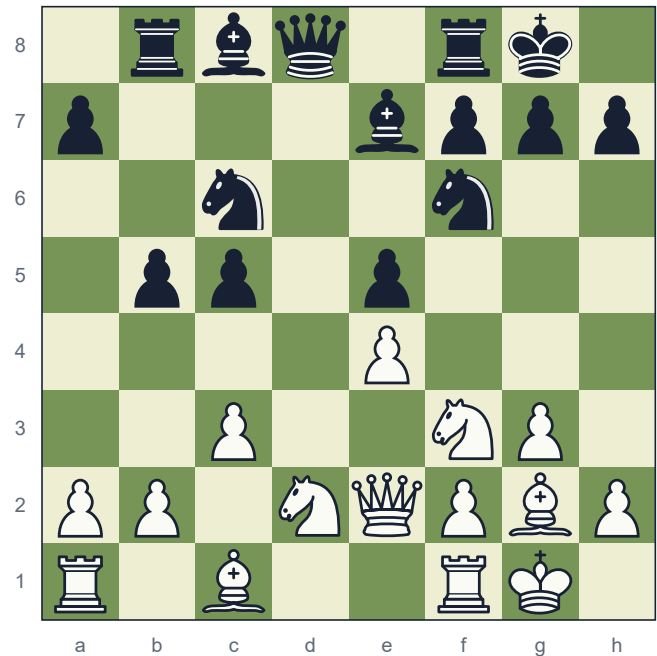
COURSE STUDY LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 c5 4. d3 Nc6 5. Nbd2 e5 6. e4 dxe4 7. dxe4 Be7 8. c3 b5 9. Qe2 Rb8 10. O-O O-O

Authored anchor ends after 7. dxe4. Later moves are one engine-assisted illustration.



Before your decision - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THIS BRANCH

White delays castling while constructing the center. The exchange on e4 opens the d-file and makes queen exchanges a practical possibility.

PLAN FROM THIS BRANCH

Compare castling with a useful queen move, then develop the queen bishop. Open-file control may matter more than preserving queens for an attack.

OPPONENT RESOURCE

Black can exchange queens if the file opens completely. Evaluate the king's destination in the resulting endgame rather than fearing a lost castling right automatically.

REMEMBER Queen exchange can change what king safety means.

Work through KIA-19

7. A4

Places the pawn on a4. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

8. NC3

Develops toward d5 and e4. Compare its central influence with the fact that it blocks the c-pawn.

9. H3

Controls nearby wing squares and may restrain a piece or pawn. Compare this useful purpose with the time lost to central development.

10. NH2

Places the knight on h2. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

EXPLAIN THE POSITION

Starting with Nf3 allows Black a Sicilian-like or English-like structure. White can establish e4 after seeing Black's fianchetto. Finish development with Nbd2 or Nc3 according to the desired pawn break. Decide whether c3-d4 or c4 gives the pieces the best squares.

PRACTICE TASK

Replay this branch without looking. Stop at the first move you cannot explain. Then play the endpoint for ten moves against a partner or engine, switching sides for a second game. Judge your decisions, not just the result.

Build e4 before dreaming of e5



KIA-01 anchor - Black to move

THE IDEA

The center pawn is the platform for the attack. Nbd2, Re1 and d3 often support it, but a pin, exchange or different black pawn structure can change the count.

HOW TO DECIDE

Count attackers and legal defenders of e4 after Black's best capture. Only then assess e5 and the knight it would attack. A pawn advance that loses material is not rescued by a familiar plan.

THE OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

...dxe4 opens the d-file; ...d4 creates a wedge; ...f6 may undermine an advanced e5. Each demands a different response.

BOARD DRILL

Take three branch positions and list what changes after e5. Include the affected knight, opened diagonal and new pawn weakness.

The e5 wedge and piece routes



KIA-02 anchor - White to move

THE IDEA

An e5 pawn can drive Nf6 away and give White space near the king. It also blocks the g2 bishop and becomes a target for ...f6.

HOW TO DECIDE

Prepare useful knight routes, often Nf1-e3 or h2-g4, only when the destination is safe. Bring queen and bishop into play without abandoning d3 and e5.

THE OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

Black can counter on the queenside with ...b5 or in the center with ...f6. A beautiful maneuver that arrives too late is ineffective.

BOARD DRILL

Play a closed-center endpoint and require yourself to state Black's next pawn break before every white move.

h4-h5 needs a target



KIA-05 anchor - White to move

THE IDEA

A kingside pawn advance can open lines or gain space when Black has castled short and the center is stable. It is much less persuasive when the king is still central or on the other wing.

HOW TO DECIDE

Identify the pawn contact you intend to create, the piece that will use the opened file and the central reply Black can choose. Count the moves required to reach the target.

THE OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

Black may castle long, exchange on e4 or open with ...f6. Your h-pawn does not defend the center.

BOARD DRILL

At a laboratory checkpoint, compare h4 with a central or developing move. Give a reason connected to the king location.

When c4 is the right adaptation



KIA-08 anchor - Black to move

THE IDEA

c4 directly questions d5 and often makes sense against an active light-squared bishop or a stable central structure. It may lead to Reti-type play rather than a kingside attack.

HOW TO DECIDE

Calculate ...dxc4 and ...d4 separately. Decide which pawn recaptures and where the queen knight belongs afterward. Keep the g2 bishop's diagonal in view.

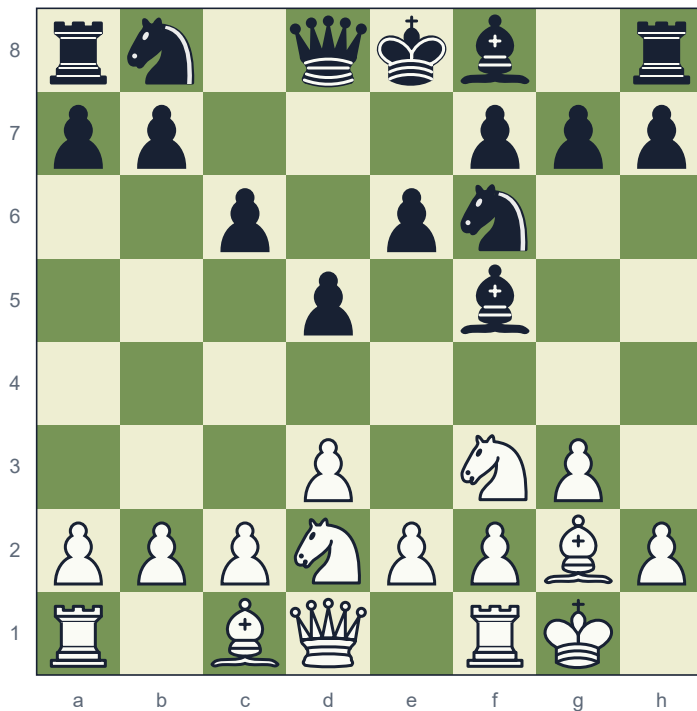
THE OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

Black can close with ...d4 and restrict Nc3. The central challenge must have a follow-up.

BOARD DRILL

Compare one c4 line with one e4 line and explain which pawn file opens in each.

Active bishops change the plan



KIA-07 anchor - Black to move

THE IDEA

A bishop developed to f5 or g4 before ...e6 is not the restricted French bishop. White may benefit from a central challenge or a useful bishop exchange.

HOW TO DECIDE

If considering Nh4, calculate the bishop retreat and whether h-file exchanges help Black. Compare the value of the bishop pair with the time spent moving the knight twice.

THE OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

After Nxg6 hxg6, Black may use the h-file. Doubled pawns do not automatically mean a weak king.

BOARD DRILL

Reconstruct the Nh4 branch and name one benefit for each side after the exchange.

Symmetric fianchettoes



KIA-13 anchor - Black to move

THE IDEA

With both sides fianchettoed, there may be no ready-made kingside target. Central space, bishop activity and the timing of a pawn break become the main contest.

HOW TO DECIDE

Choose between c3-d4, c4 and e4 based on the current center. Improve the least active piece before manufacturing a wing attack.

THE OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

Black can mirror central pressure or seize space with ...d4. White's extra move is useful but does not guarantee an advantage.

BOARD DRILL

Play the same endpoint once with a c-pawn plan and once with a central d-pawn plan. Compare piece squares.

Open-center transitions



KIA-03 anchor - Black to move

THE IDEA

After ...dxe4 dxe4, the d-file opens and the familiar blocked-center attack may disappear. The bishops and rooks acquire new jobs.

HOW TO DECIDE

Contest the open file, identify an entry square and decide whether exchanging queens helps. A knight on c4 can be useful if it attacks real targets.

THE OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

Black can pressure e4 and challenge the file. A slow knight tour may concede open-file control.

BOARD DRILL

List the blocked and open lines before and after the central exchange, without using an engine.

Choosing 1.Nf3 or 1.e4



KIA-06 anchor - Black to move

THE IDEA

The main course starts with Nf3 for flexibility. The French and some ...e6 Sicilian routes work well from e4, but Black can choose a different central structure.

HOW TO DECIDE

Match positions by piece locations, pawn structure and side to move. Keep entry routes separate until they truly transpose. Use the branch map when Black occupies e5 or develops an active bishop.

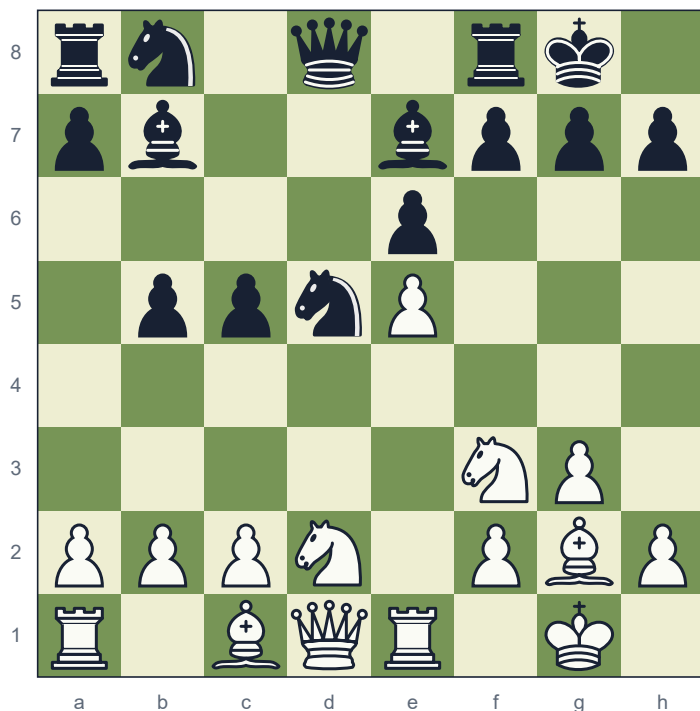
THE OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

A Caro-Kann ...e5 center or a Sicilian fianchetto may offer no French-style e5 attack. Adapt instead of forcing the pattern.

BOARD DRILL

Write two legal routes to the same French-type position, then change one black move and explain why the transposition breaks.

Loose pieces and forks



KIA-03 audit position - White to move

AUDIT THIS REAL POSITION

Find two pieces that would be vulnerable if their defender moved. Calculate one legal forcing move that tests the relation. This is an analysis exercise; it does not assert that a winning tactic exists in the diagram.

CONNECT IT TO THIS OPENING

An automatic e5 attack plan may no longer fit. Black can use ...Nc6 and ...Qc7 to put pressure on e4.

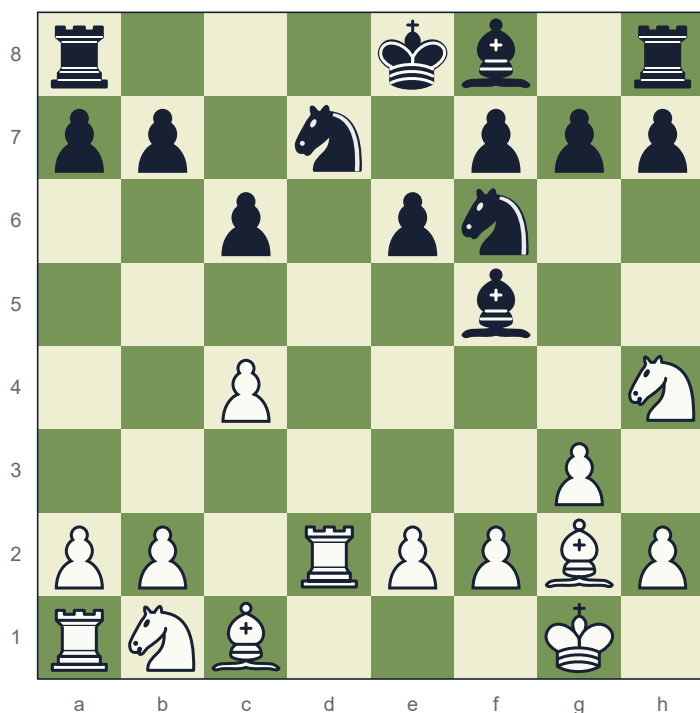
A USEFUL ANSWER

Give a short legal variation and an explanation of the resulting material and king safety. If there is no forcing gain, say so and choose a developing or improving move. Finding no combination can be the correct conclusion.

CALCULATION SKILL

Before calculating an attack, list undefended pieces. A knight fork attacks two targets that cannot both move away. A queen check may combine king pressure with a second target. If you remove a defender, inspect every piece it protected.

Pins and discovered attacks



KIA-08 audit position - White to move

CALCULATION SKILL

An absolute pin prevents a piece from moving if doing so exposes its king. A relative pin involves a valuable piece behind it, usually the queen. A discovered attack appears when a blocking piece moves away. Always trace the entire line, including the piece behind the blocker.

AUDIT THIS REAL POSITION

Identify a line piece, its blocker and the target behind it. If no pin exists, explain which required element is missing. This is an analysis exercise; it does not assert that a winning tactic exists in the diagram.

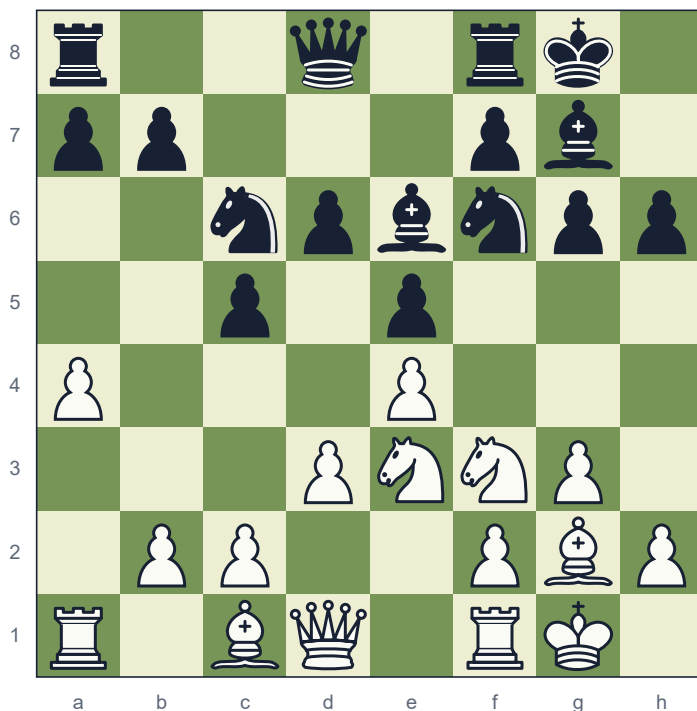
CONNECT IT TO THIS OPENING

Black can exchange queens or use ...Nbd7 and ...Be7 to complete development. The position is now closer to a Reti structure than an e5 attack.

A USEFUL ANSWER

Give a short legal variation and an explanation of the resulting material and king safety. If there is no forcing gain, say so and choose a developing or improving move. Finding no combination can be the correct conclusion.

Intermediate moves and defensive resources



KIA-13 audit position - White to move

CALCULATION SKILL

A recapture is not compulsory unless it is the only legal response to check. Before recapturing, inspect checks, stronger captures and direct threats. When attacking, give the defender the same opportunity; do not assume automatic recaptures.

AUDIT THIS REAL POSITION

At a capture in your line, pause before the reply. List all legal checks, then compare them with the expected recapture. This is an analysis exercise; it does not assert that a winning tactic exists in the diagram.

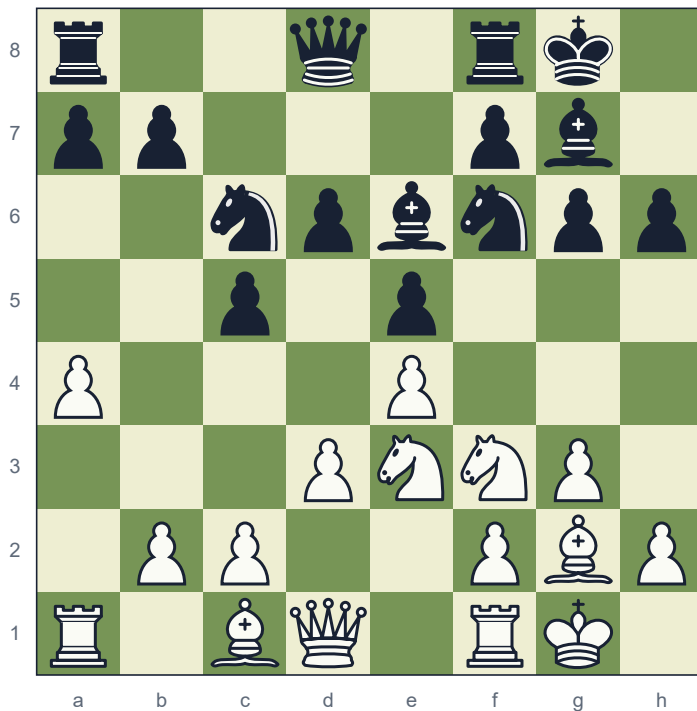
CONNECT IT TO THIS OPENING

An unnecessary e5 can be captured or leave d5 weak. Black can challenge the center with ...c5 just as White can with c4.

A USEFUL ANSWER

Give a short legal variation and an explanation of the resulting material and king safety. If there is no forcing gain, say so and choose a developing or improving move. Finding no combination can be the correct conclusion.

A sacrifice needs a stopping point



KIA-18 audit position - White to move

CALCULATION SKILL

Calculate a sacrifice until the defender has a stable reply you can evaluate. Count material after the whole sequence, not after the first capture. If the line ends only with a vague promise of attack, compare a non-sacrificial candidate.

AUDIT THIS REAL POSITION

Choose a tempting sacrifice from a laboratory or your own game. Write the best defensive reply and the position where you stop calculating. This is an analysis exercise; it does not assert that a winning tactic exists in the diagram.

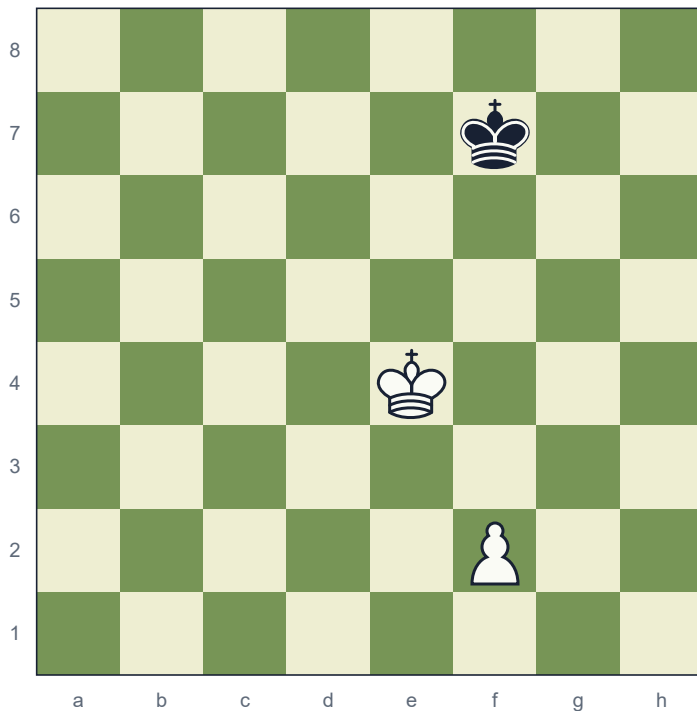
CONNECT IT TO THIS OPENING

Black can play ...Rb8 and ...b5, or ...d5 when ready. Waiting only for an e5 attack can concede the initiative.

A USEFUL ANSWER

Give a short legal variation and an explanation of the resulting material and king safety. If there is no forcing gain, say so and choose a developing or improving move. Finding no combination can be the correct conclusion.

Activate the king when queens are gone



READ THE BOARD

White to move: Kf5 is a legal active king move. Kf4 is also legal but less direct; compare plans rather than inventing a forcing win. The general lesson is to bring the king toward the pawn and useful squares while keeping the opposing king out.

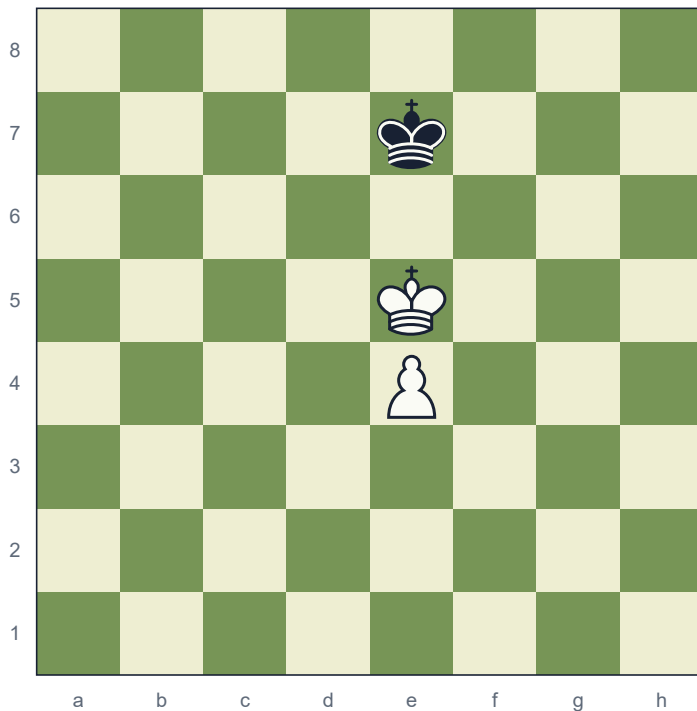
FROM YOUR OPENING TO THIS LESSON

In an opening-to-endgame transition, first inspect checks and pawn threats, then activate the king. Do not continue making shelter moves whose main purpose was defense against a queen. A rook ending may still require care about checks from behind.

PRACTICE

Reconstruct the diagram. Explain the legal moves and the role of each king before moving. Then return to a course endpoint and identify which feature of this simple lesson could matter after exchanges.

Opposition and the importance of the move



Teaching position - White to move

READ THE BOARD

The kings face each other on e5 and e7 with one square between. White to move must give way or move the pawn; the geometry changes if Black is to move. Opposition is a tool for gaining entry squares, not a rule that always wins.

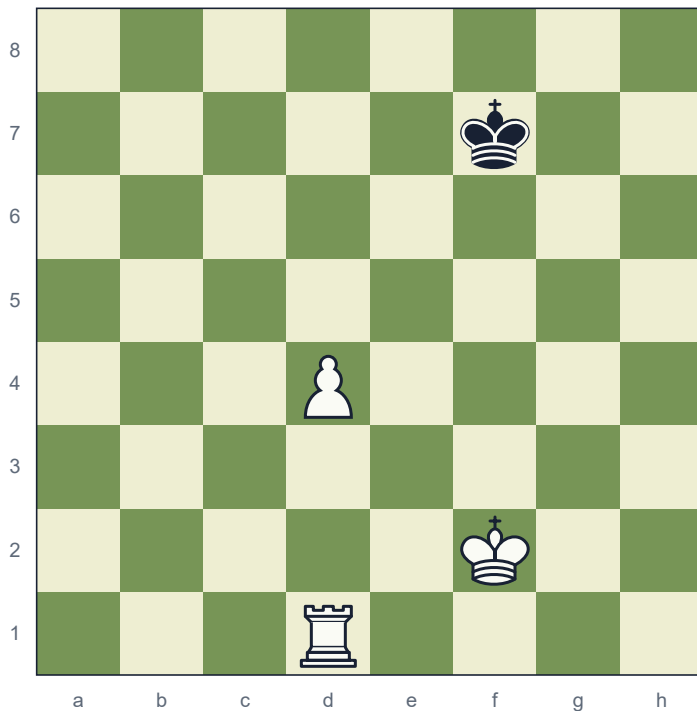
FROM YOUR OPENING TO THIS LESSON

Replay both side-to-move versions. Track the pawn's key squares and whether the attacking king can reach them. If you exchange into a pawn ending, calculate the actual king route and tempo rather than relying on the extra pawn alone.

PRACTICE

Reconstruct the diagram. Explain the legal moves and the role of each king before moving. Then return to a course endpoint and identify which feature of this simple lesson could matter after exchanges.

Rooks belong where they work



Teaching position - White to move

READ THE BOARD

The rook on d1 stands behind its own passed d-pawn. As the pawn advances, the rook can continue supporting it from behind. This is a teaching position, not a claim of a difficult theoretical win against a rook.

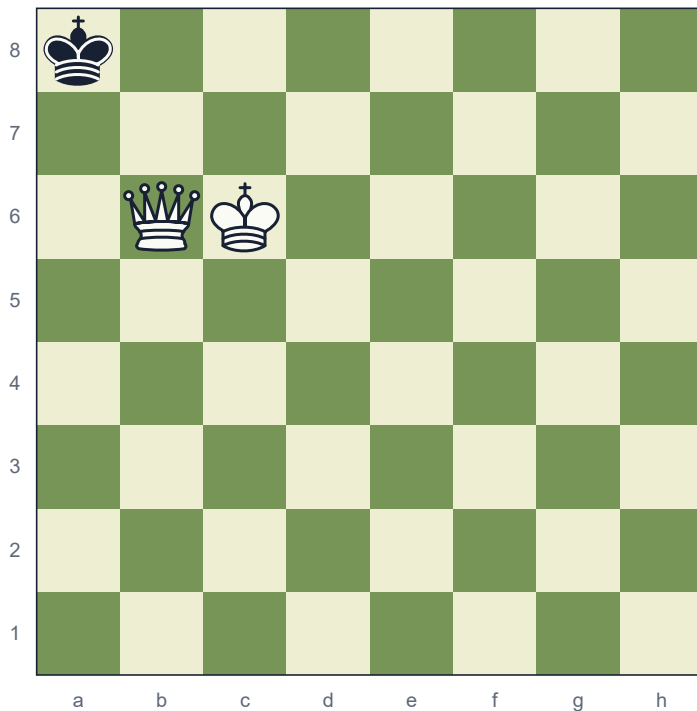
FROM YOUR OPENING TO THIS LESSON

In real rook endings compare activity, checking distance, king shelter and pawn races. Putting a rook behind a passed pawn is a useful default, but a tactical threat or a decisive lateral check can override it. Do not trade an active rook into a lost pawn ending.

PRACTICE

Reconstruct the diagram. Explain the legal moves and the role of each king before moving. Then return to a course endpoint and identify which feature of this simple lesson could matter after exchanges.

Recognize stalemate before promoting



Teaching position - Black to move

READ THE BOARD

Black to move is not in check and has no legal move: a7 and b8 are controlled by Qb6, while b7 is controlled by the queen and Kc6. This is stalemate, so the position is a draw despite White's extra queen.

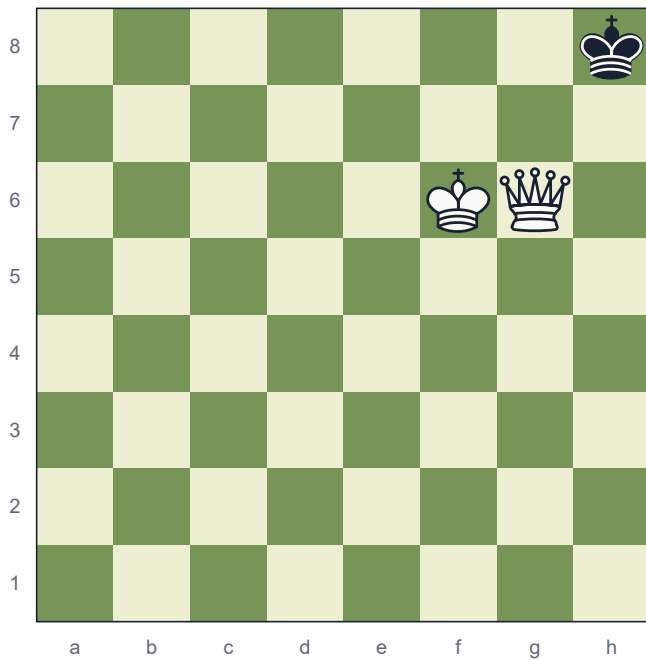
FROM YOUR OPENING TO THIS LESSON

Before delivering the final move of a won game, check whether the opponent has a legal reply if not in check. In queen-versus-king technique, restrict the king with the queen, approach with your king and preserve a legal waiting square until you can give mate.

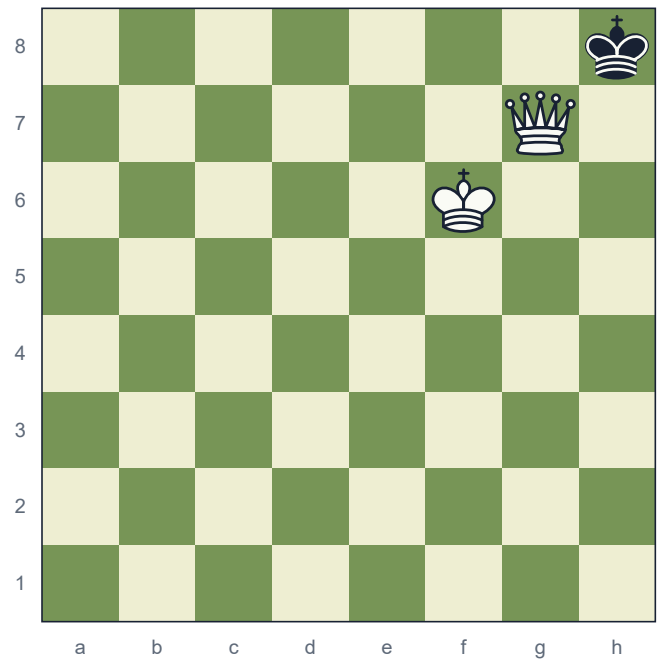
PRACTICE

Reconstruct the diagram. Explain the legal moves and the role of each king before moving. Then return to a course endpoint and identify which feature of this simple lesson could matter after exchanges.

Finish a won queen ending



White to move - find mate in one



After Qg7# - Black is checkmated

WHY THIS IS MATE

Qg7 gives check along the g7-h8 diagonal. The white king on f6 protects the queen, so ...Kxg7 is illegal. The queen controls g8 and h7, removing the remaining escape squares. This proof checks attacks and legal replies, not just the appearance of the diagram.

TECHNIQUE BEFORE THE FINAL MOVE

Use the queen to reduce the enemy king's space, bring your king close enough to support the mate, and keep a legal waiting square until you can give checkmate. A queen alone can accidentally stalemate; review the previous lesson before repeating this drill.

Choosing the right exchanges

DO NOT TRADE BY HABIT

When offered a trade, compare the activity of the pieces leaving the board, the resulting pawn weaknesses and the king positions. A player with less space may welcome exchanges, but trading the only active piece can make the position worse.

PAWN ENDING TEST

Before exchanging the last pieces, calculate king activity, passed-pawn races and the side to move. Opposition is one tool; it is not a substitute for counting legal tempi. A pawn ending is often less forgiving than a rook ending.

OPENING-SPECIFIC QUESTION

The main course starts with Nf3 for flexibility. The French and some ...e6 Sicilian routes work well from e4, but Black can choose a different central structure.

PRACTICAL CONVERSION

When ahead, neutralize counterplay and improve the least active piece before collecting another pawn. When defending, seek active checks, pawn breaks and useful exchanges rather than passive waiting.

A STUDY HABIT

After every practice game, keep one transition position. Record which exchange you chose, which alternative you considered and how the pawn structure changed.

How the six laboratories work

ORIGINAL ILLUSTRATIVE PLAY

These are original engine-assisted study continuations from this course's positions. They are not historical master games and no invented players or tournament results are assigned. The continuations reach roughly move twenty and stop for further practice.

THINK BEFORE REVEALING

At each checkpoint, name the opponent's threat, compare two candidates and calculate a forcing reply. Use a board to replay the sequence. The engine comparison supplies concrete evidence, while the opening explanation supplies a plan.

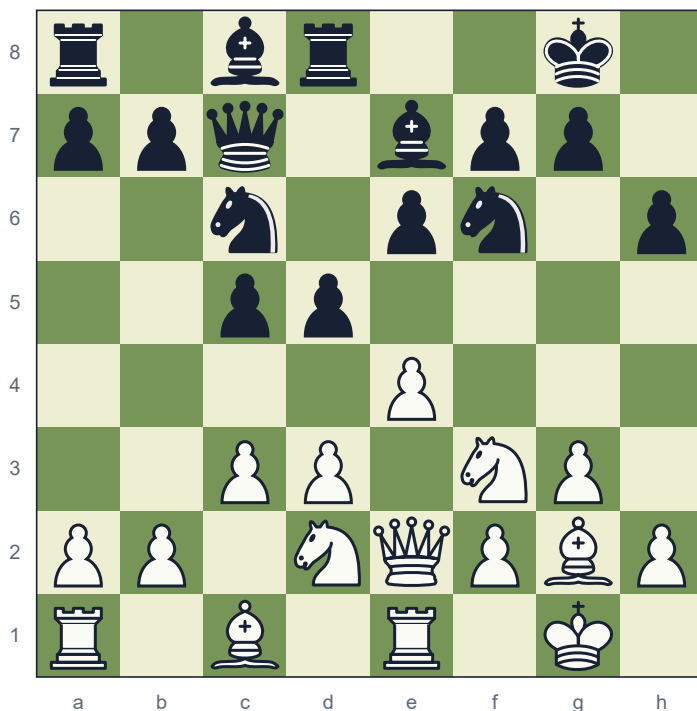
MORE THAN ONE GOOD MOVE

Close engine scores do not establish a unique answer. The finite search can prefer a different move when run longer. Accept another candidate if you can support it with a sound variation and a coherent explanation.

PRACTICE FROM BOTH SIDES

Play each starting position twice, switching colors. Record the first decision you could not explain and compare it with the branch lesson after the game.

KIA-LAB-01 / The core French-type position



Laboratory start - White to move

OPENING BACKGROUND

Re1 supports e4 and makes e5 more credible. Black has a broad d5-c5 center and may expand on the queenside while White builds a kingside initiative.

READ THE CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, c3, d3, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, d5, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

OPENING CONCERN TO RECHECK

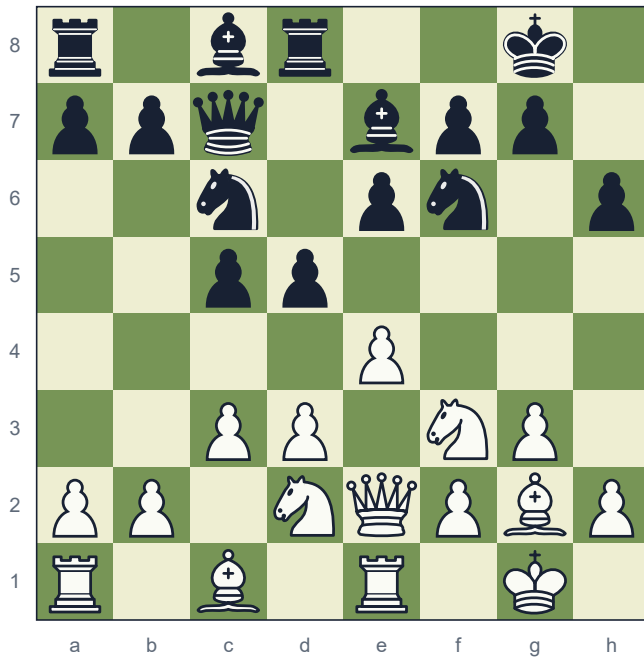
Black can play ...Qc7, ...b5 or ...dxe4. A kingside attack is premature if e4 can simply be captured. Decide which parts still apply after the moves already played.

BEFORE PLAYING

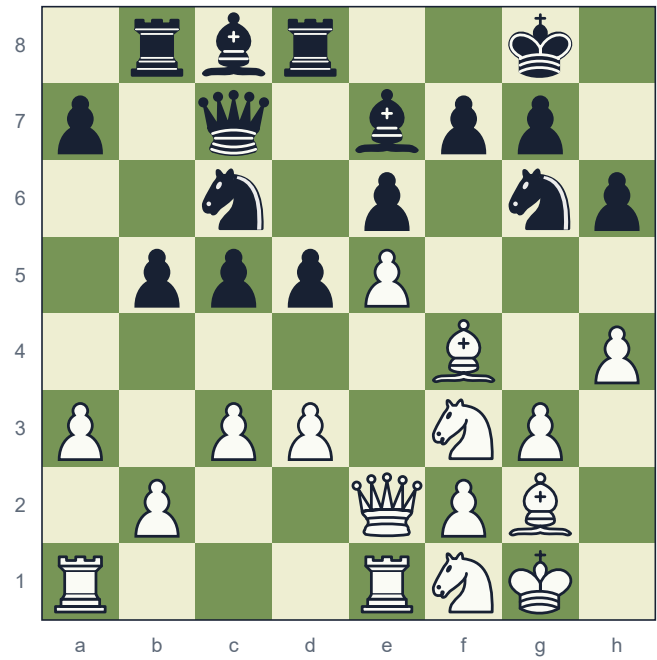
Write a candidate move and a reply for the opponent. Name the pawn break each side would like to achieve. The continuation on the following pages is one checked illustration, not a forced script.

KIA-LAB-01 / play and explain 1

11. a3 Rb8 12. e5 Nd7 13. Nf1 b5 14. Bf4 Nf8 15. h4 Ng6



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

11. A3

Controls nearby wing squares and may restrain a piece or pawn. Compare this useful purpose with the time lost to central development.

13. NF1

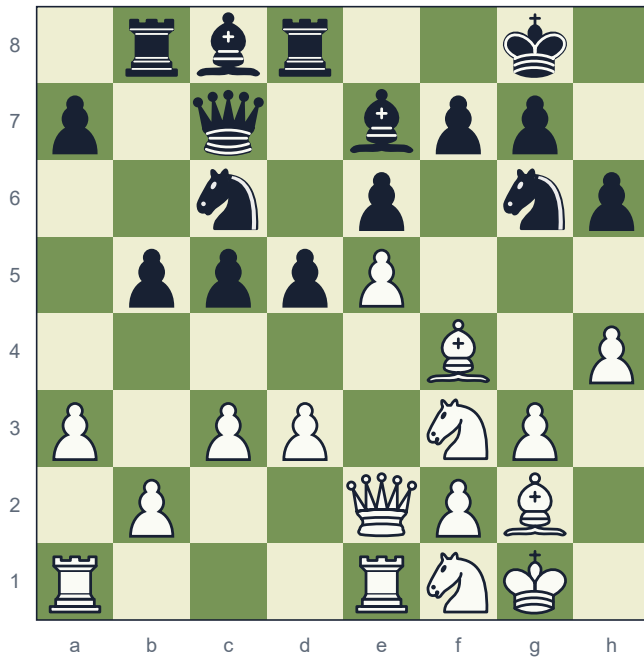
Places the knight on f1. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

REASSESS

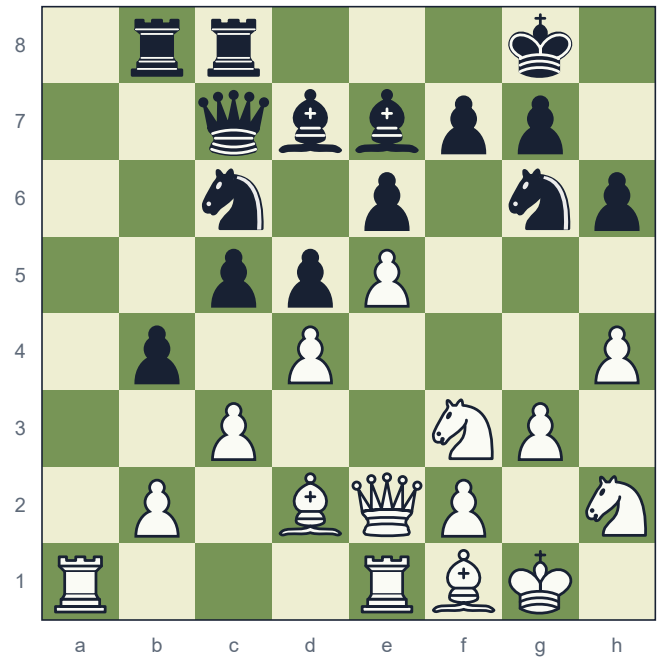
Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-01 / play and explain 2

16. Bd2 a5 17. N1h2 b4 18. axb4 axb4 19. d4 Bd7 20. Bf1 Rdc8



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

16. BD2

Places the bishop on d2. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

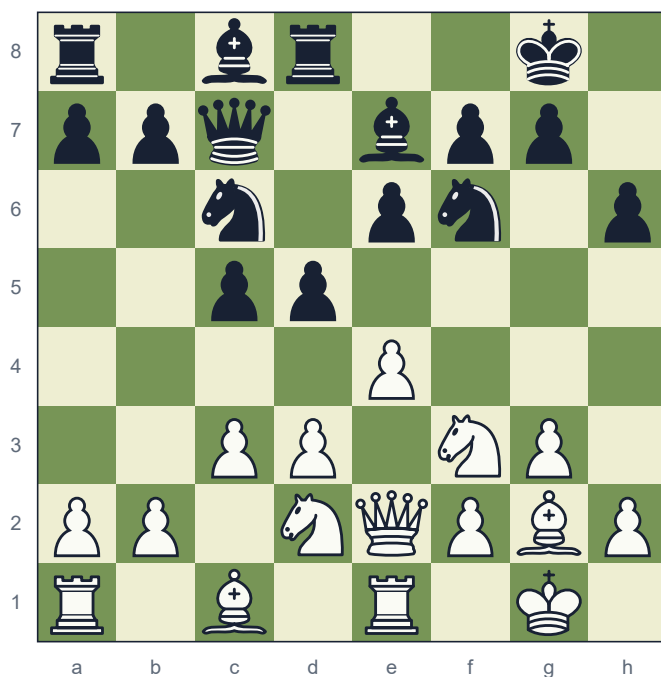
18. AXB4

The pawn captures a pawn on b4. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

REASSESS

Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-01 / decision 1



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

a3 and a4. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, c3, d3, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, d5, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE A3

11. a3 Rb8 12. d4 cxd4 13. Nxd4 Nxd4 14. cxd4 dxe4 Search estimate: -0.06 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE A4

11. a4 Search estimate: -0.08 from White's perspective.

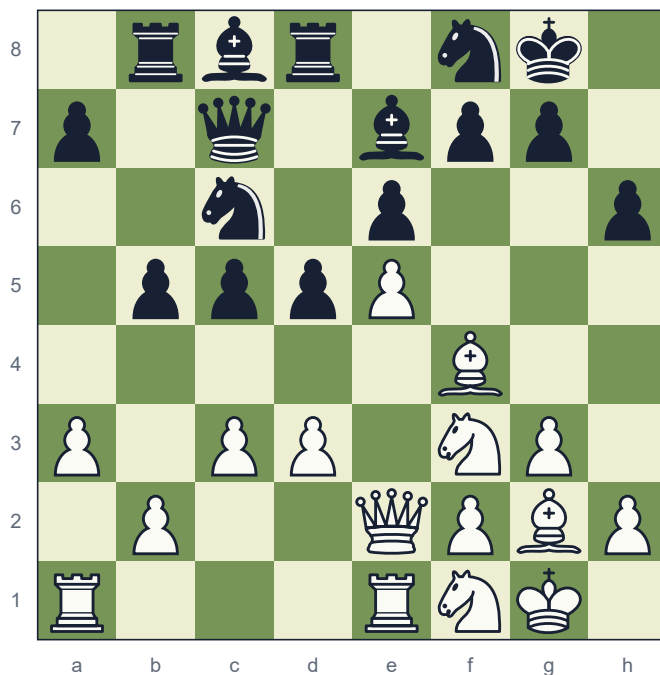
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Controls nearby wing squares and may restrain a piece or pawn. Compare this useful purpose with the time lost to central development.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-01 / decision 2



COMPARE CANDIDATES

h4 and d4. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, c3, d3, e5. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, d5, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE H4

15. h4 Search estimate: +0.24 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE D4

15. d4 cxd4 16. Nxd4 Nxd4 17. cxd4 b4 18. axb4 Bxb4 Search estimate: -0.04 from White's perspective.

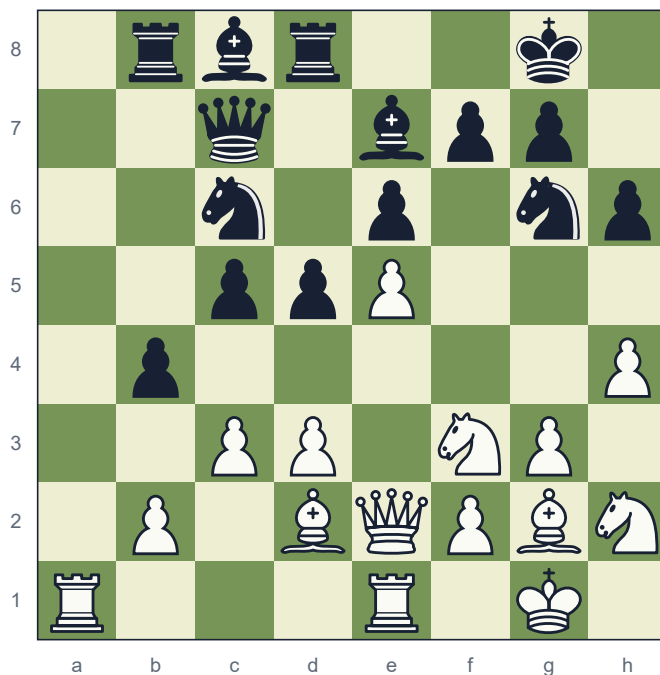
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Creates a wing or central pawn contact and changes king shelter. Calculate captures and the opponent's central counterplay before extending the advance.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-01 / decision 3



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

d4 and h5. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, c3, d3, e5. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, d5, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE D4

19. d4 Bd7 20. h5 Nf8 21. Ng4 bxc3 22. bxc3 cxd4 Search estimate: +0.18 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE H5

19. h5 Search estimate: +0.17 from White's perspective.

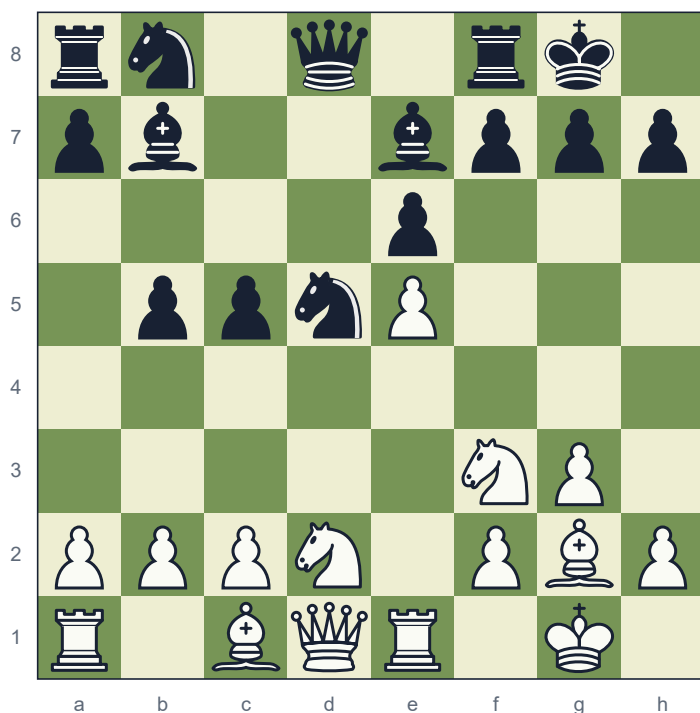
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Changes central space and pawn contacts. Calculate captures, advances and maintaining tension before choosing the next piece plan.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-02 / Black exchanges on e4



Laboratory start - White to move

OPENING BACKGROUND

The central exchange removes the familiar d5-e5 blockade. White's d-pawn becomes an e-pawn, opening the d-file and changing the bishop's prospects.

READ THE CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, e5. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

OPENING CONCERN TO RECHECK

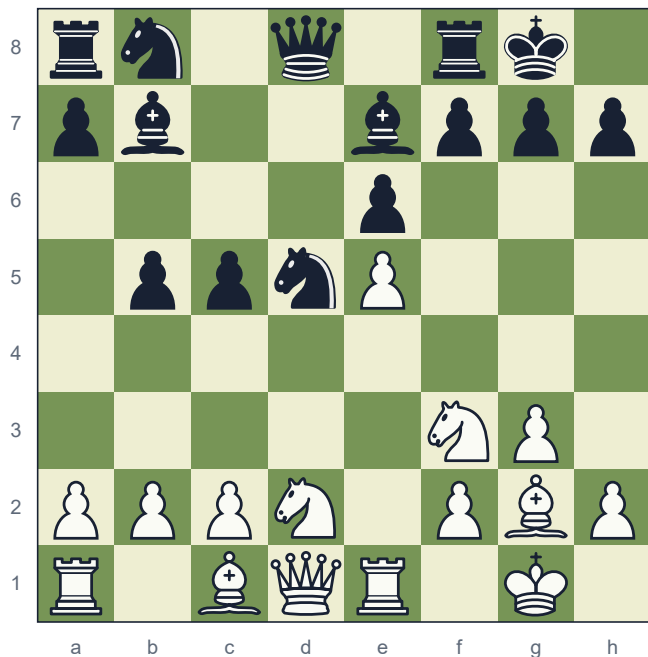
An automatic e5 attack plan may no longer fit. Black can use ...Nc6 and ...Qc7 to put pressure on e4. Decide which parts still apply after the moves already played.

BEFORE PLAYING

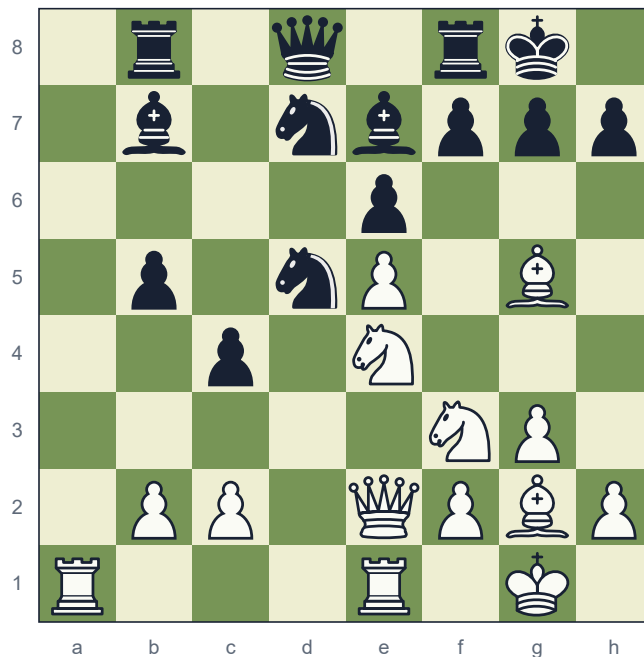
Write a candidate move and a reply for the opponent. Name the pawn break each side would like to achieve. The continuation on the following pages is one checked illustration, not a forced script.

KIA-LAB-02 / play and explain 1

11. Qe2 c4 12. Ne4 Nd7 13. a4 a6 14. Bg5 Rb8 15. axb5 axb5



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

11. QE2

Places the queen on e2. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

13. A4

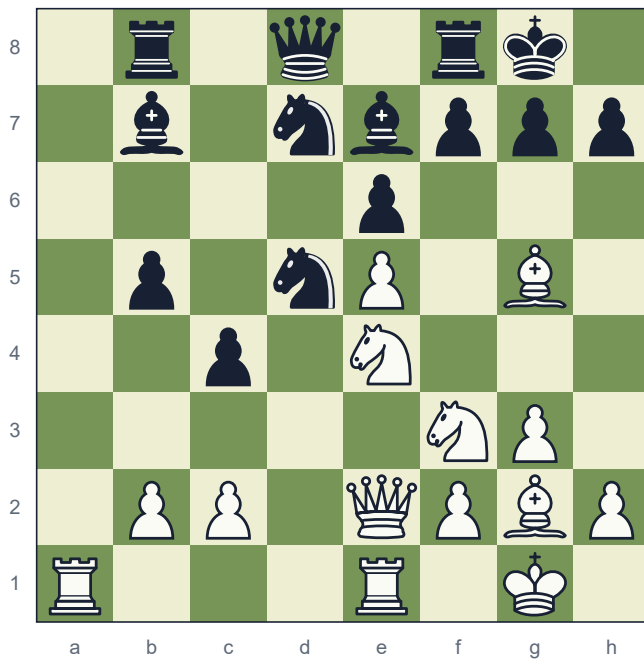
Places the pawn on a4. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

REASSESS

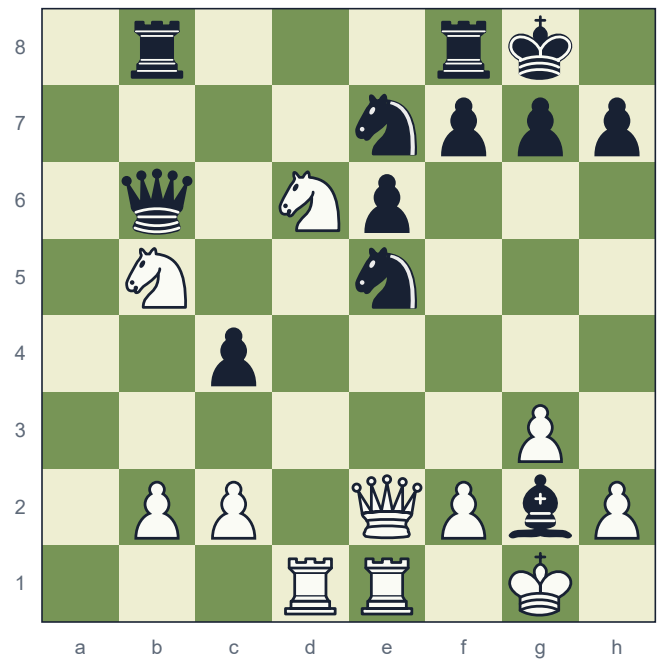
Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-02 / play and explain 2

16. Rad1 Qc7 17. Nd4 Nxe5 18. Bxe7 Nxe7 19. Nxb5 Qb6 20. Ned6 Bxg2



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

16. RAD1

Places the rook on d1, attacking knight on d5. A legal capture may still be unsound if the target is defended.

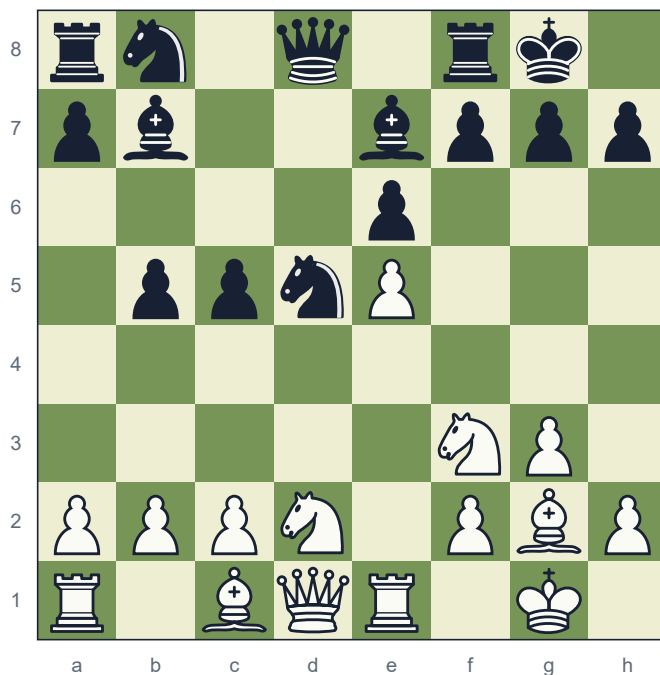
18. BXE7

The bishop captures a bishop on e7. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

REASSESS

Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-02 / decision 1



COMPARE CANDIDATES

Qe2 and Ne4. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, e5. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE QE2

11. Qe2 Search estimate: +0.32 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE NE4

11. Ne4 Nd7 12. Qe2 c4 13. Bg5 Qb6 14. Bxe7 Nxe7 Search estimate: +0.26 from White's perspective.

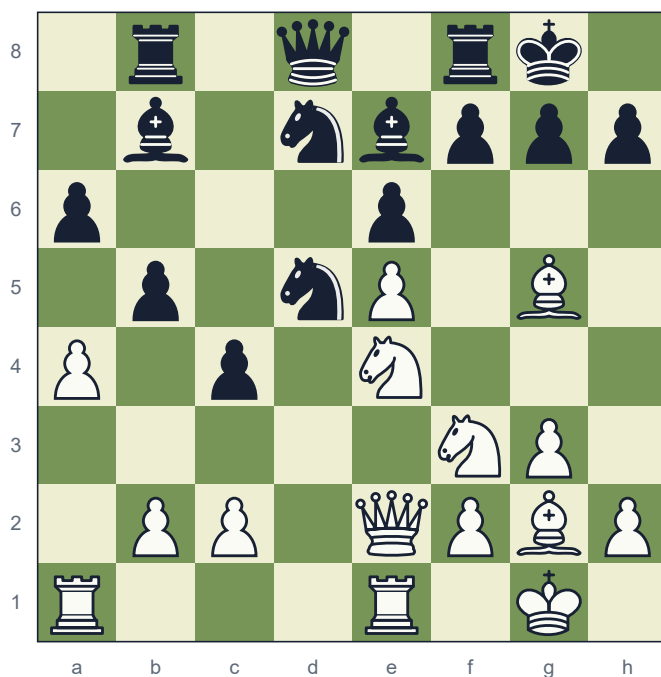
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Places the queen on e2. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-02 / decision 2



COMPARE CANDIDATES

axb5 and Rad1. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, e5. Black king g8; central-file pawns c4, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE AXB5

15. axb5 axb5 16. Rad1 Qc7 17. Nd4 Nxe5 18. Nxb5 Qb6 Search estimate: +0.12 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE RAD1

15. Rad1 Bxg5 Search estimate: +0.05 from White's perspective.

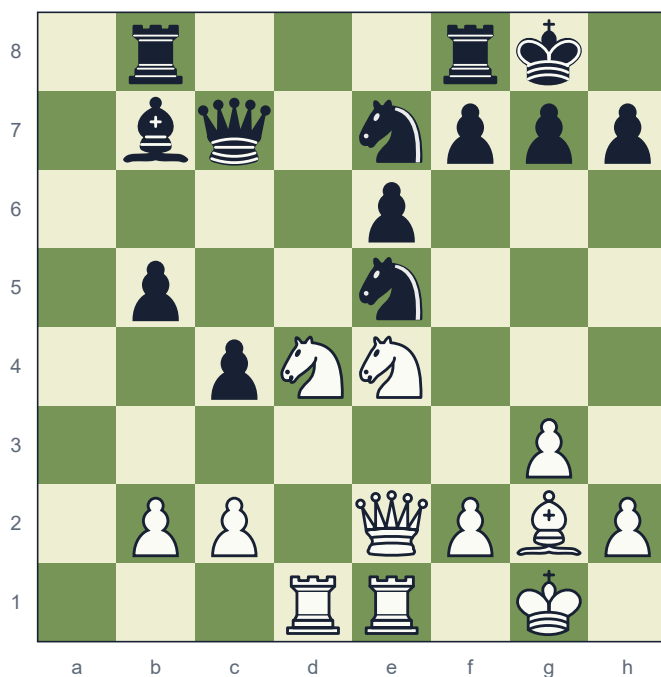
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The pawn captures a pawn on b5. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-02 / decision 3



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Nxb5 and h4. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2. Black king g8; central-file pawns c4, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE NXB5

19. Nxb5 Qb6 20. Ned6 Bxg2 21. Kxg2 Qc6+ 22. Qe4 Rfd8 Search estimate: -0.08 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE H4

19. h4 Qb6 20. Nxb5 Qxb5 21. Nd6 Bf3 22. Bxf3 Nxf3+ Search estimate: -0.27 from White's perspective.

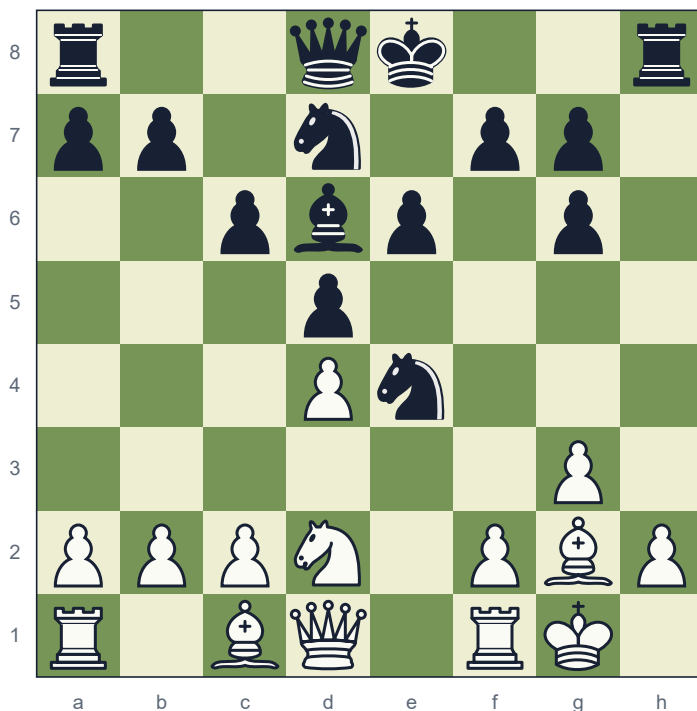
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The knight captures a pawn on b5. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-03 / Questioning Bf5 with Nh4



Laboratory start - White to move

OPENING BACKGROUND

White gives a knight for the active bishop and changes Black's kingside pawn structure. The open h-file can help Black as well as create targets.

READ THE CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, d4. Black king e8; central-file pawns d5, c6, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

OPENING CONCERN TO RECHECK

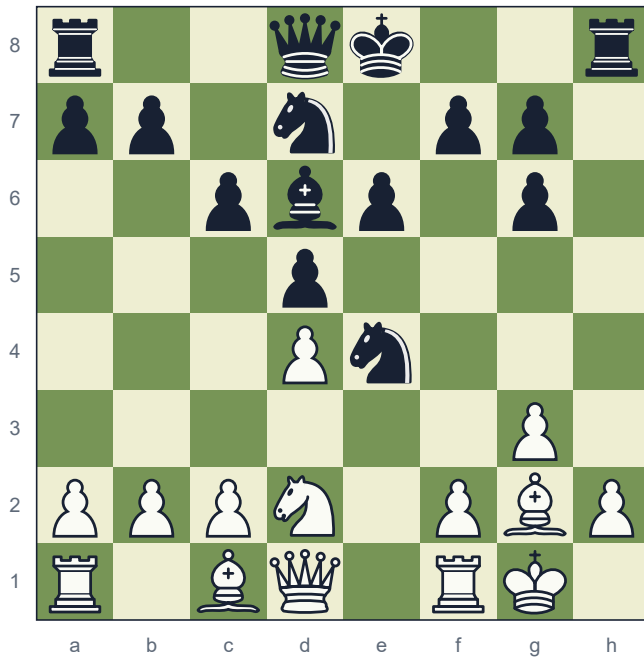
Black's h8 rook now has an open file. Castling short was already a commitment, so watch pressure toward your own king. Decide which parts still apply after the moves already played.

BEFORE PLAYING

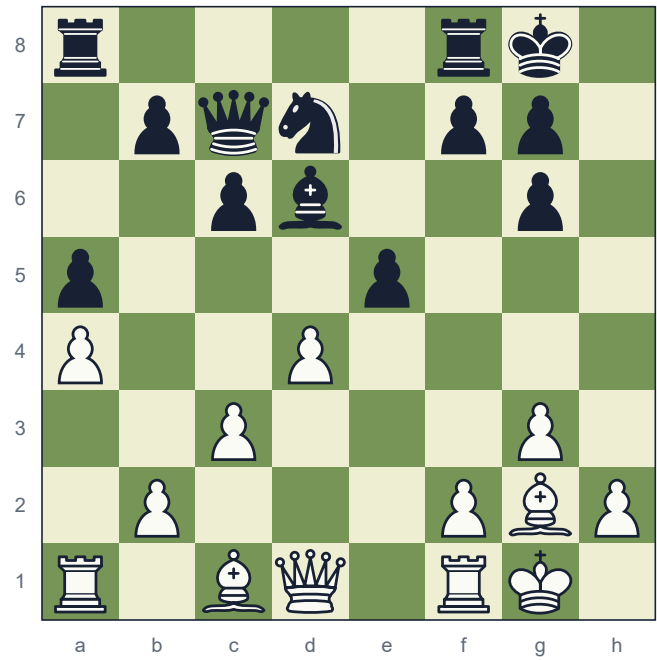
Write a candidate move and a reply for the opponent. Name the pawn break each side would like to achieve. The continuation on the following pages is one checked illustration, not a forced script.

KIA-LAB-03 / play and explain 1

11. Nxe4 dxe4 12. Bxe4 O-O 13. c3 Qc7 14. a4 e5 15. Bg2 a5



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

11. NXE4

The knight captures a knight on e4. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

13. C3

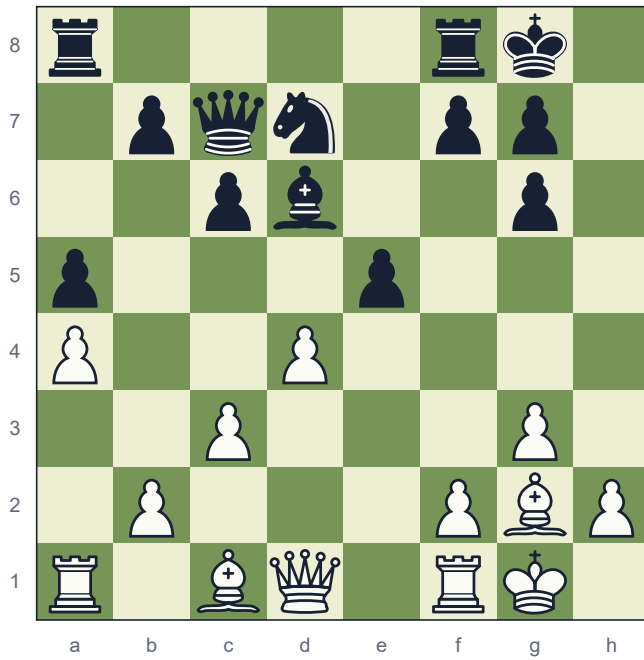
Places the pawn on c3. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

REASSESS

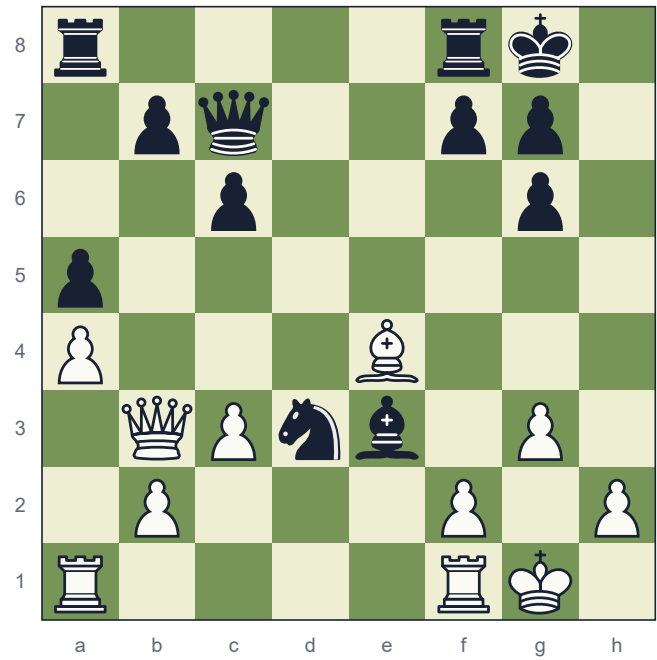
Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-03 / play and explain 2

16. dxe5 Nxe5 17. Qb3 Nd3 18. Bg5 Be7 19. Be3 Bc5 20. Be4 Bxe3



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

16. DXE5

The pawn captures a pawn on e5. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

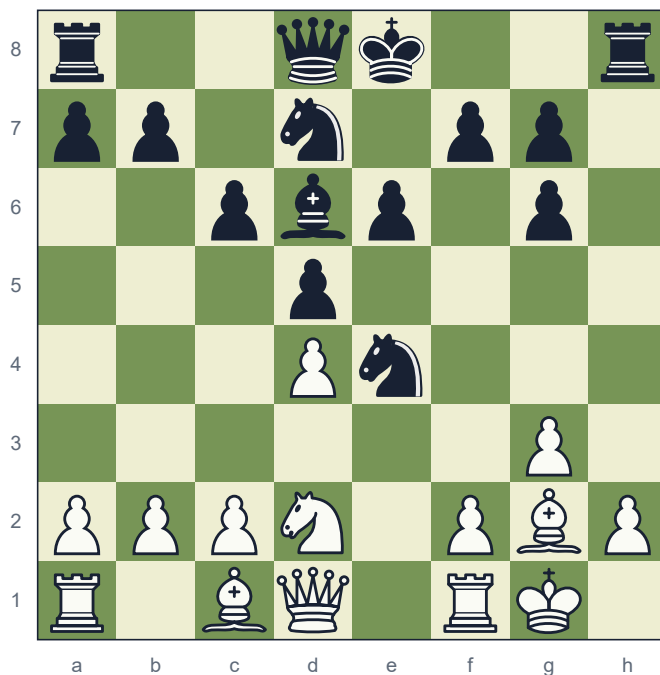
18. BG5

Places the bishop on g5. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

REASSESS

Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-03 / decision 1



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Nxe4 and Bxe4. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, d4. Black king e8; central-file pawns d5, c6, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE NXE4

11. Nxe4 Search estimate: +0.56 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE BXE4

11. Bxe4 dxe4 12. Nxe4 Nf6 13. Re1 O-O 14. c3 Be7 Search estimate: +0.21 from White's perspective.

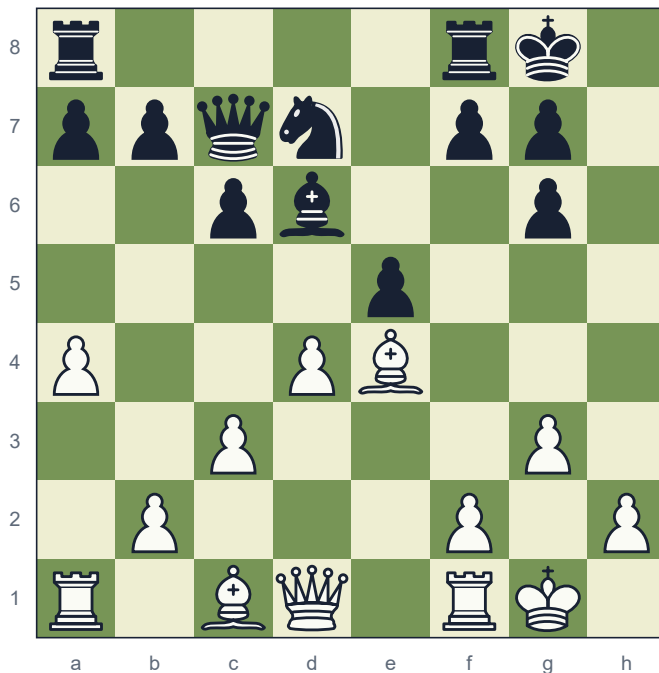
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The knight captures a knight on e4. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-03 / decision 2



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Bg2 and a5. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, c3, d4. Black king g8; central-file pawns e5, c6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE BG2

15. Bg2 Rfe8 Search estimate: +0.51 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE A5

15. a5 Rfe8 16. Bg2 a6 17. Bg5 Be7 18. Be3 exd4 Search estimate: +0.51 from White's perspective.

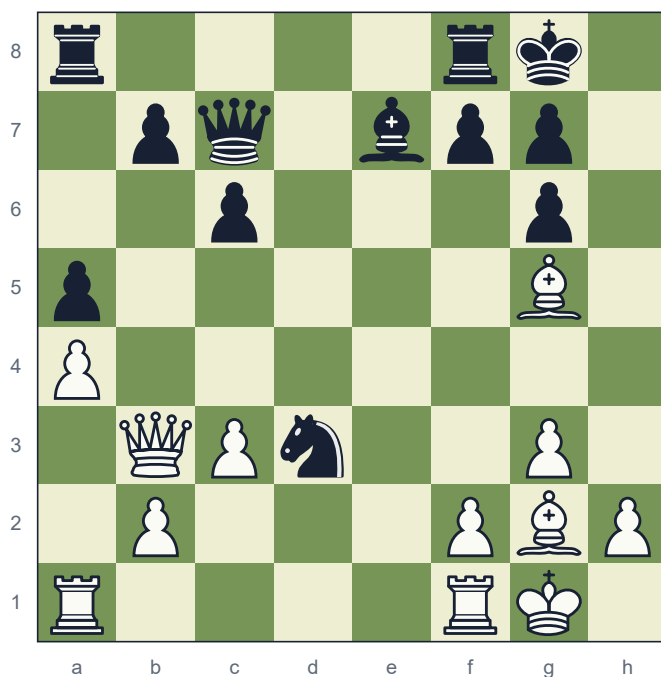
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Completes the kingside fianchetto. Trace the diagonal to its first blocker; the bishop cannot attack through friendly pawns or pieces.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-03 / decision 3



COMPARE CANDIDATES

Be3 and Rad1. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, c3. Black king g8; central-file pawns c6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE BE3

19. Be3 Bc5 20. Be4 Bxe3 21. Bxd3 Ba7 22. Bxg6 Rad8 Search estimate: +0.47 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE RAD1

19. Rad1 Nc5 Search estimate: +0.13 from White's perspective.

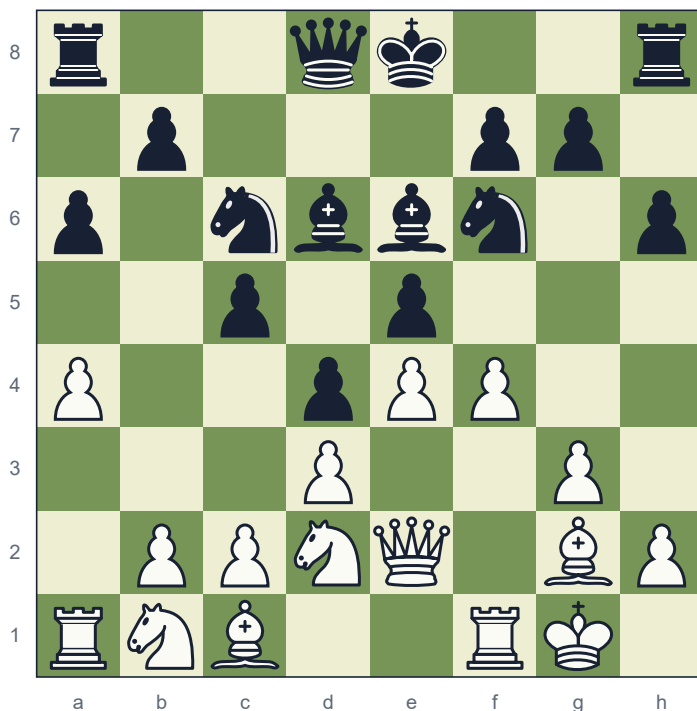
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Places the bishop on e3. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-04 / Reversed King's Indian structure



Laboratory start - White to move

OPENING BACKGROUND

Black closes the center with a space advantage. White has a reversed King's Indian type of position, but the move order and extra tempo require independent calculation.

READ THE CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, d3, e4, f4. Black king e8; central-file pawns d4, c5, e5, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

OPENING CONCERN TO RECHECK

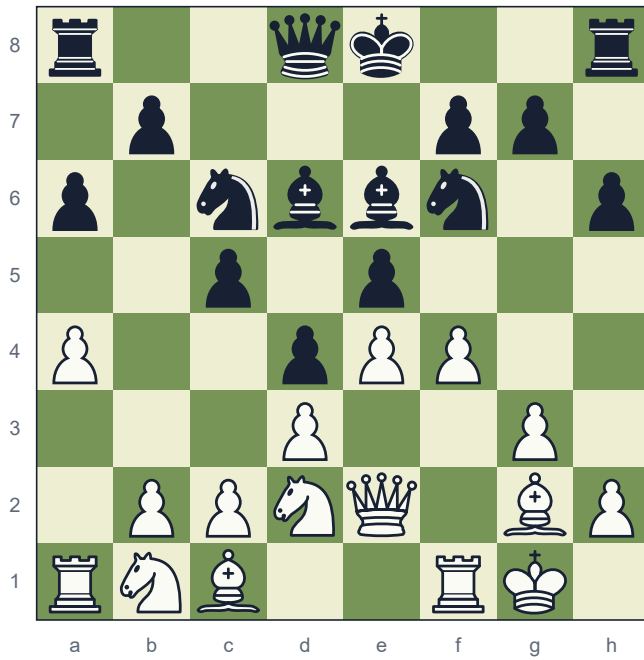
Black can expand with ...b5 and ...c4. A slow maneuver must be measured against the opponent's actual pawn-break timing. Decide which parts still apply after the moves already played.

BEFORE PLAYING

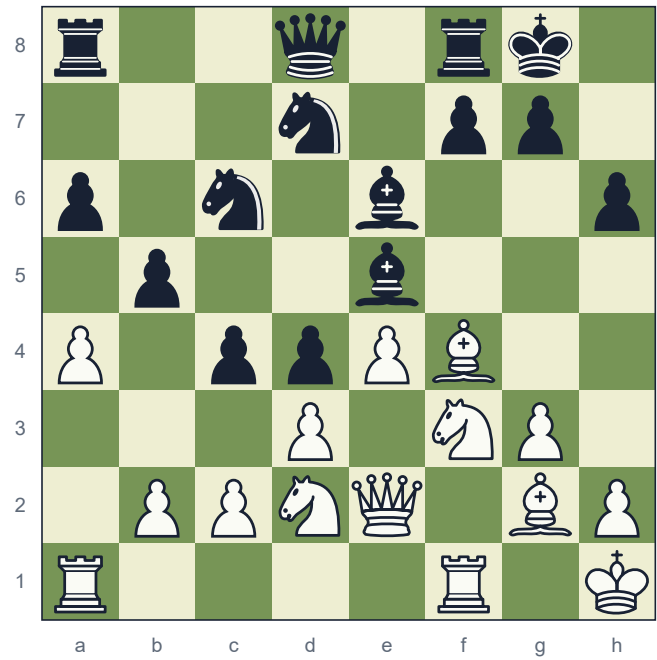
Write a candidate move and a reply for the opponent. Name the pawn break each side would like to achieve. The continuation on the following pages is one checked illustration, not a forced script.

KIA-LAB-04 / play and explain 1

11. Kh1 b5 12. Nf3 c4 13. fxe5 Bxe5 14. Bf4 Nd7 15. Nbd2 O-O



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

11. KH1

Places the king on h1. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

13. FXE5

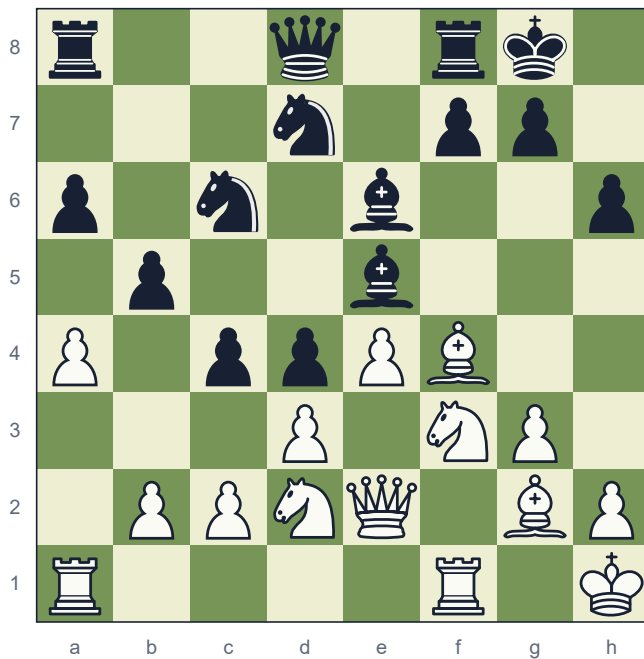
The pawn captures a pawn on e5. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

REASSESS

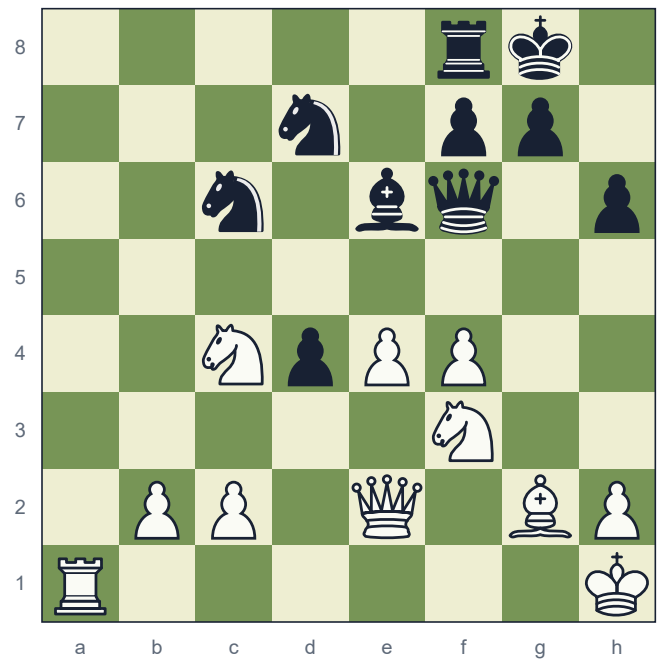
Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-04 / play and explain 2

16. axb5 axb5 17. dxc4 Rxa1 18. Rxa1 bxc4 19. Nxc4 Bxf4 20. gxf4 Qf6



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

16. AXB5

The pawn captures a pawn on b5. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

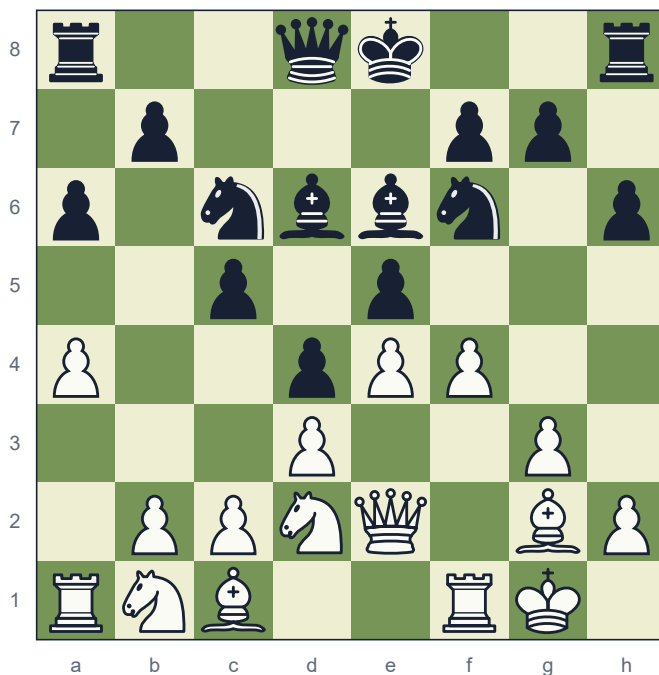
18. RXA1

The rook captures a rook on a1. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

REASSESS

Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-04 / decision 1



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Kh1 and Nf3. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, d3, e4, f4. Black king e8; central-file pawns d4, c5, e5, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE KH1

11. Kh1 b5 12. Nf3 c4 13. fxe5 Bxe5 14. axb5 axb5 Search estimate: -0.31 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE NF3

11. Nf3 b5 12. Nxe5 Nxe5 13. fxe5 Bxe5 14. Bf4 Nd7 Search estimate: -0.33 from White's perspective.

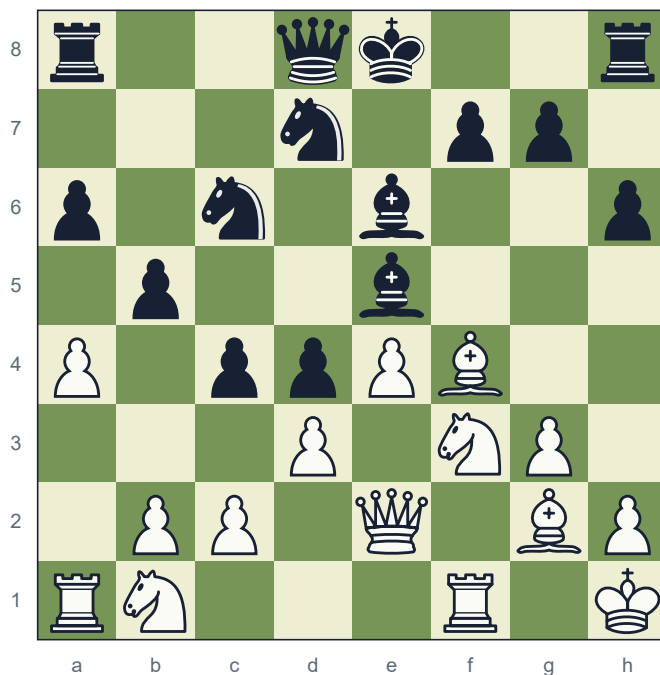
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Places the king on h1. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-04 / decision 2



COMPARE CANDIDATES

Nbd2 and axb5. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king h1; central-file pawns c2, d3, e4. Black king e8; central-file pawns c4, d4, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE NBD2

15. Nbd2 O-O 16. dxc4 bxa4 17. Rxa4 f6 18. b4 a5 Search estimate: -0.04 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE AXB5

15. axb5 axb5 Search estimate: -0.28 from White's perspective.

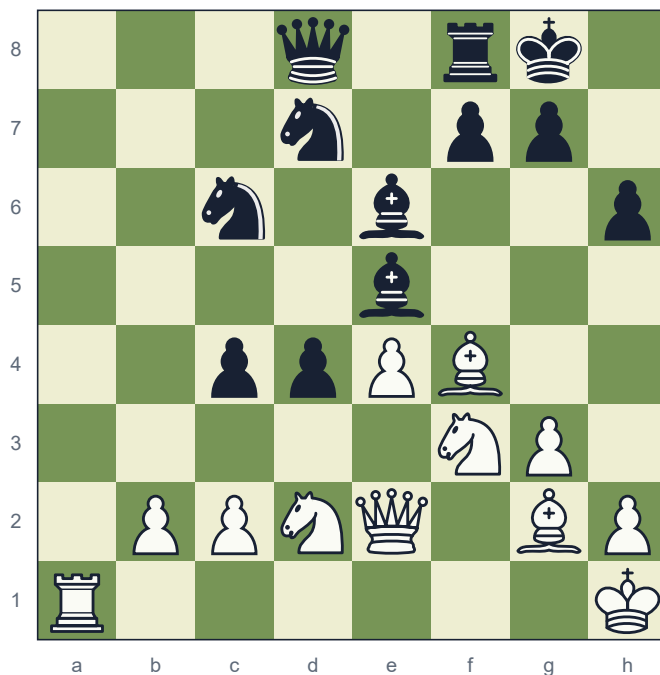
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Develops the queen knight while leaving the c-pawn free. The knight supports e4 and may seek c4 or a route through f1.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-04 / decision 3



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Nxc4 and Rg1. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king h1; central-file pawns c2, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns c4, d4, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE NXC4

19. Nxc4 Bxf4 20. gxf4 Qf6 21. f5 Bxc4 22. Qxc4 Rd8 Search estimate: -0.01 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE RG1

19. Rg1 c3 Search estimate: -0.71 from White's perspective.

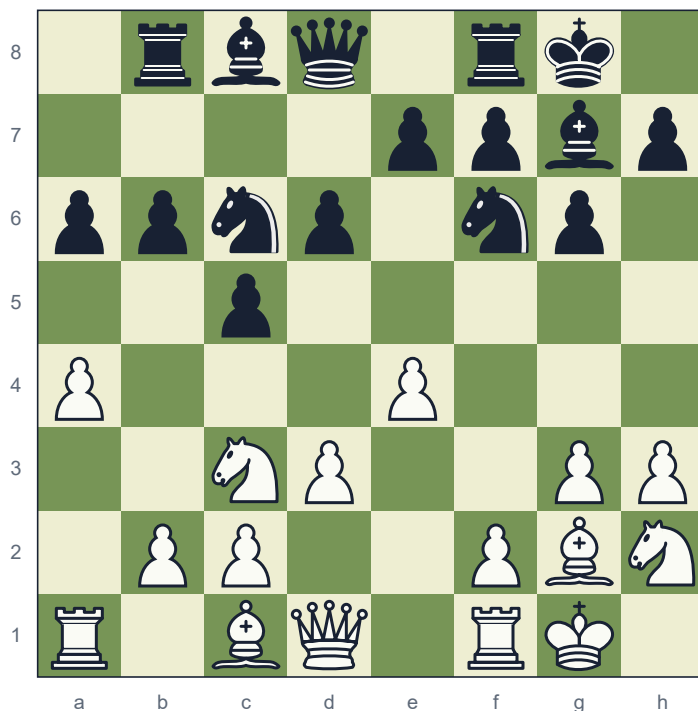
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The knight captures a pawn on c4. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-05 / Black plays ...c5 on move one



Laboratory start - White to move

OPENING BACKGROUND

Starting with Nf3 allows Black a Sicilian-like or English-like structure. White can establish e4 after seeing Black's fianchetto.

READ THE CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, d3, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, d6, e7, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

OPENING CONCERN TO RECHECK

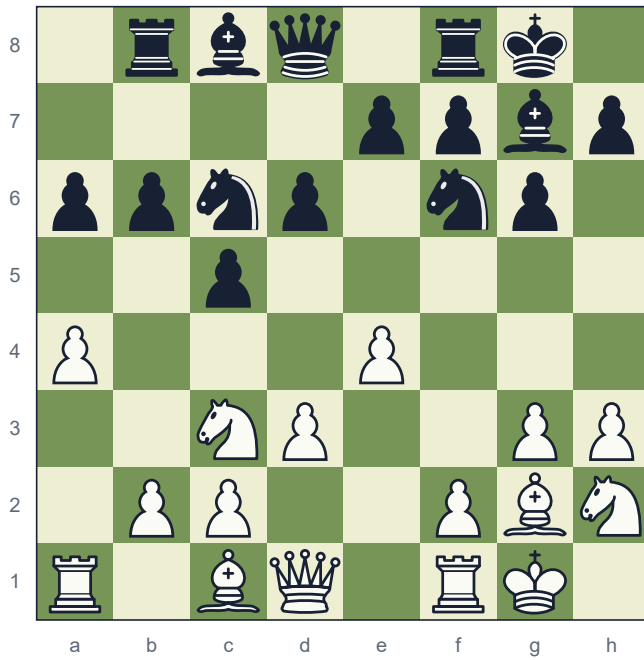
Nc3 blocks the c-pawn temporarily, while Nbd2 can crowd the queen bishop. Each knight square carries a structural commitment. Decide which parts still apply after the moves already played.

BEFORE PLAYING

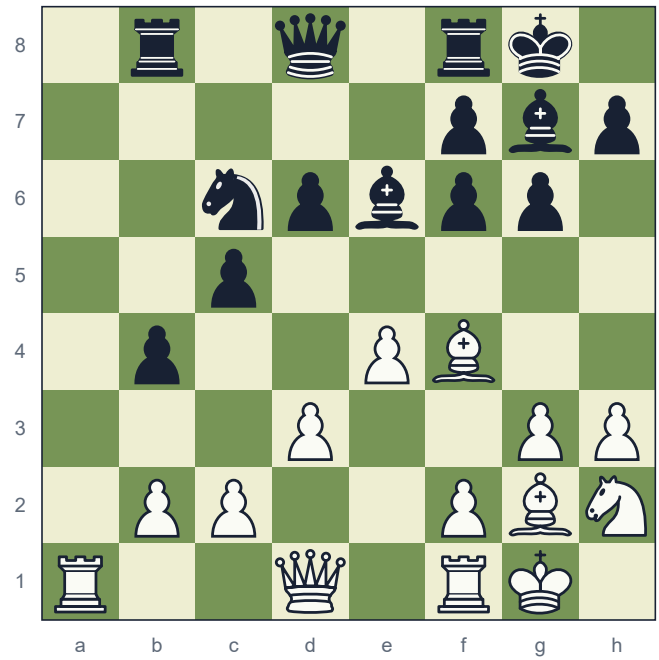
Write a candidate move and a reply for the opponent. Name the pawn break each side would like to achieve. The continuation on the following pages is one checked illustration, not a forced script.

KIA-LAB-05 / play and explain 1

11. Nd5 b5 12. axb5 axb5 13. Bg5 b4 14. Nxf6+ exf6 15. Bf4 Be6



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

11. ND5

Places the knight on d5, attacking knight on f6. A legal capture may still be unsound if the target is defended.

13. BG5

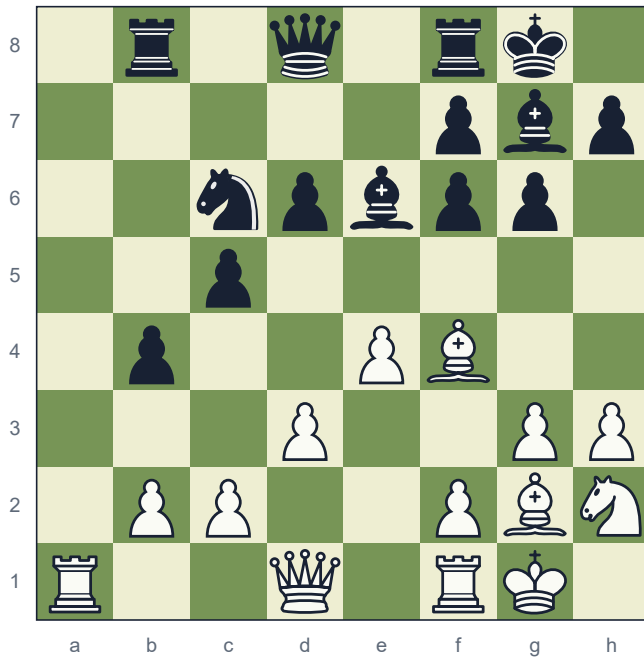
Places the bishop on g5, attacking knight on f6. A legal capture may still be unsound if the target is defended.

REASSESS

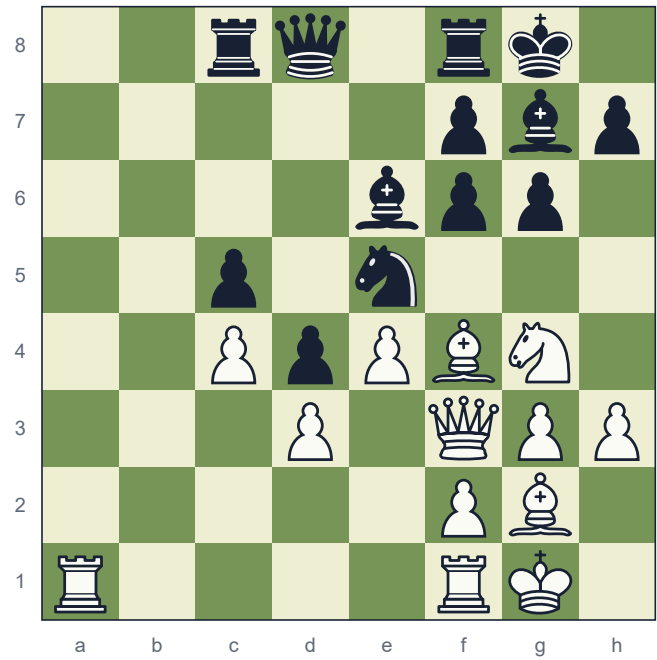
Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-05 / play and explain 2

16. c3 Rc8 17. Ng4 d5 18. Qf3 bxc3 19. bxc3 d4 20. c4 Ne5



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

16. C3

Places the pawn on c3. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

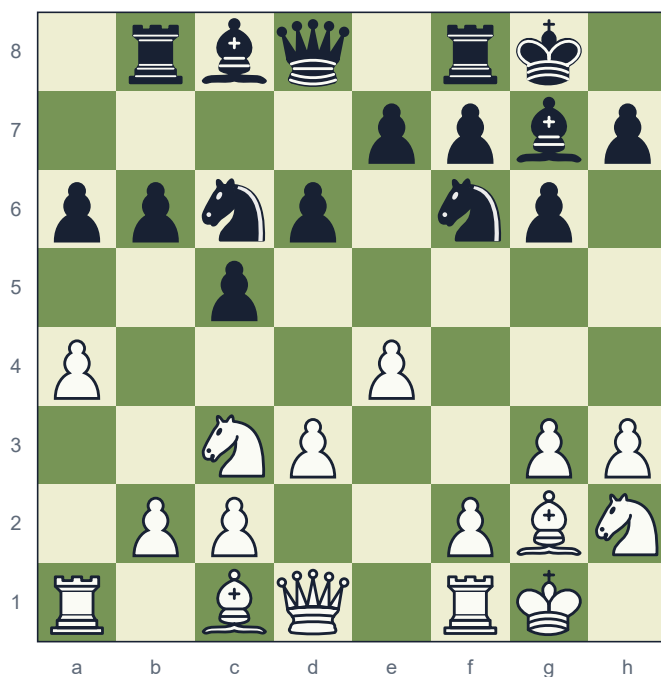
18. QF3

Places the queen on f3. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

REASSESS

Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-05 / decision 1



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Nd5 and Bg5. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, d3, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, d6, e7, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE ND5

11. Nd5 b5 12. axb5 axb5 13. Bg5 b4 14. Nxf6+ Bxf6 Search estimate: -0.15 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE BG5

11. Bg5 h6 Search estimate: -0.23 from White's perspective.

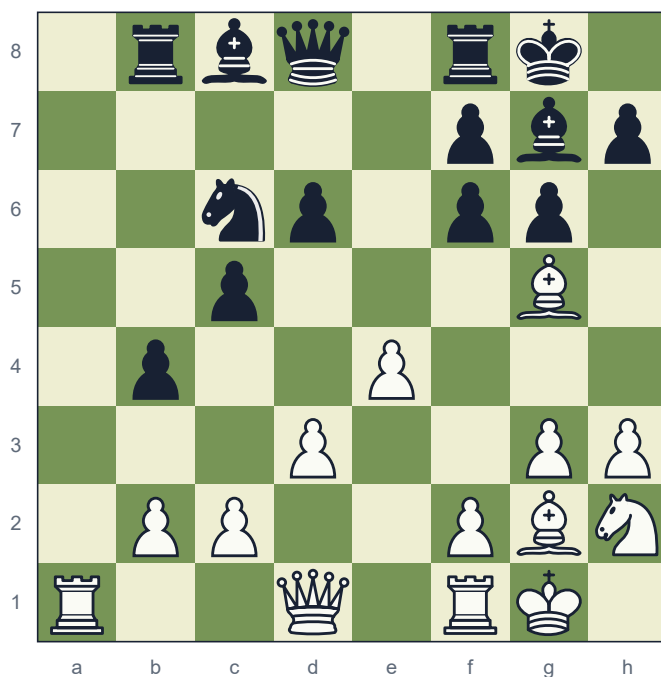
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Places the knight on d5, attacking knight on f6. A legal capture may still be unsound if the target is defended.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-05 / decision 2



COMPARE CANDIDATES

Bf4 and Be3. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, d3, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, d6, f6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE BF4

15. Bf4 Search estimate: -0.02 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE BE3

15. Be3 Qb6 16. Bf4 Ne5 17. Qd2 Search estimate: -0.09 from White's perspective.

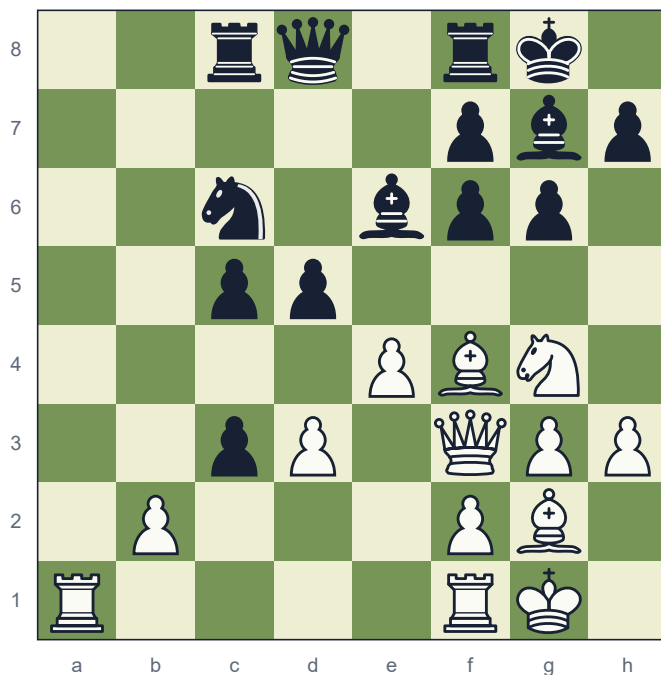
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Develops the queen bishop with central influence. Check whether a pawn advance can gain a tempo against it.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-05 / decision 3



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

bxc3 and Nh6+. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, d3, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns c3, c5, d5, f6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE BXC3

19. bxc3 Search estimate: -0.12 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE NH6+

19. Nh6+ Bxh6 20. Bxh6 Nd4 21. Qe3 c2 22. Bxf8 Kxf8 Search estimate: -2.10 from White's perspective.

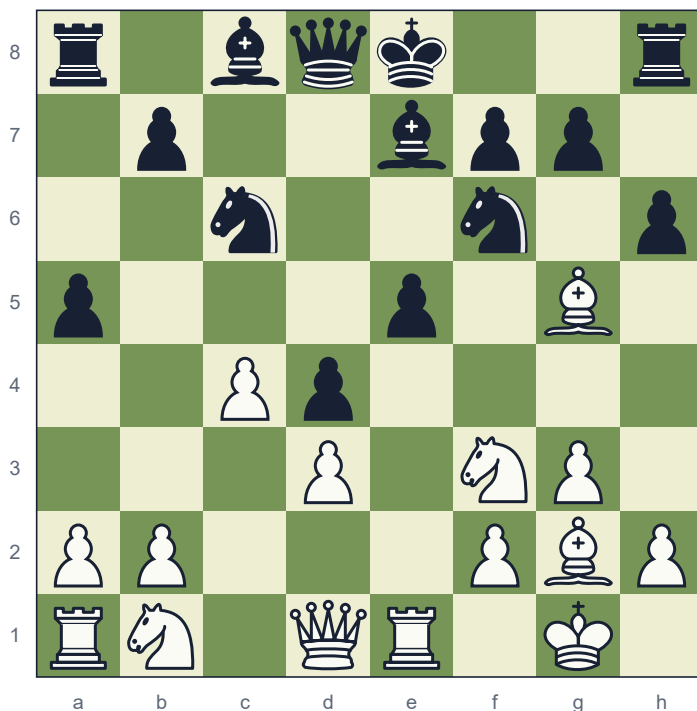
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The pawn captures a pawn on c3. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-06 / Early ...d4 before the setup



Laboratory start - White to move

OPENING BACKGROUND

White chooses c4 before e4 to challenge the broad center. Once Black closes with ...d4, the result belongs to a different structure from the main KIA attack.

READ THE CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, d3, c4. Black king e8; central-file pawns d4, e5, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

OPENING CONCERN TO RECHECK

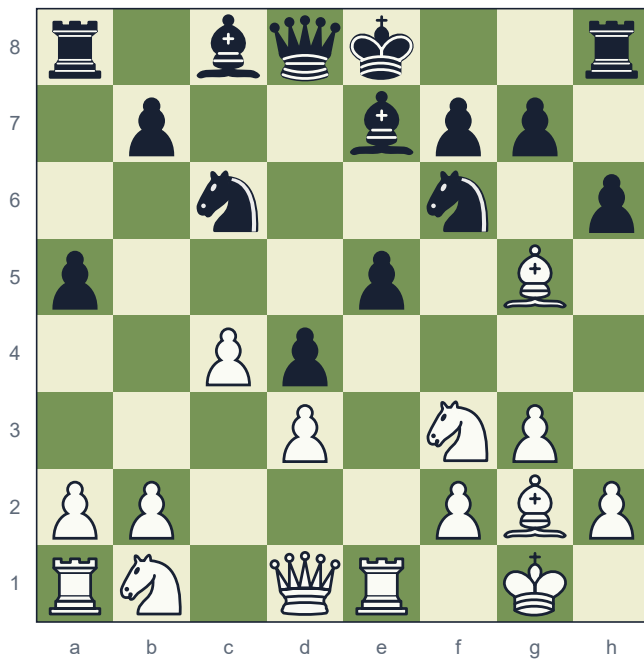
Black's d4 pawn restricts Nc3. Putting a piece on a square controlled by that pawn is a concrete error, regardless of a familiar development pattern. Decide which parts still apply after the moves already played.

BEFORE PLAYING

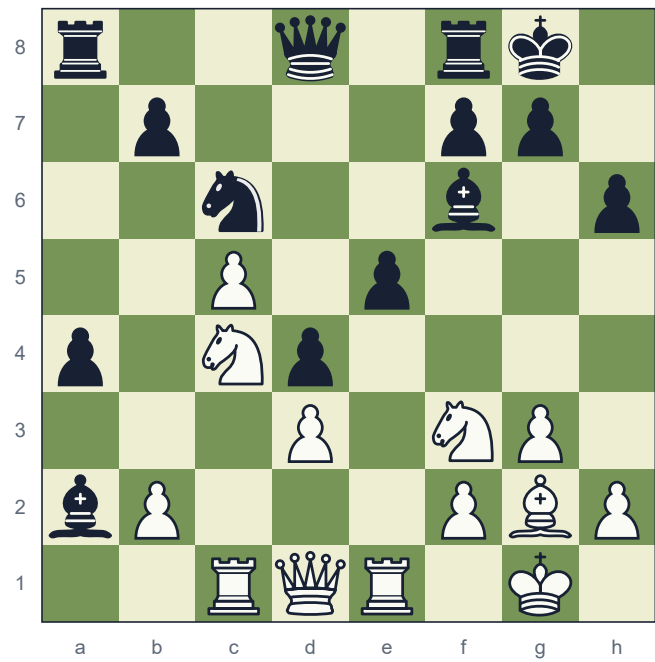
Write a candidate move and a reply for the opponent. Name the pawn break each side would like to achieve. The continuation on the following pages is one checked illustration, not a forced script.

KIA-LAB-06 / play and explain 1

11. Bxf6 Bxf6 12. c5 Be6 13. Na3 a4 14. Rc1 Bxa2 15. Nc4 O-O



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

11. Bxf6

The bishop captures a knight on f6. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

13. NA3

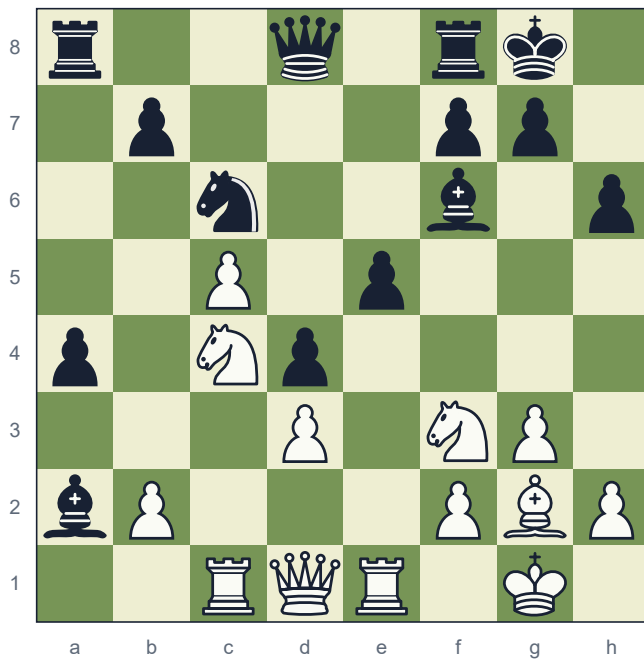
Places the knight on a3. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

REASSESS

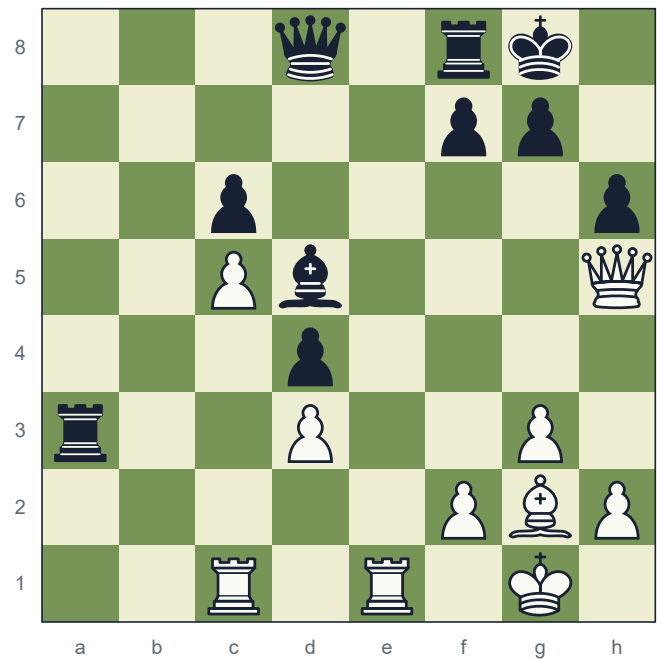
Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-06 / play and explain 2

16. Nfxe5 Bxe5 17. Nxe5 Bd5 18. Nxc6 bxc6 19. Qh5 a3 20. bxa3 Rxa3



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

16. NFXE5

The knight captures a pawn on e5. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

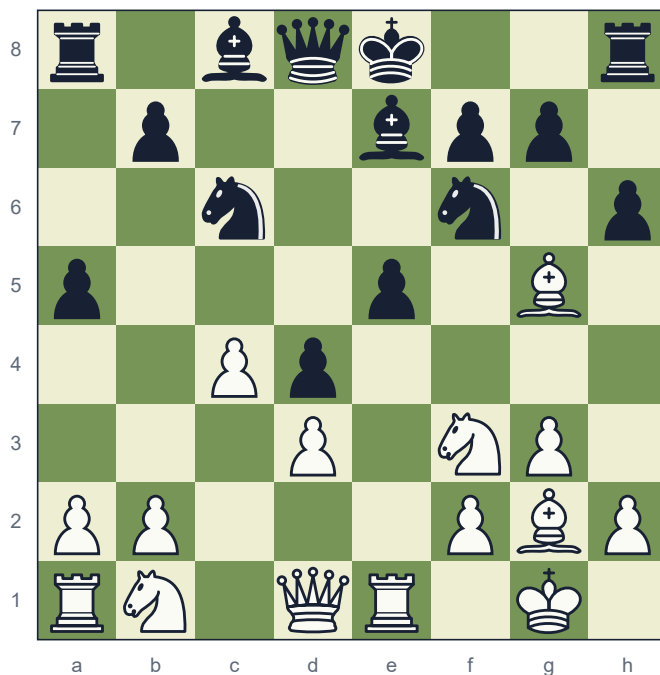
18. NXC6

The knight captures a knight on c6. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

REASSESS

Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KIA-LAB-06 / decision 1



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Bxf6 and Bc1. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, d3, c4. Black king e8; central-file pawns d4, e5, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE BXF6

11. Bxf6 Search estimate: +0.25 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE BC1

11. Bc1 Nd7 12. Na3 O-O 13. Nb5 Re8 14. a3 a4 Search estimate: -0.78 from White's perspective.

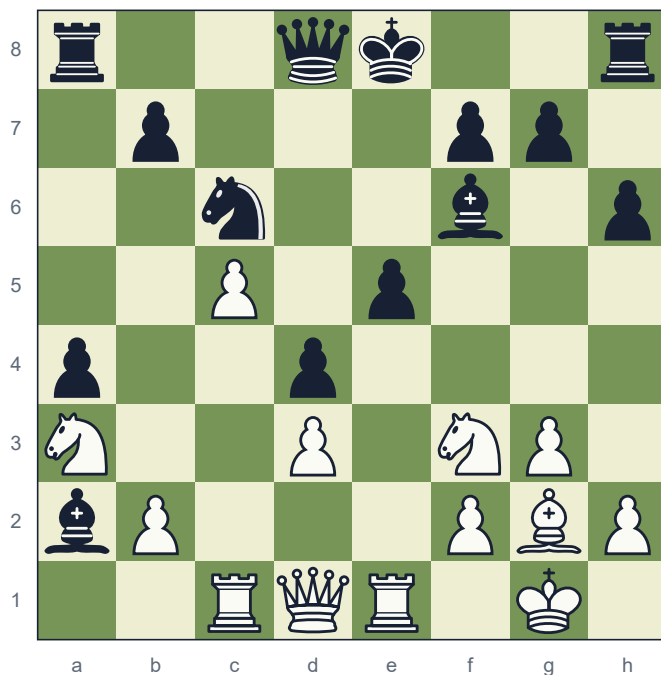
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The bishop captures a knight on f6. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-06 / decision 2



COMPARE CANDIDATES

Nc4 and Nd2. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, d3, c5. Black king e8; central-file pawns d4, e5, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE NC4

15. Nc4 O-O 16. Nfxe5 Bxe5 17. Nxe5 Bd5 18. Nxc6 bxc6 Search estimate: +0.06 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE ND2

15. Nd2 Search estimate: -0.08 from White's perspective.

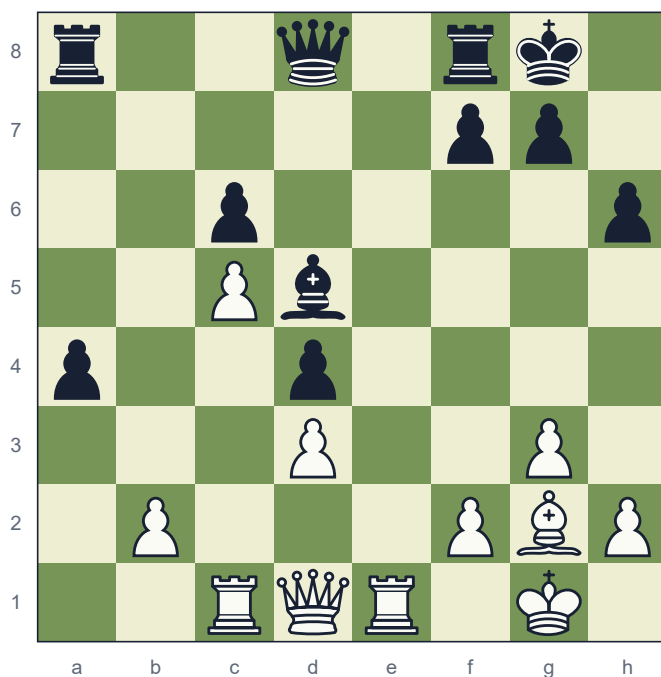
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Places the knight on c4. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KIA-LAB-06 / decision 3



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Qh5 and Re5. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns f2, d3, c5. Black king g8; central-file pawns d4, c6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE QH5

19. Qh5 a3 20. bxa3 Rxa3 21. Bxd5 Qxd5 22. Re5 Qb3 Search estimate: +0.07 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE RE5

19. Re5 Bxg2 20. Kxg2 f6 21. Re4 f5 22. Re5 f4 Search estimate: +0.01 from White's perspective.

EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Places the queen on h5, attacking bishop on d5. A legal capture may still be unsound if the target is defended.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

48 exercises / instructions

THREE KINDS OF QUESTION

Questions 1-24 test opening recall, 25-36 test plans and defense, and 37-48 compare concrete candidates from the laboratories. These are not all tactical puzzles and do not all have one uniquely best move.

WORK WITHOUT THE ANSWER

Use a board and write your answer. Spend two to five minutes on a recall question and five to ten on a candidate comparison. Name the opponent's threat before choosing your own move.

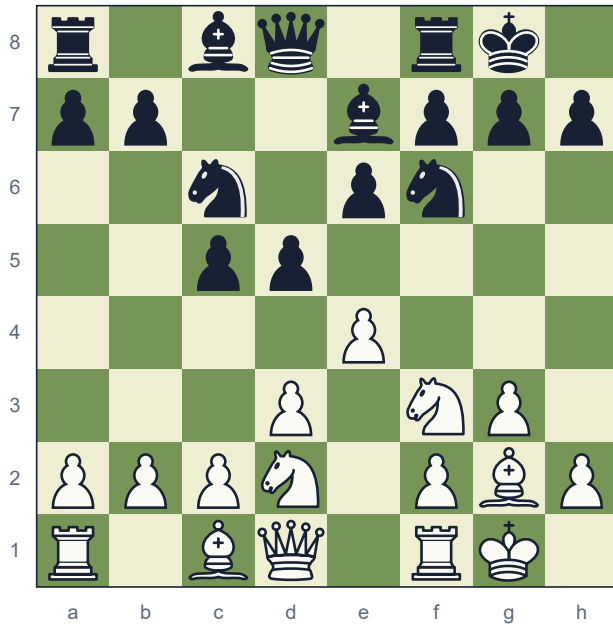
MARKING

Award one point for a legal, relevant choice or plan; one for a clear reason; one for recognizing the opponent's resource; and one for a supporting variation or accurate description of the structure. Maximum: 192. Do not reward memorized notation that you cannot explain.

ANSWERS ARE LATER

The question pages come first, followed by explained answers and sample continuations. In planning questions the sample answer is a guide, not an exhaustive list of reasonable plans.

Exercises 1-2



White to move

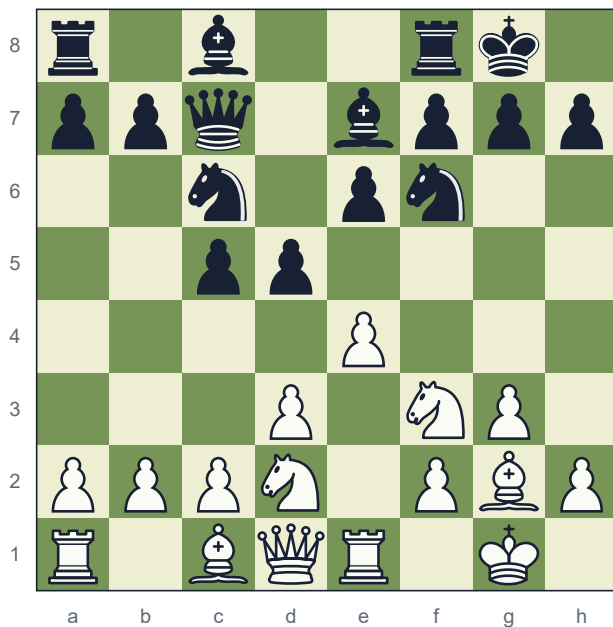
01 / OPENING RECALL

Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

02 / OPENING RECALL

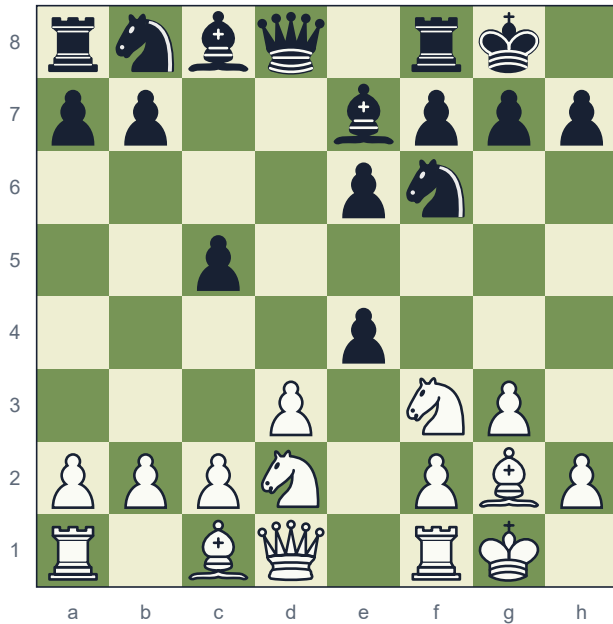
Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 3-4



White to move

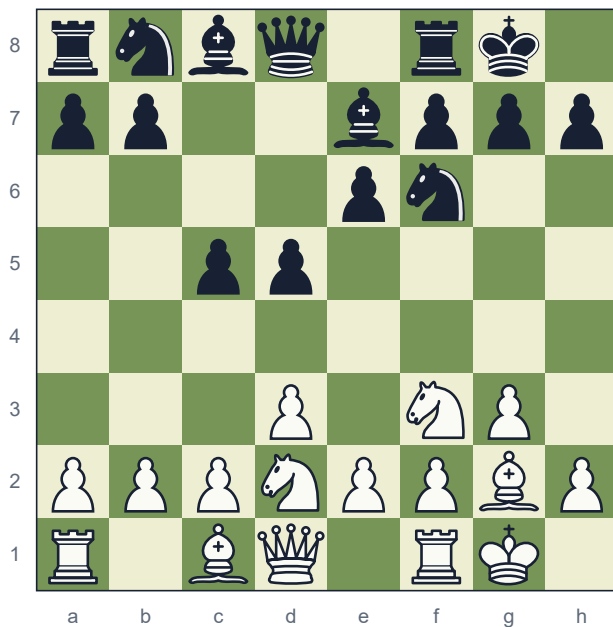
03 / OPENING RECALL

Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

04 / OPENING RECALL

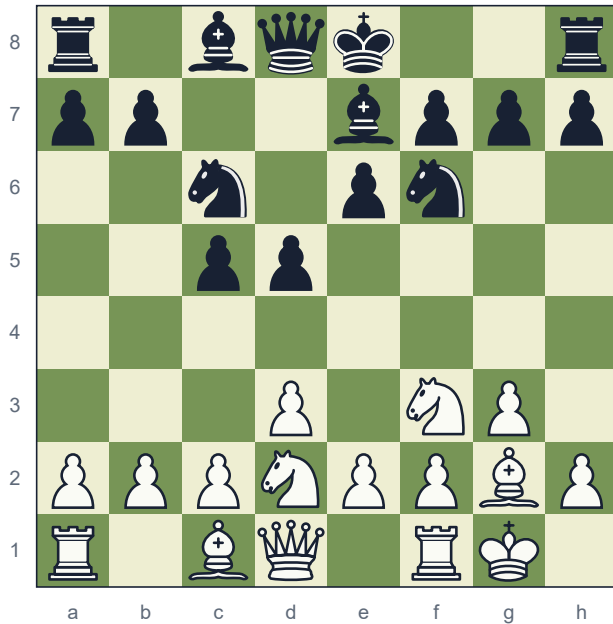
Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 5-6



White to move

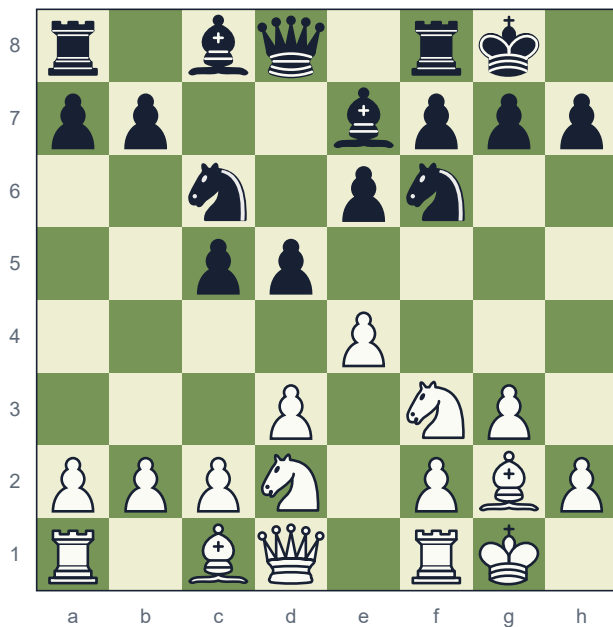
05 / OPENING RECALL

Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

06 / OPENING RECALL

Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 7-8



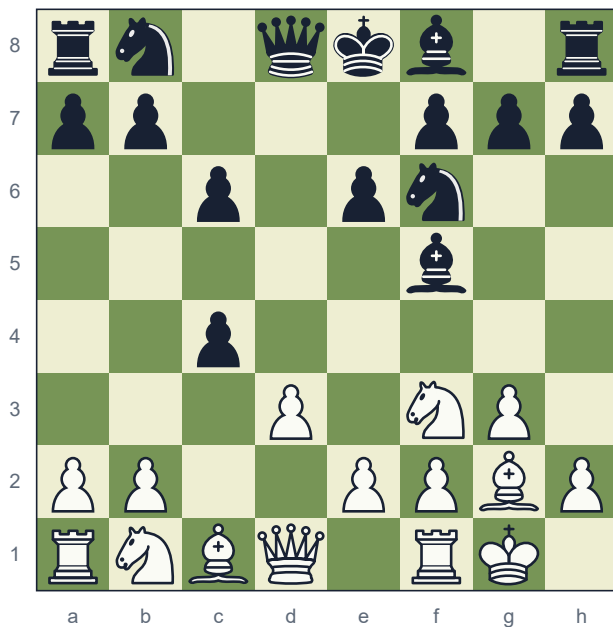
07 / OPENING RECALL

Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



08 / OPENING RECALL

Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 9-10



White to move

09 / OPENING RECALL

Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

10 / OPENING RECALL

Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 11-12



White to move

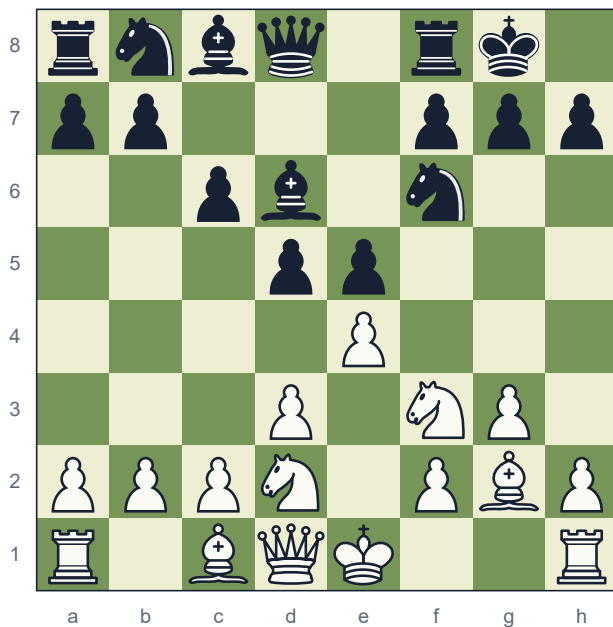
11 / OPENING RECALL

Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

12 / OPENING RECALL

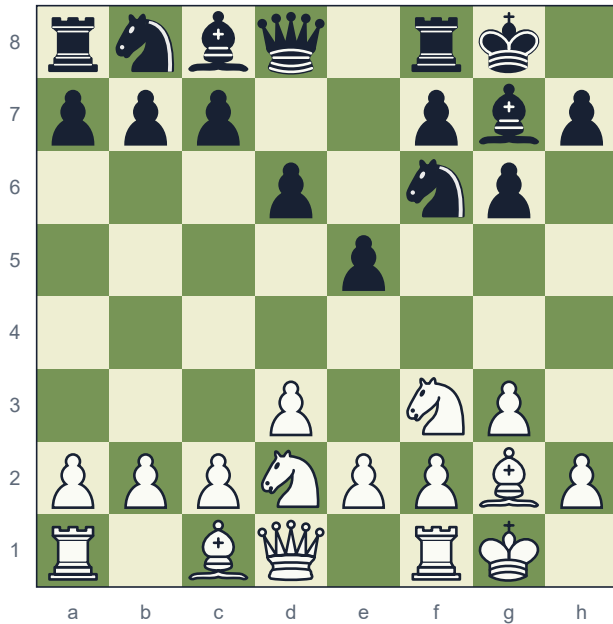
Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 13-14



White to move

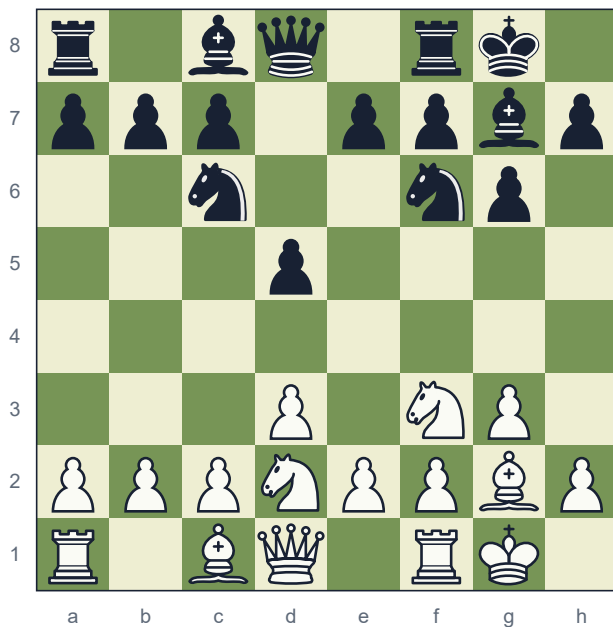
13 / OPENING RECALL

Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

14 / OPENING RECALL

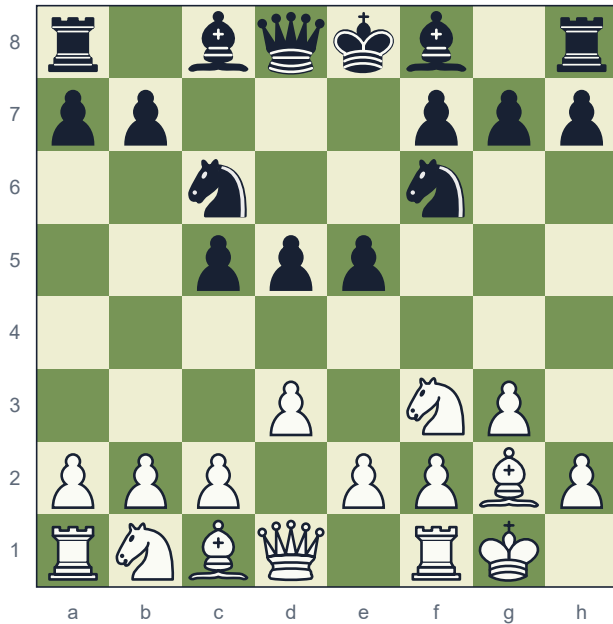
Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 15-16



White to move

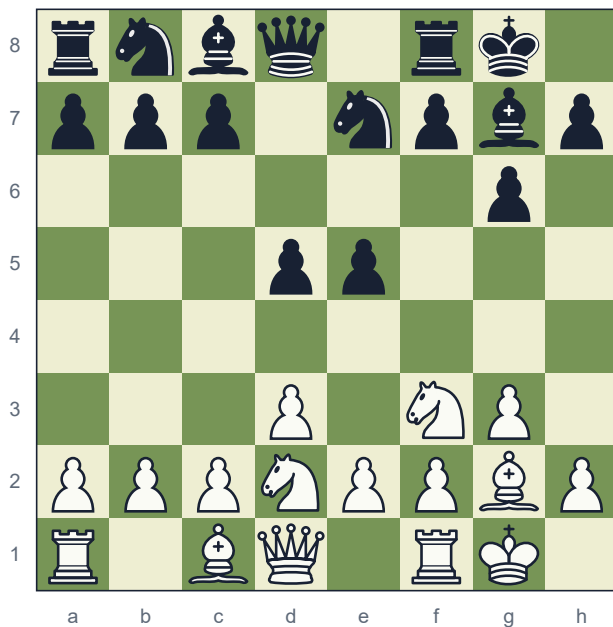
15 / OPENING RECALL

Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

16 / OPENING RECALL

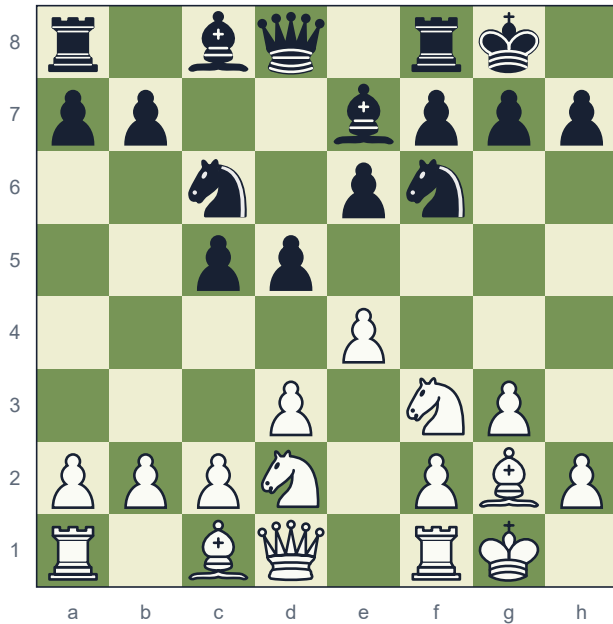
Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 17-18



White to move

17 / OPENING RECALL

Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

18 / OPENING RECALL

Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 19-20



White to move

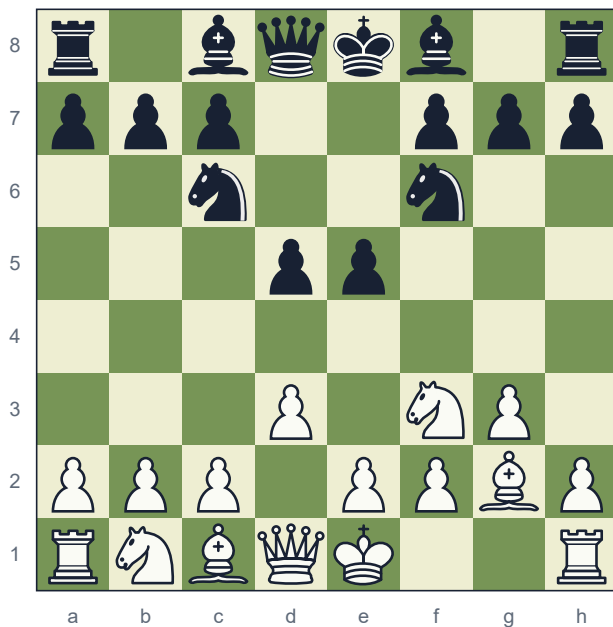
19 / OPENING RECALL

Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

20 / OPENING RECALL

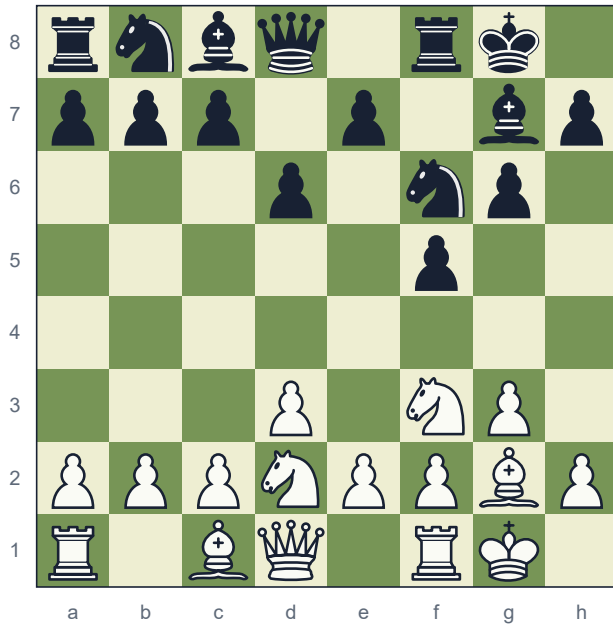
Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 21-22



White to move

21 / OPENING RECALL

Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

22 / OPENING RECALL

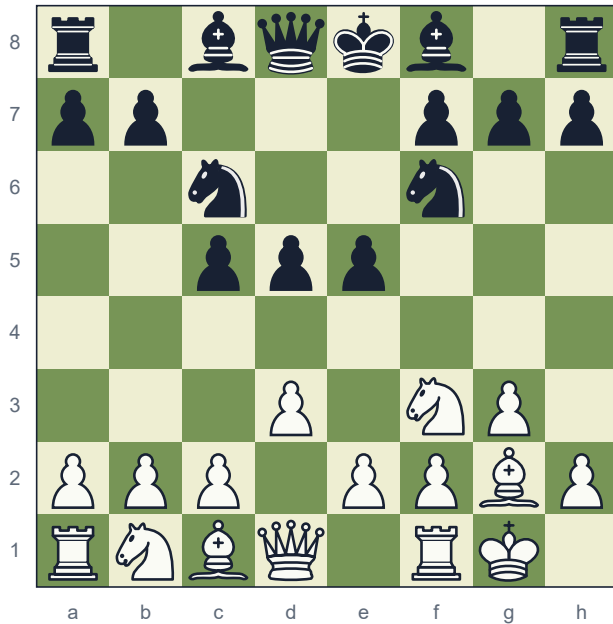
Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 23-24



White to move

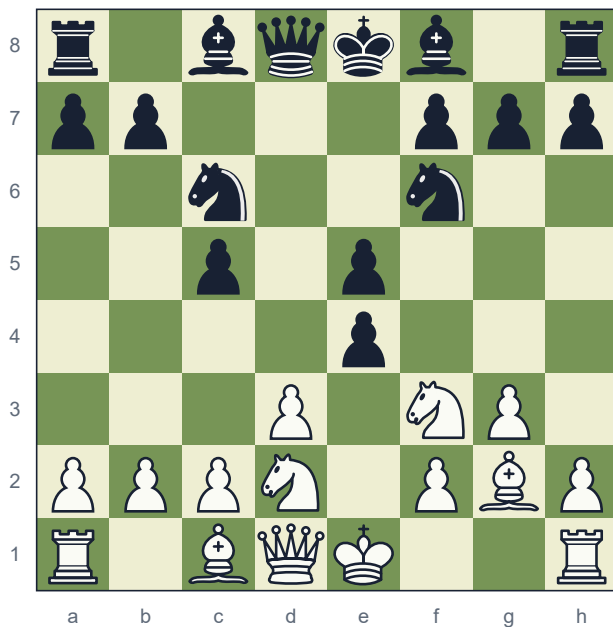
23 / OPENING RECALL

Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

24 / OPENING RECALL

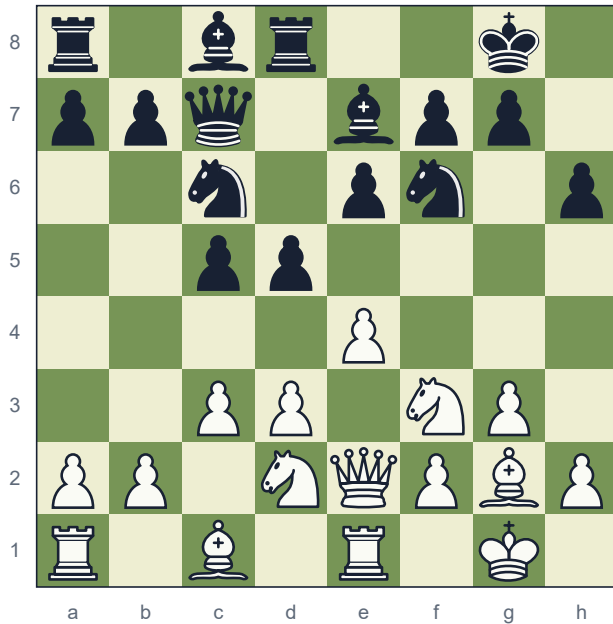
Choose the course move, explain its purpose and name one opposing resource. Other playable moves may exist; this is a repertoire-recall question.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 25-26



White to move

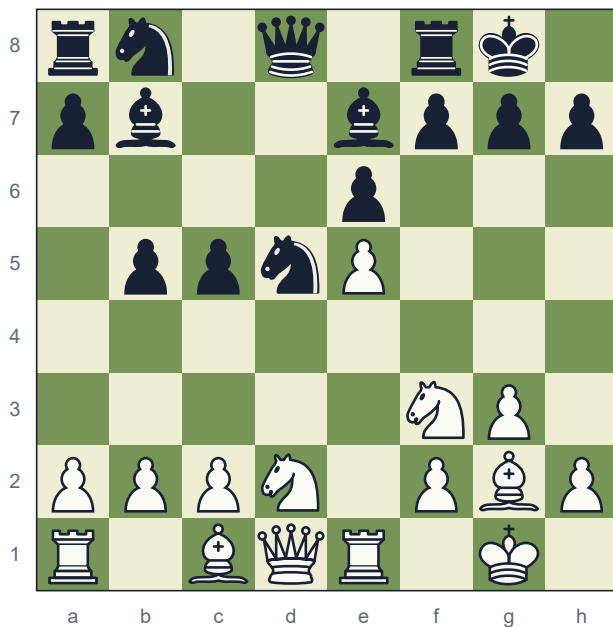
25 / PLAN AND DEFENSE

Name the side to move, describe the central structure and give a plan for your course side. Name the opponent's most relevant counterplay. No single move is required.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

26 / PLAN AND DEFENSE

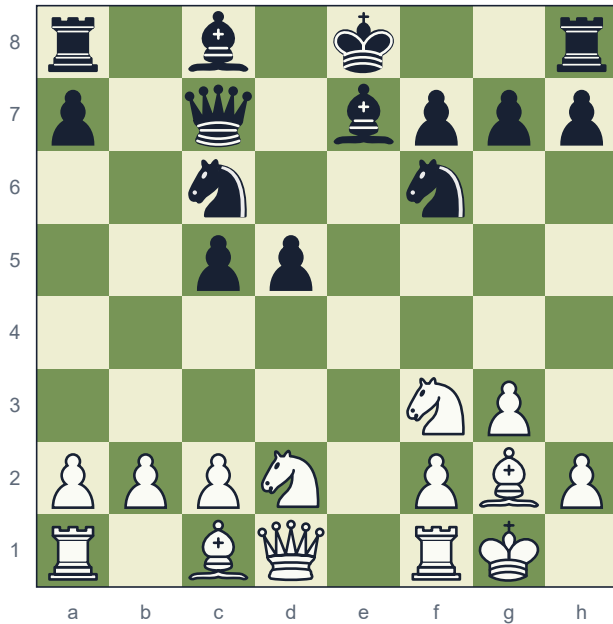
Name the side to move, describe the central structure and give a plan for your course side. Name the opponent's most relevant counterplay. No single move is required.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 27-28



White to move

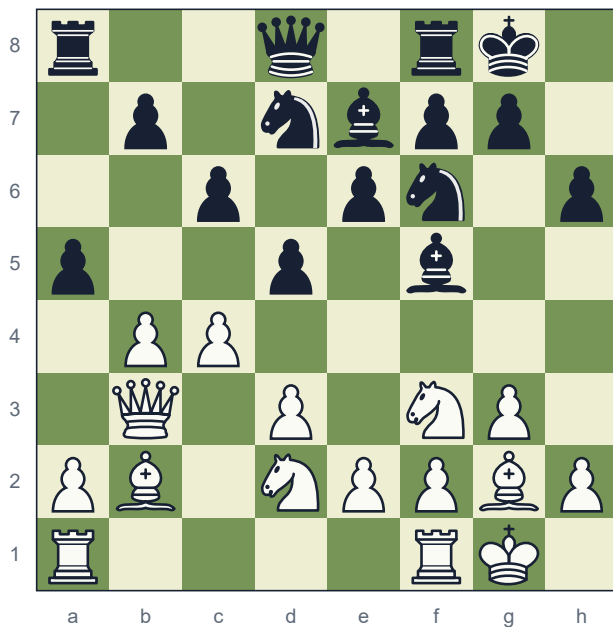
27 / PLAN AND DEFENSE

Name the side to move, describe the central structure and give a plan for your course side. Name the opponent's most relevant counterplay. No single move is required.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

28 / PLAN AND DEFENSE

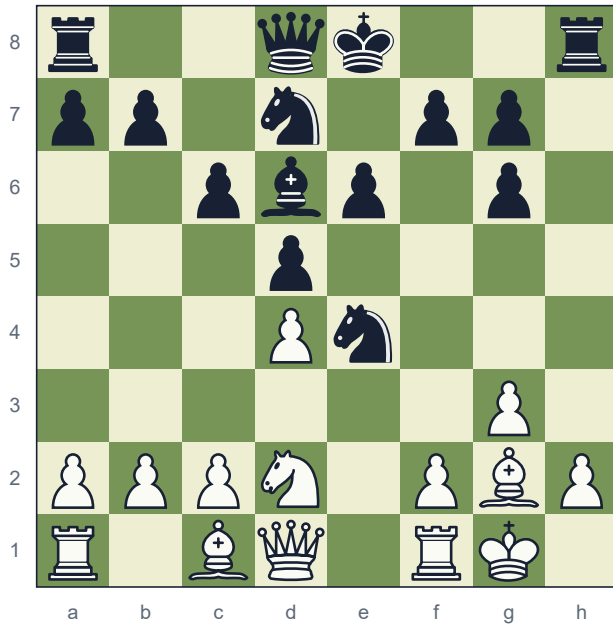
Name the side to move, describe the central structure and give a plan for your course side. Name the opponent's most relevant counterplay. No single move is required.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 29-30



White to move

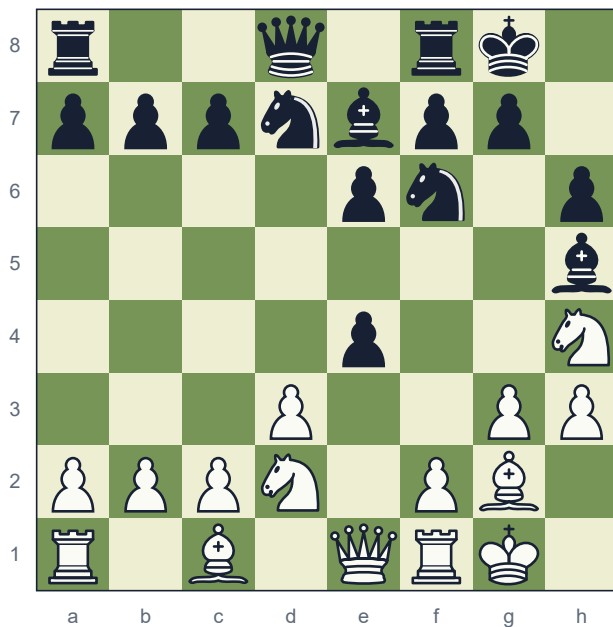
29 / PLAN AND DEFENSE

Name the side to move, describe the central structure and give a plan for your course side. Name the opponent's most relevant counterplay. No single move is required.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

30 / PLAN AND DEFENSE

Name the side to move, describe the central structure and give a plan for your course side. Name the opponent's most relevant counterplay. No single move is required.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 31-32



White to move

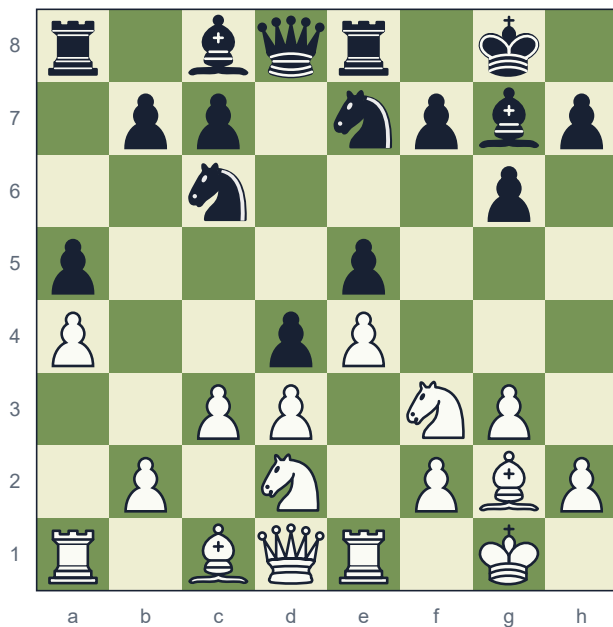
31 / PLAN AND DEFENSE

Name the side to move, describe the central structure and give a plan for your course side. Name the opponent's most relevant counterplay. No single move is required.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

32 / PLAN AND DEFENSE

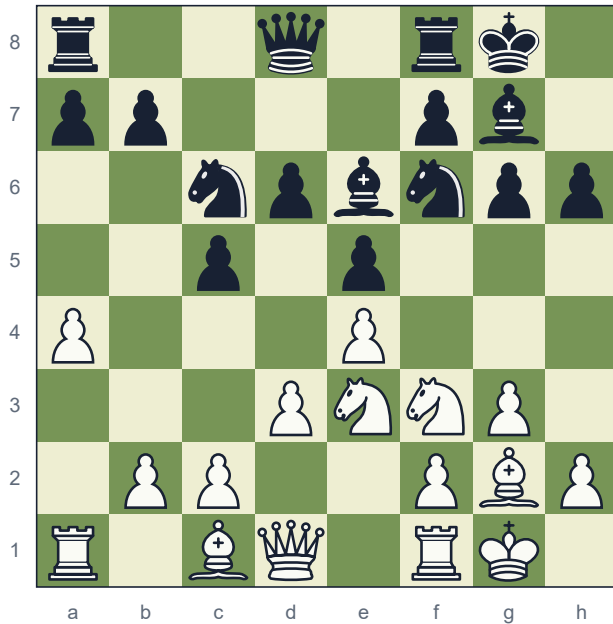
Name the side to move, describe the central structure and give a plan for your course side. Name the opponent's most relevant counterplay. No single move is required.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 33-34



White to move

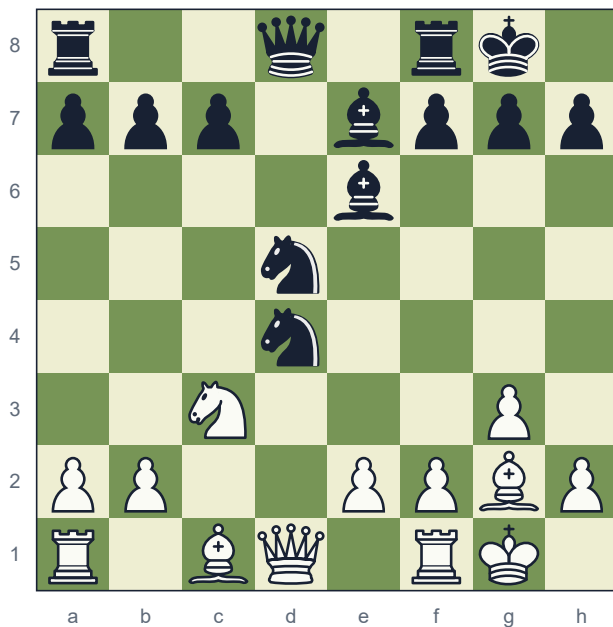
33 / PLAN AND DEFENSE

Name the side to move, describe the central structure and give a plan for your course side. Name the opponent's most relevant counterplay. No single move is required.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

34 / PLAN AND DEFENSE

Name the side to move, describe the central structure and give a plan for your course side. Name the opponent's most relevant counterplay. No single move is required.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 35-36



White to move

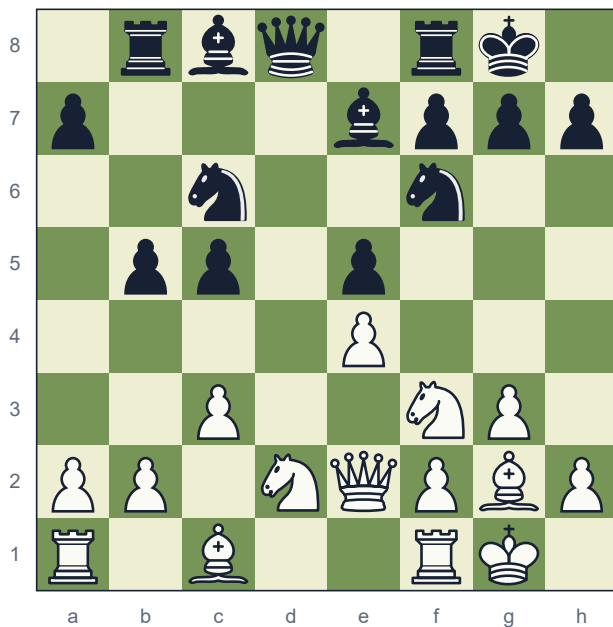
35 / PLAN AND DEFENSE

Name the side to move, describe the central structure and give a plan for your course side. Name the opponent's most relevant counterplay. No single move is required.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

36 / PLAN AND DEFENSE

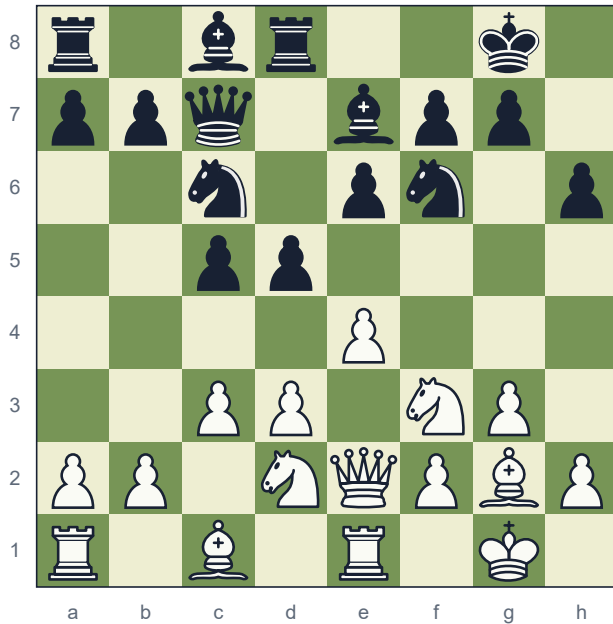
Name the side to move, describe the central structure and give a plan for your course side. Name the opponent's most relevant counterplay. No single move is required.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 37-38



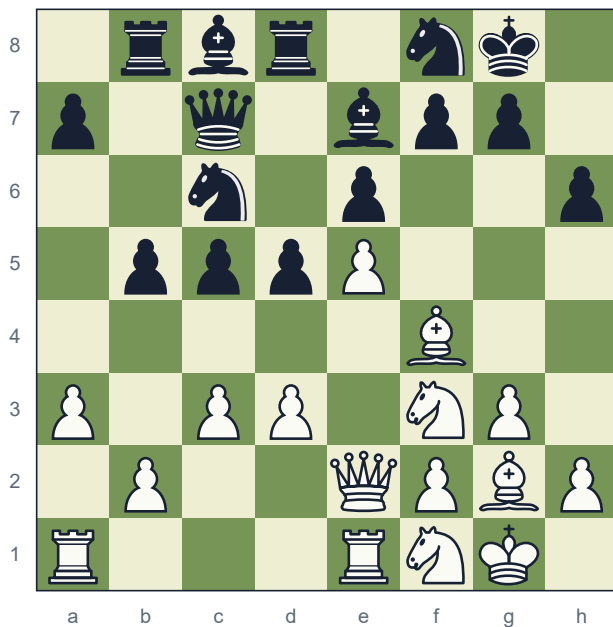
37 / CANDIDATE COMPARISON

Compare a4 with a3. Calculate a reply for each, choose your preference and explain it. Similar estimates can support both moves.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



38 / CANDIDATE COMPARISON

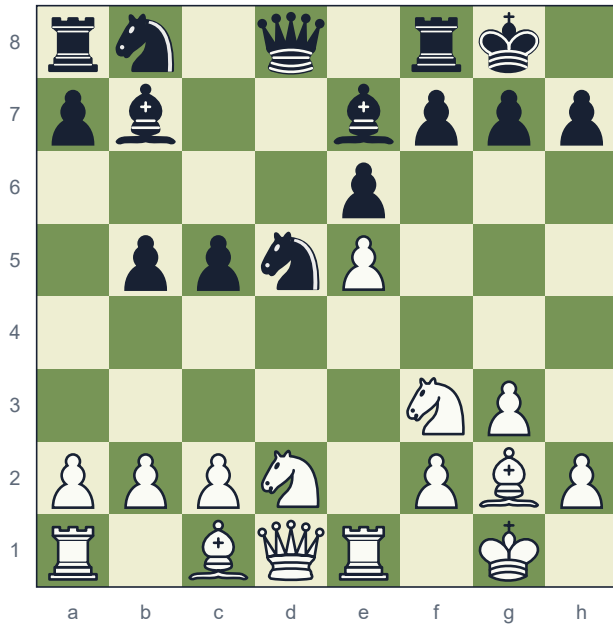
Compare h4 with d4. Calculate a reply for each, choose your preference and explain it. Similar estimates can support both moves.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 39-40



White to move

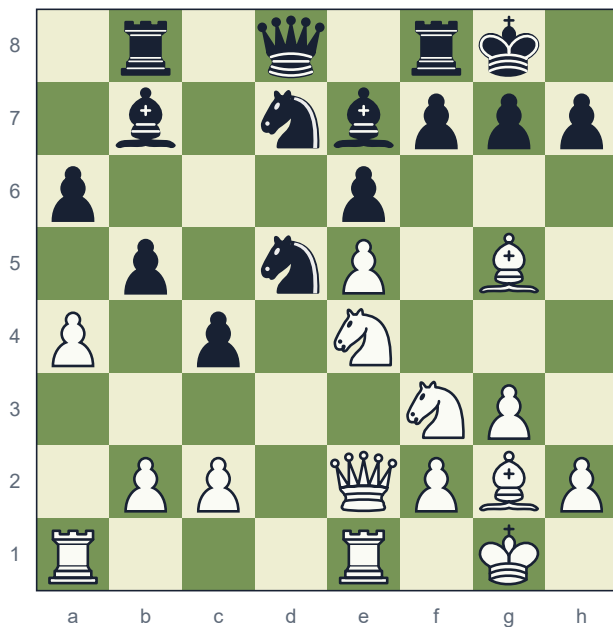
39 / CANDIDATE COMPARISON

Compare Ne4 with Qe2. Calculate a reply for each, choose your preference and explain it. Similar estimates can support both moves.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

40 / CANDIDATE COMPARISON

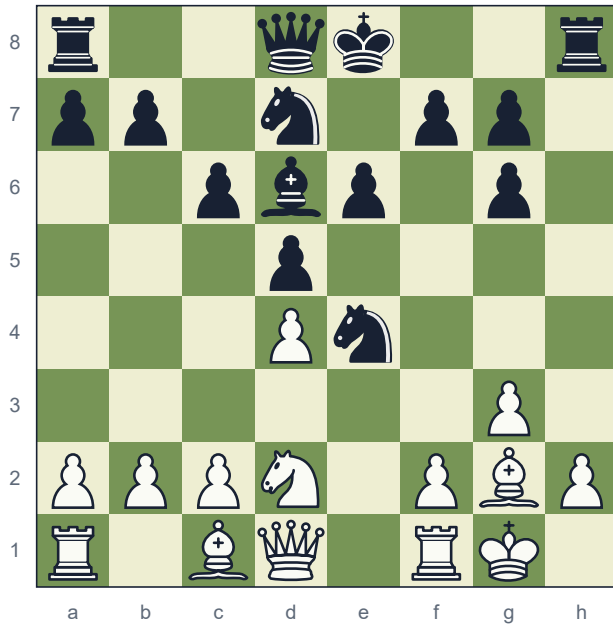
Compare axb5 with Rad1. Calculate a reply for each, choose your preference and explain it. Similar estimates can support both moves.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 41-42



White to move

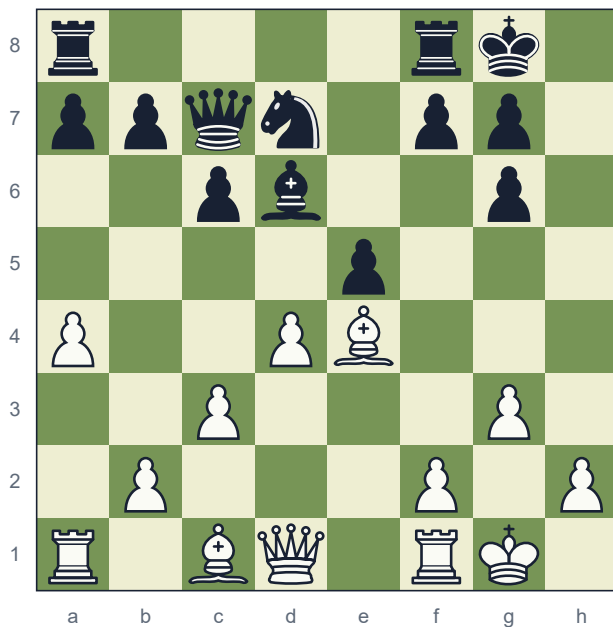
41 / CANDIDATE COMPARISON

Compare Bxe4 with Nxe4. Calculate a reply for each, choose your preference and explain it. Similar estimates can support both moves.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

42 / CANDIDATE COMPARISON

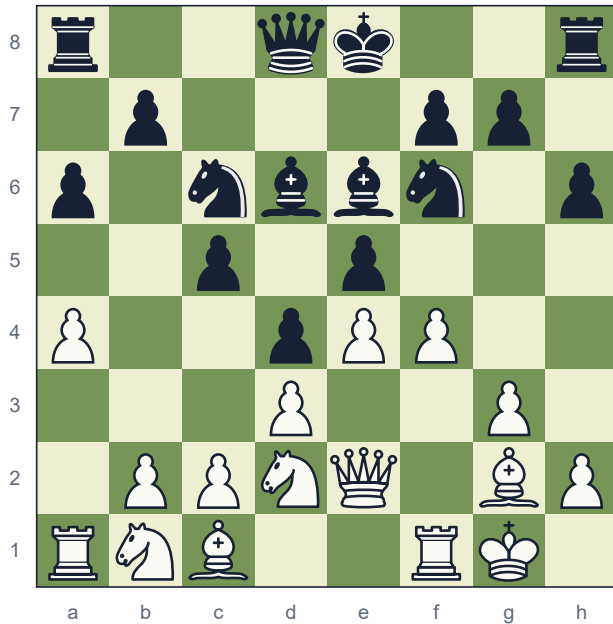
Compare Bg2 with a5. Calculate a reply for each, choose your preference and explain it. Similar estimates can support both moves.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 43-44



White to move

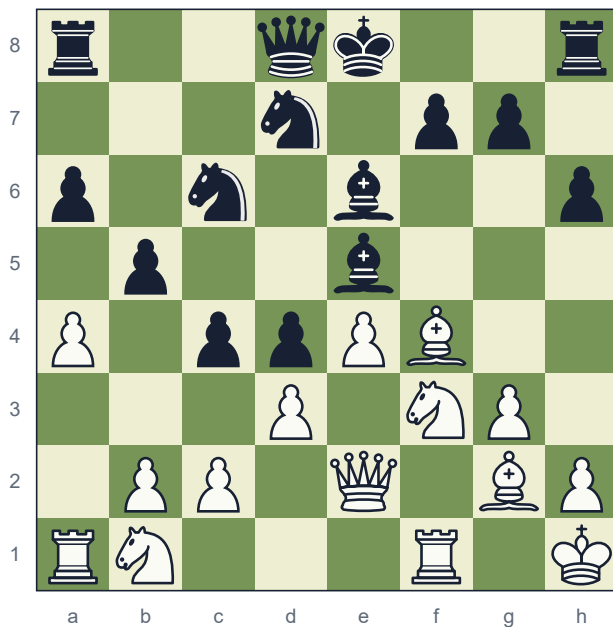
43 / CANDIDATE COMPARISON

Compare Nf3 with Kh1. Calculate a reply for each, choose your preference and explain it. Similar estimates can support both moves.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

44 / CANDIDATE COMPARISON

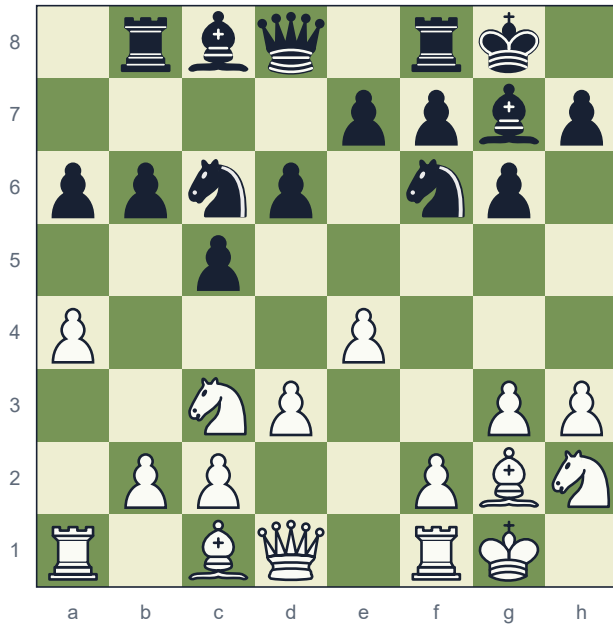
Compare Nbd2 with axb5. Calculate a reply for each, choose your preference and explain it. Similar estimates can support both moves.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 45-46



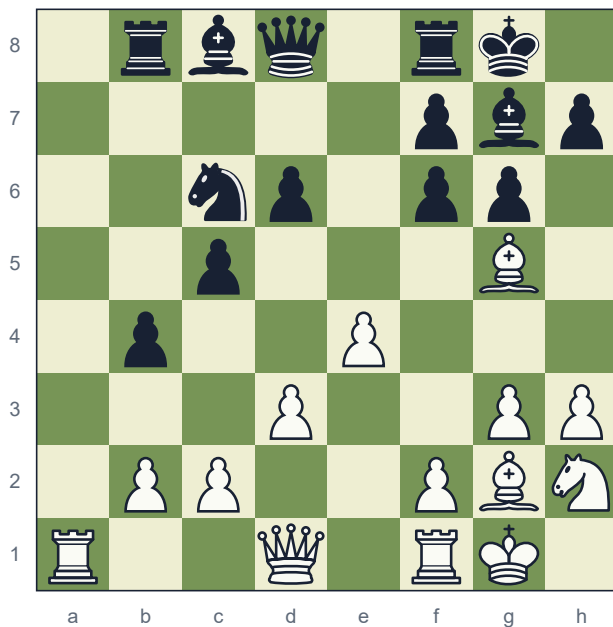
45 / CANDIDATE COMPARISON

Compare Bg5 with Nd5. Calculate a reply for each, choose your preference and explain it. Similar estimates can support both moves.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



46 / CANDIDATE COMPARISON

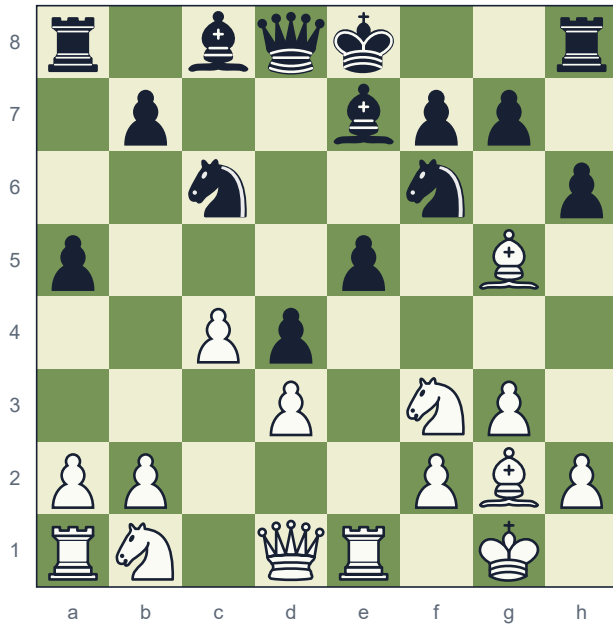
Compare Bf4 with Be3. Calculate a reply for each, choose your preference and explain it. Similar estimates can support both moves.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Exercises 47-48



White to move

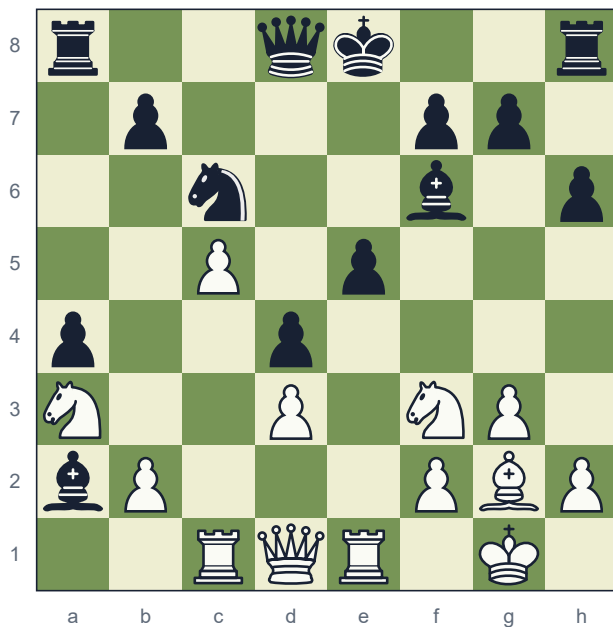
47 / CANDIDATE COMPARISON

Compare Bc1 with Bxf6. Calculate a reply for each, choose your preference and explain it. Similar estimates can support both moves.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:



White to move

48 / CANDIDATE COMPARISON

Compare Nc4 with Nd2. Calculate a reply for each, choose your preference and explain it. Similar estimates can support both moves.

My choice or plan:

My reason:

Opponent's resource:

Answers 1-2

01 / KIA-01

Course move: 8. Re1. Re1 supports e4 and makes e5 more credible. Black has a broad d5-c5 center and may expand on the queenside while White builds a kingside initiative.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

8. Re1 Qc7 9. c3 h6 10. Qe2 Rd8

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black can play ...Qc7, ...b5 or ...dxe4. A kingside attack is premature if e4 can simply be captured.

02 / KIA-02

Course move: 9. e5. Advancing e5 gains space and displaces Nf6, but fixes a pawn that Black can undermine with ...f6. The f1 knight route is now a plan, not a forced continuation.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

9. e5 Nd7 10. Qe2 b5

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black can strike at the base or head of the chain. A dramatic wing attack fails if the center opens with your pieces misplaced.

Answers 3-4

03 / KIA-03

Course move: 8. dxe4. The central exchange removes the familiar d5-e5 blockade. White's d-pawn becomes an e-pawn, opening the d-file and changing the bishop's prospects.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

8. dxe4 b5 9. e5 Nd5 10. Re1 Bb7

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

An automatic e5 attack plan may no longer fit. Black can use ...Nc6 and ...Qc7 to put pressure on e4.

04 / KIA-04

Course move: 7. e4. Black gains space and closes the d-file. White must choose where to challenge the chain rather than follow a standard e5 attack by habit.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

7. e4 d4 8. a4 b6 9. e5 Nd5

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

...Nc6 and ...e5 can consolidate a space advantage. Waiting without a pawn break can leave every white piece short of squares.

Answers 5-6

05 / KIA-05

Course move: 7. e4. Black has not declared the king's destination. White has no automatic target on g8 and should prepare useful central moves first.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

7. e4 Qc7 8. exd5 exd5 9. d4 b6

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

A pawn storm toward an empty kingside wastes time. Black may answer by exchanging central pawns with the king still flexible.

06 / KIA-06

Course move: 8. Re1. The same structural idea can be reached with 1.e4 and d3. Nd2 must precede Ngf3 here if White wants this exact arrangement without blocking a knight.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

8. Re1 Qc7 9. c3 h6 10. Qe2 Rd8

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black is not forced to play ...Nf6 or ...Be7. Early ...dxe4 or a different bishop development changes the task.

Answers 7-8

07 / KIA-07

Course move: 6. Nbd2. Black develops the light-squared bishop before closing it with ...e6. White cannot assume that Black has the restricted bishop of a French-type position.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

6. Nbd2 h6 7. c4 Be7 8. b4 O-O

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

The bishop on f5 influences e4 and may move to g6 if chased. A knight trip can cost more time than the bishop is worth.

08 / KIA-08

Course move: 7. dxc4. White changes the usual KIA pawn structure to challenge Black's center immediately. The d-pawn recapture opens the d-file and retains a central foothold.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

7. dxc4 Qxd1 8. Rxd1 Bc2 9. Rd2 Bf5

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black can exchange queens or use ...Nbd7 and ...Be7 to complete development. The position is now closer to a Reti structure than an e5 attack.

Answers 9-10

09 / KIA-09

Course move: 7. Nxg6. White gives a knight for the active bishop and changes Black's kingside pawn structure. The open h-file can help Black as well as create targets.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

7. Nxg6 hxg6 8. Nd2 Bd6 9. e4 Nbd7

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black's h8 rook now has an open file. Castling short was already a commitment, so watch pressure toward your own king.

10 / KIA-10

Course move: 6. Nbd2. Black pins or pressures Nf3 and establishes a broad center. White needs a central plan before beginning a maneuvering attack.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

6. Nbd2 e5 7. e4 dxe4 8. dxe4 h6

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

If Nf3 is exchanged, e4 may lose a defender. Count defenders after ...Bxf3 rather than before it.

Answers 11-12

11 / KIA-11

Course move: 6. Nbd2. Black develops actively while retaining the c-pawn's choice between c5 and c6. White keeps the usual pieces but must watch central pressure.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

6. Nbd2 Bh5 7. h3 h6 8. Qe1 Be7

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Copying the Slav plan can be inaccurate because Black can play ...c5 in one move. White's d3 pawn can become a target after central exchanges.

12 / KIA-12

Course move: 7. O-O. White can choose a KIA-style arrangement, but Black obtains an e5-d5 center and an active bishop. This is not the usual French target position.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

7. O-O Bc7 8. c3 Re8 9. Qc2 a5

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black may gain space with ...d4. A rehearsed e5 push is impossible while Black occupies e5.

Answers 13-14

13 / KIA-13

Course move: 7. e4. Both sides have fianchettoed and established restrained centers. White's extra move is useful, but the standard French-style kingside attack has no obvious hook.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

7. e4 c5 8. a4 Nc6 9. Nc4 h6

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

An unnecessary e5 can be captured or leave d5 weak. Black can challenge the center with ...c5 just as White can with c4.

14 / KIA-14

Course move: 7. e4. Black claims a broad center. White may need a central exchange or a lever rather than another slow redeployment.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

7. e4 e5 8. a4 a5 9. c3 Be6

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black can advance ...d4 and squeeze the knights. Passivity is a practical risk even without a direct tactical threat.

Answers 15-16

15 / KIA-15

Course move: 6. e4. Black closes the center with a space advantage. White has a reversed King's Indian type of position, but the move order and extra tempo require independent calculation.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

6. e4 d4 7. a4 Bd6 8. Nfd2 a6

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black can expand with ...b5 and ...c4. A slow maneuver must be measured against the opponent's actual pawn-break timing.

16 / KIA-16

Course move: 7. e4. Black develops the king knight to e7 and holds d5-e5. The absence of a knight on f6 changes both e5 ideas and possible kingside exchanges.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

7. e4 a5 8. a4 Re8 9. c3 Nbc6

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black may play ...Nbc6 or ...c5, gaining more space. Do not waste a tempo preparing to displace a knight that is not on f6.

Answers 17-18

17 / KIA-17

Course move: 8. Re1. This 1.e4 route can reach the French-type center when Black chooses ...d5 and ...e6. White keeps familiar plans without opening the Sicilian with an immediate d4.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

8. Re1 Qc7 9. c3 h6 10. Qe2 b5

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black may delay ...d5, fianchetto or expand on the queenside. The same first three moves do not guarantee the same middlegame.

18 / KIA-18

Course move: 7. Nbd2. Black fianchettoes and does not offer the French-type e6-d5 target. White's setup is playable but the main task is a central or queenside decision.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

7. Nbd2 O-O 8. a4 e5 9. Nc4 h6

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black can play ...Rb8 and ...b5, or ...d5 when ready. Waiting only for an e5 attack can concede the initiative.

Answers 19-20

19 / KIA-19

Course move: 6. e4. Starting with Nf3 allows Black a Sicilian-like or English-like structure. White can establish e4 after seeing Black's fianchetto.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

6. e4 Nf6 7. a4 O-O 8. Nc3 Rb8

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Nc3 blocks the c-pawn temporarily, while Nbd2 can crowd the queen bishop. Each knight square carries a structural commitment.

20 / KIA-20

Course move: 5. O-O. Black has gained a large center. White completes development while preparing a challenge; there is no obligation to finish every standard KIA move first.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

5. O-O Be7 6. c4 O-O 7. cxd5 Nxd5

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black can push ...e4 to attack Nf3 if the pawn is supported. Watch that immediate threat before choosing a quiet move.

Answers 21-22

21 / KIA-21

Course move: 7. e4. White challenges Black's kingside space through e4. Black's f-pawn move creates a different set of dark-square weaknesses and attacking chances.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

7. e4 fxe4 8. Nxe4 Nxe4 9. dxe4 e5

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black may use ...e5 and ...Nc6 to support a broad center. The g7 bishop and f-file can become active after exchanges.

22 / KIA-22

Course move: 6. e4. Black gains queenside space and develops the bishop to b7. White uses the time to establish e4 but must notice the long diagonal toward the king side.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

6. e4 d6 7. a4 b4 8. a5 c5

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black can pressure e4 after ...d5 or ...c5. A flank pawn advance may be part of central control, not merely a waste of time.

Answers 23-24

23 / KIA-23

Course move: 6. c4. White chooses c4 before e4 to challenge the broad center. Once Black closes with ...d4, the result belongs to a different structure from the main KIA attack.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

6. c4 d4 7. e3 Be7 8. exd4 cxd4

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black's d4 pawn restricts Nc3. Putting a piece on a square controlled by that pawn is a concrete error, regardless of a familiar development pattern.

24 / KIA-24

Course move: 7. dxe4. White delays castling while constructing the center. The exchange on e4 opens the d-file and makes queen exchanges a practical possibility.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

7. dxe4 Be7 8. c3 b5 9. Qe2 Rb8

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black can exchange queens if the file opens completely. Evaluate the king's destination in the resulting endgame rather than fearing a lost castling right automatically.

Answers 25-26

25 / KIA-01

White to move. White king g1; central-file pawns f2, c3, d3, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, d5, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move. Branch plan to reassess: Check whether e5 is safe, then consider Nf1 and h4 only if the center is stable. White's queen bishop needs a route, often through f4 or g5 after development.

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black can play ...Qc7, ...b5 or ...dxe4. A kingside attack is premature if e4 can simply be captured. Check which threats remain possible in this exact diagram.

26 / KIA-03

White to move. White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, e5. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move. Branch plan to reassess: Develop on open files and compare piece activity. Use the e4 outpost control and consider Nc4 when it creates a real threat.

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

An automatic e5 attack plan may no longer fit. Black can use ...Nc6 and ...Qc7 to put pressure on e4. Check which threats remain possible in this exact diagram.

Answers 27-28

27 / KIA-05

White to move. White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2. Black king e8; central-file pawns c5, d5, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move. Branch plan to reassess: Re1 supports e4; e5 can gain space if tactically justified. Wait to see whether Black castles or opens the center before committing the h-pawn.

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

A pawn storm toward an empty kingside wastes time. Black may answer by exchanging central pawns with the king still flexible. Check which threats remain possible in this exact diagram.

28 / KIA-07

White to move. White king g1; central-file pawns e2, f2, d3, c4. Black king g8; central-file pawns d5, c6, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move. Branch plan to reassess: Prepare e4 with adequate support, or choose c4 to challenge d5 directly. Consider Nh4 only if it wins a useful bishop exchange without neglecting the center.

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

The bishop on f5 influences e4 and may move to g6 if chased. A knight trip can cost more time than the bishop is worth. Check which threats remain possible in this exact diagram.

Answers 29-30

29 / KIA-09

White to move. White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, d4. Black king e8; central-file pawns d5, c6, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move. Branch plan to reassess: Develop the remaining pieces and use the bishop pair in a position that may open. Do not assume doubled pawns alone justify a direct attack.

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black's h8 rook now has an open file. Castling short was already a commitment, so watch pressure toward your own king. Check which threats remain possible in this exact diagram.

30 / KIA-11

White to move. White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, d3. Black king g8; central-file pawns e4, e6, c7, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move. Branch plan to reassess: Use e4 with sufficient support and prepare Re1 if needed. The queen can sometimes unpin Nf3 by moving from d1, but move it only for a clear reason.

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Copying the Slav plan can be inaccurate because Black can play ...c5 in one move. White's d3 pawn can become a target after central exchanges. Check which threats remain possible in this exact diagram.

Answers 31-32

31 / KIA-14

White to move. White king g1; central-file pawns f2, c3, d3, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns d4, e5, c7, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move. Branch plan to reassess: Consider exd5 and Re1, checking the recapture and pressure against e5. Look for c4 or c3-d4 only after comparing the resulting weak squares.

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black can advance ...d4 and squeeze the knights. Passivity is a practical risk even without a direct tactical threat. Check which threats remain possible in this exact diagram.

32 / KIA-16

White to move. White king g1; central-file pawns f2, c3, d3, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns d4, e5, c7, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move. Branch plan to reassess: Use a central lever and complete development. Consider exd5 when the resulting open file can be used by a rook rather than merely exchanging for its own sake.

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black may play ...Nbc6 or ...c5, gaining more space. Do not waste a tempo preparing to displace a knight that is not on f6. Check which threats remain possible in this exact diagram.

Answers 33-34

33 / KIA-18

White to move. White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f2, d3, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, e5, d6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move. Branch plan to reassess: Prepare c3 and d4 if favorable, or c4 for a different space structure. Develop the queen bishop before starting a slow knight tour.

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black can play ...Rb8 and ...b5, or ...d5 when ready. Waiting only for an e5 attack can concede the initiative. Check which threats remain possible in this exact diagram.

34 / KIA-20

White to move. White king g1; central-file pawns e2, f2. Black king g8; central-file pawns c7, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move. Branch plan to reassess: Use c4 or e4 only after calculating exchanges. Develop the queen knight to a square that supports the chosen lever.

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black can push ...e4 to attack Nf3 if the pawn is supported. Watch that immediate threat before choosing a quiet move. Check which threats remain possible in this exact diagram.

Answers 35-36

35 / KIA-22

White to move. White king g1; central-file pawns f2, c3, d3, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, d6, e6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move. Branch plan to reassess: Develop Nbd2 and support the center. a4 may question b5 if it creates a useful weakness without costing a central tempo.

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black can pressure e4 after ...d5 or ...c5. A flank pawn advance may be part of central control, not merely a waste of time. Check which threats remain possible in this exact diagram.

36 / KIA-24

White to move. White king g1; central-file pawns f2, c3, e4. Black king g8; central-file pawns c5, e5, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move. Branch plan to reassess: Compare castling with a useful queen move, then develop the queen bishop. Open-file control may matter more than preserving queens for an attack.

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Black can exchange queens if the file opens completely. Evaluate the king's destination in the resulting endgame rather than fearing a lost castling right automatically. Check which threats remain possible in this exact diagram.

Answers 37-38

37 / KIA-LAB-01

The finite search prefers a3 (-0.06 from White's perspective), compared with a4 (-0.08 from White's perspective). Controls nearby wing squares and may restrain a piece or pawn. Compare this useful purpose with the time lost to central development.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

11. a3 Rb8 12. d4 cxd4 13. Nxd4 Nxd4 14. cxd4 dxe4

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Alternative line: 11. a4

38 / KIA-LAB-01

The finite search prefers h4 (+0.24 from White's perspective), compared with d4 (-0.04 from White's perspective). Creates a wing or central pawn contact and changes king shelter. Calculate captures and the opponent's central counterplay before extending the advance.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

15. h4

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Alternative line: 15. d4 cxd4 16. Nxd4 Nxd4 17. cxd4 b4 18. axb4 Bxb4

Answers 39-40

39 / KIA-LAB-02

The finite search prefers Qe2 (+0.32 from White's perspective), compared with Ne4 (+0.26 from White's perspective). Places the queen on e2. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

11. Qe2

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Alternative line: 11. Ne4 Nd7 12. Qe2 c4 13. Bg5 Qb6 14. Bxe7 Nxe7

40 / KIA-LAB-02

The finite search prefers axb5 (+0.12 from White's perspective), compared with Rad1 (+0.05 from White's perspective). The pawn captures a pawn on b5. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

15. axb5 axb5 16. Rad1 Qc7 17. Nd4 Nxe5 18. Nxb5 Qb6

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Alternative line: 15. Rad1 Bxg5

Answers 41-42

41 / KIA-LAB-03

The finite search prefers Nxe4 (+0.56 from White's perspective), compared with Bxe4 (+0.21 from White's perspective). The knight captures a knight on e4. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

11. Nxe4

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Alternative line: 11. Bxe4 dxe4 12. Nxe4 Nf6 13. Re1 O-O 14. c3 Be7

42 / KIA-LAB-03

The finite search prefers Bg2 (+0.51 from White's perspective), compared with a5 (+0.51 from White's perspective). Completes the kingside fianchetto. Trace the diagonal to its first blocker; the bishop cannot attack through friendly pawns or pieces.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

15. Bg2 Rfe8

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Alternative line: 15. a5 Rfe8 16. Bg2 a6 17. Bg5 Be7 18. Be3 exd4

Answers 43-44

43 / KIA-LAB-04

The finite search prefers Kh1 (-0.31 from White's perspective), compared with Nf3 (-0.33 from White's perspective). Places the king on h1. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

11. Kh1 b5 12. Nf3 c4 13. fxe5 Bxe5 14. axb5 axb5

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Alternative line: 11. Nf3 b5 12. Nxe5 Nxe5 13. fxe5 Bxe5 14. Bf4 Nd7

44 / KIA-LAB-04

The finite search prefers Nbd2 (-0.04 from White's perspective), compared with axb5 (-0.28 from White's perspective). Develops the queen knight while leaving the c-pawn free. The knight supports e4 and may seek c4 or a route through f1.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

15. Nbd2 O-O 16. dxc4 bxa4 17. Rxa4 f6 18. b4 a5

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Alternative line: 15. axb5 axb5

Answers 45-46

45 / KIA-LAB-05

The finite search prefers Nd5 (-0.15 from White's perspective), compared with Bg5 (-0.23 from White's perspective). Places the knight on d5, attacking knight on f6. A legal capture may still be unsound if the target is defended.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

11. Nd5 b5 12. axb5 axb5 13. Bg5 b4 14. Nxf6+ Bxf6

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Alternative line: 11. Bg5 h6

46 / KIA-LAB-05

The finite search prefers Bf4 (-0.02 from White's perspective), compared with Be3 (-0.09 from White's perspective). Develops the queen bishop with central influence. Check whether a pawn advance can gain a tempo against it.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

15. Bf4

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Alternative line: 15. Be3 Qb6 16. Bf4 Ne5 17. Qd2

Answers 47-48

47 / KIA-LAB-06

The finite search prefers Bxf6 (+0.25 from White's perspective), compared with Bc1 (-0.78 from White's perspective). The bishop captures a knight on f6. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

11. Bxf6

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Alternative line: 11. Bc1 Nd7 12. Na3 O-O 13. Nb5 Re8 14. a3 a4

48 / KIA-LAB-06

The finite search prefers Nc4 (+0.06 from White's perspective), compared with Nd2 (-0.08 from White's perspective). Places the knight on c4. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

SAMPLE CONTINUATION

15. Nc4 O-O 16. Nfxe5 Bxe5 17. Nxe5 Bd5 18. Nxc6 bxc6

RESOURCE OR COMPARISON

Alternative line: 15. Nd2

A 12-week course you can repeat

WEEKLY WORKLOAD

Aim for four study sessions of 30-45 minutes and two slow practice games. If that is too much, stretch each week to two weeks. Consistency and review matter more than finishing on a deadline.

A 35-MINUTE SESSION

Spend 5 minutes recalling yesterday's position, 10 minutes learning one decision, 15 minutes calculating or playing a position, and 5 minutes writing the lesson. Keep the answer hidden during recall.

USE A MASTERY GATE

Move on when you can reconstruct the main branch, explain its plan and name the opponent's counterplay on two different days. If not, repeat the decision with a changed opposing reply.

DO NOT STUDY EVERY BRANCH EQUALLY

Prioritize the first line of each family and the lines your opponents play. Optional alternatives are comparison material after the main repertoire is stable.

Weeks 1-3

WEEK 1 / BOARD SKILLS AND THINKING ROUTINE

00 foundations; practice coordinates, legal moves, notation and the blunder check. Play two practice games and save one critical position. End the week by explaining a decision without the book.

WEEK 2 / FIRST OPENING FAMILY

01 family 1. Learn its main route, then two alternatives. Play two practice games and save one critical position. End the week by explaining a decision without the book.

WEEK 3 / SECOND OPENING FAMILY

01 family 2. Compare the opponent's central choices. Play two practice games and save one critical position. End the week by explaining a decision without the book.

REVIEW LOOP

Revisit new positions after 1 day, 3 days, 7 days and about a month. A failed recall is useful information: shorten the line and rebuild the reason for the move.

Weeks 4-6

WEEK 4 / THIRD OPENING FAMILY

01 family 3. Add common deviations and one warning position. Play two practice games and save one critical position. End the week by explaining a decision without the book.

WEEK 5 / FOURTH FAMILY AND BOUNDARIES

01 family 4. Distinguish the main repertoire from optional branches and bridges. Play two practice games and save one critical position. End the week by explaining a decision without the book.

WEEK 6 / PAWN STRUCTURES

02 strategic lessons 1-4. Identify the correct break from the actual center. Play two practice games and save one critical position. End the week by explaining a decision without the book.

REVIEW LOOP

Revisit new positions after 1 day, 3 days, 7 days and about a month. A failed recall is useful information: shorten the line and rebuild the reason for the move.

Weeks 7-9

WEEK 7 / DEFENSE AND TACTICS

02 remaining lessons and calculation audits. Practice checks, captures and opponent resources. Play two practice games and save one critical position. End the week by explaining a decision without the book.

WEEK 8 / FIRST THREE LABORATORIES

03 laboratories 1-3. Play each starting position from both sides. Play two practice games and save one critical position. End the week by explaining a decision without the book.

WEEK 9 / LAST THREE LABORATORIES

03 laboratories 4-6. Compare candidates before revealing the engine lines. Play two practice games and save one critical position. End the week by explaining a decision without the book.

REVIEW LOOP

Revisit new positions after 1 day, 3 days, 7 days and about a month. A failed recall is useful information: shorten the line and rebuild the reason for the move.

Weeks 10-12

WEEK 10 / ENDGAME TRANSITIONS

02 endgames. Analyze one legal exchange sequence from your own game. Play two practice games and save one critical position. End the week by explaining a decision without the book.

WEEK 11 / FULL RETRIEVAL TEST

04 questions 1-48. Write explanations before looking at answers. Play two practice games and save one critical position. End the week by explaining a decision without the book.

WEEK 12 / CONSOLIDATE YOUR OWN REPERTOIRE

Repair recurring errors and build a small personal file of the positions you actually meet. Play two practice games and save one critical position. End the week by explaining a decision without the book.

REVIEW LOOP

Revisit new positions after 1 day, 3 days, 7 days and about a month. A failed recall is useful information: shorten the line and rebuild the reason for the move.

Pocket reference / 1

THE FRENCH-TYPE CENTER

Use this card after studying the full explanations. It is a reminder, not a replacement for calculating the current position.

KIA-01 The core French-type position

Support e4 before converting it into an e5 wedge.

KIA-02 The e5 wedge and ...Nd7

An advanced pawn gives space and creates a target.

KIA-03 Black exchanges on e4

A changed pawn structure requires a changed plan.

KIA-04 Black closes with ...d4

Against a d4 wedge, identify a lever.

KIA-05 Black delays castling

Attack a real king position, not a remembered diagram.

KIA-06 The direct 1.e4 French route

A transposition is a position, not a similar-looking setup.

Pocket reference / 2

SLAV STRUCTURES AND ACTIVE BISHOPS

Use this card after studying the full explanations. It is a reminder, not a replacement for calculating the current position.

KIA-07 Slav setup: bishop outside the chain

Notice which bishop escaped the pawn chain.

KIA-08 A direct central challenge with c4

c4 is a useful adaptation, not a failure of the system.

KIA-09 Questioning Bf5 with Nh4

A damaged pawn structure may open useful lines for its owner.

KIA-10 The ...Bg4 pin

A pinned defender may not be a real defender.

KIA-11 An early ...Bg4 without ...c6

The location of the c-pawn changes the available break.

KIA-12 Caro-Kann route with 1.e4

Name the actual central pawns before naming your attack.

Pocket reference / 3

FIANCHETTOS AND OTHER CENTRAL STRUCTURES

Use this card after studying the full explanations. It is a reminder, not a replacement for calculating the current position.

KIA-13 Symmetrical fianchetto

Symmetry calls for useful improvements, not an automatic pawn storm.

KIA-14 Black chooses ...d5 in the fianchetto

When the opponent occupies the center, plan the challenge.

KIA-15 Reversed King's Indian structure

Reversed colors do not reverse every plan mechanically.

KIA-16 The Pachman setup

Count the real pieces around the intended pawn advance.

KIA-17 Sicilian with ...e6

The Sicilian entry is useful when the center matches.

KIA-18 Sicilian with ...d6

KIA piece placement does not guarantee a KIA attack.

Pocket reference / 4

FIRST-MOVE CHOICES AND USEFUL ADAPTATIONS

Use this card after studying the full explanations. It is a reminder, not a replacement for calculating the current position.

KIA-19 Black plays ...c5 on move one

Pick the knight square to support a plan.

KIA-20 Black occupies e5 immediately

A pawn attack on a piece overrides a setup plan.

KIA-21 Dutch-style ...f5

Meet wing space with a supported central challenge.

KIA-22 The ...b5 flank expansion

Ask what the flank bishop attacks.

KIA-23 Early ...d4 before the setup

Adapt the pawn structure before copying the piece setup.

KIA-24 Early central exchange before castling

Queen exchange can change what king safety means.

A practical game-analysis worksheet

GAME DETAILS

Date: _____ Opponent: _____ Time control: _____ Result: _____

FIRST UNFAMILIAR POSITION

Move number: _____ Relevant line ID: _____

What did the opponent's last move threaten? Write the FEN or save the position in your chess program.

MY CANDIDATES

Candidate A and a reply: _____

Candidate B and a reply: _____

Why did I choose the move I played?

DIAGNOSIS

Was the main error opening recall, missed tactics, the wrong pawn break, king safety, an exchange decision or time management? Choose the earliest cause that explains the later problem.

REPAIR

Write one concrete rule tied to the position. Add a short legal variation and schedule the next review. Do not add twenty engine moves that you cannot explain.

Glossary

ANCHOR

The authored move sequence defining a branch; later printed moves may be an illustrative continuation.

COMPENSATION

Activity, king pressure or structural advantages that may offset a material deficit.

COUNTERPLAY

Active threats or pressure that make the opponent address your ideas.

EN PRISE

A piece is available to be captured; check whether the capture is actually safe.

FIANCHETTO

Developing a bishop to b2, g2, b7 or g7 behind a moved b- or g-pawn.

INITIATIVE

The ability to pose threats that influence the opponent's replies.

ISOLATED PAWN

A pawn with no friendly pawn on either adjacent file.

Glossary / continued

MINORITY ATTACK

A pawn advance by fewer pawns against a larger pawn group to create weaknesses.

OUTPOST

A useful supported square for a piece, often difficult for enemy pawns to challenge.

PROPHYLAXIS

A move that anticipates and reduces the opponent's useful plan.

TEMPO

One move of time; useful tempi are gained when threats force helpful replies.

TRANSPOSITION

Different move orders reaching the same position with the same side to move and relevant rights.

ZWISCHENZUG

An intermediate move, often forcing, played before an expected recapture.

Sources and attribution

OPENING NAMES AND ROUTES

Lichess chess-openings is a CC0 reference for established names and entry move orders. The course commentary, study routes and practice curriculum are original. Some Hippo routes use descriptive teaching labels because opening-name databases use that term inconsistently.

<https://github.com/lichess-org/chess-openings>

ENGINE AND LEGAL-MOVE TOOLS

Stockfish 18 supplies finite tactical comparisons and illustrative continuations. python-chess 1.11.2 validates moves, positions and PGN.

<https://stockfishchess.org/download/>

<https://python-chess.readthedocs.io/>

PIECE ARTWORK

The Cburnett piece designs are by Colin M. L. Burnett, as distributed by python-chess. Adapted SVG sources, attribution and the GPL-2.0 license are included in Artwork_Credits_and_Sources. The palette and PDF drawing scale are adjusted; the original piece silhouettes are retained.

<https://python-chess.readthedocs.io/en/latest/svg.html>

Research scope and verification

KING'S INDIAN ATTACK CONTEXT

Public opening references identify the KIA as a flexible White setup. This course distinguishes its pawn structures and includes practical departures rather than treating the formation as a forced sequence.
<https://www.chess.com/openings/Kings-Indian-Attack>

WHAT WAS CHECKED

All 130 course anchors across the five courses were legally replayed. Repertoire-side decisions after the opening commitment received 80,000-node best-move and played-move comparisons; apparent losses above 1.00 were rechecked at 600,000 nodes. Flagged choices were revised. Warning lines deliberately contain mistakes and are marked.

ILLUSTRATIONS AND LIMITS

Short anchors were extended to about move ten using 140,000-node searches. Endpoints used 400,000 nodes; laboratory positions used 500,000 nodes per search. These are finite checks, not proofs of equality or exhaustive modern theory. Optional gambits and full Hippo formations retain practical and strategic risks.

WHAT THE NUMBERS MEAN

Laboratory estimates are expressed from your course side's perspective, so higher is better for that side. They are not literal pawn counts or guaranteed winning probabilities. Close candidate values should be treated as comparable, and deeper analysis may change the ordering.

PUBLICATION CHECKS

PDF text, page geometry, board legality and PGN replay are checked. Every combined-volume page is rendered for visual review. The supplied verification manifest records the final page counts and file hashes.